THE TANDEM COMPANION · BUILD 2

FOR THEIR ENTERTAINMENT

REMNIA

Standalone FTE Companion · Reference, Working Pages, and the Remnian Lineage Record

AUTHORED COPY	The Tandem Companion — Content Master, Stage 3 · Sep 26, 2026
PRODUCTION SYSTEM	The Tandem Companion — Production Master · Direction C
SOURCE AUTHORITY	Tandem Source Authority Audit — Working Record · Sep 26, 2026
AUTHOR RULINGS	TCD-001–064 · TCD-058 clarification (2026-09-26) · IV.2 / IV.3 status corrections (2026-10-09)
LINEAGE RECORD	Rebuilt from evidence, 2026-10-09. A derived record, not a source.
ASSEMBLED	2026-10-09

VOLUME NOTE · BUILD 2

B2 ABOUT THIS VOLUME

What this standalone volume holds, and how to read its references.

This is Build 2 of the Tandem Companion: a standalone working volume for *For Their Entertainment* and Remnia. It carries Part I (how the Companion works) in full, the Part II sections FTE depends on, and all of Part IV, with working pages for IV.10 and IV.25 and a rebuilt working record of the Remnian imperial and royal lineage after IV.11. The copy is the locked Stage 3 Content Master; this volume lays it out and adds working pages. It doesn't add canon.

Some pages point to sections that live only in the full Tandem Companion. Two conventions keep those pointers honest:

- **Continuity Room and 3SL pointers resolve here.** References to VII.1, VII.2, VII.5, VII.7, VII.8, VII.10, VII.12 and Part VII, and to the 3SL sections III.3, III.13–III.16, III.18, III.20 and Part III, lead to the FTE Continuity Room concordance near the end of this volume, which names where the FTE information already sits in these pages.
- **Everything else outside the volume carries a dagger (†).** A reference marked † is to a section of the full Tandem Companion that isn't printed here.
- **Page numbers.** "See also" chips give the page where each in-volume section starts.

CORRECTIONS APPLIED IN THIS VOLUME

Two author status corrections post-date the Content Master and are applied where the claims appear (IV.2, IV.3). The lineage reconstruction also corrected one status and several source attributions in IV.11, IV.12 and IV.22; each is logged in the QA report with the exact text it replaces. Rulings without a TCD number are listed in Appendix A.

AUTHOR CORRECTION · 2026-10-09 · IV.2 AND IV.3

● CANON	Remnia is an empire on its own continental landmass, separated from Somnoria by ocean; the Crown sits at the highest public civil/dynastic level of the Remnian sovereignty structure.	TCD-025 · TCD-041
■ DRAFTED	Remnia has seventeen provinces.	FTE Beta (ch. 2 and two further passages; IV.2)
■ DRAFTED	The military structure (the Legion, the Vanguard, the En Guard). TCD-041 is the layered sovereignty framework, not the military's place in it.	FTE Beta chs. 1, 5, 26

THE LINEAGE RECORD

The pages after IV.11 rebuild the Remnian imperial and royal lineage from the sources, claim by claim. Each claim carries its source and the status that source earns. Biology, legal family status, the public record, titles and succession are kept in separate layers. The record is a derived working record, not a new source, and it settles nothing the rulings leave open. The unaudited *Imperial Lineage* was used only for comparison.

WHAT ISN'T IN THIS VOLUME

Part III and Parts V–VII (3SL, ADST, TSWK and the full Continuity Room); the Part II sections FTE doesn't stand on (II.1, II.3, II.7–II.12); and Appendix D. The appendices printed here are FTE slices: the rulings, conflicts, sources and terms this volume cites.

CONTENTS · BUILD 2

B2 CONTENTS

FRONT		
	About This Volume	2
PART I		6
I.1	What the Tandem Companion Is	7
I.2	The Manuscript Outranks the Companion	10
I.3	How Source Authority Works	12
I.4	Reading a Claim: Status Markers	15
I.5	Knowledge States	18
I.6	Open Canon, Decisions, and Updates	21
I.7	Using the Companion While Drafting	24
PART II		26
II.2	Macro Geography	27
II.4	Knowledge of the Other Lands	29
II.5	Shared Magical Ancestry	32
II.6	Crossblood: A Label, Not a Biology	35
II.13	The Shattered Veil and Its Descendants	37
II.14	The Elders' Prayer	42
II.15	Recurring Institutional Misreadings	45
II.16	Shared Chronology	47
PART IV		49
IV.1	Book Identity and Source Status	51
IV.2	Remnia at a Glance	54
IV.3	Power and Jurisdiction	57
IV.4	The Sanctum	62
IV.5	Elemental Magic	65
IV.6	The Tournament: Structure and Purpose	69
IV.7	The Challenges	72

CONTENTS

CONTINUED

IV.8	Conqueror Rules	77
IV.9	Katherine Nicholas	80
IV.10	Katherine's Elemental Anatomy	83
IV.10	Your Pages: Katherine’s Elemental Anatomy	87
IV.11	Lineage: Biology, Law, Record, Succession	98
IV.11	Record: Remnian Imperial + Royal Lineage	102
IV.12	Katherine's Concealment	150
IV.13	The Sister Reveal	153
IV.14	Melena Lockwood	157
IV.15	Caelum and Melena: The Leverage Ledger	160
IV.16	Atlas: The Synchronization Injury	163
IV.17	The Elders' Prayer in FTE	166
IV.18	Supporting Cast	169
IV.19	Minho Augustine	173
IV.20	The Endgame: Forfeit and Command Authority	176
IV.21	Plot State	179
IV.22	Knowledge Progression	181
IV.23	Cross-Book Connections	184
IV.24	FTE Endgame Packet	187
IV.25	FTE Open Development	190
IV.25	Working Pages: FTE Open Development	193

CONTINUITY ROOM · FTE

VII·FTE	Continuity Room: FTE Concordance	216

APPENDICES · FTE SLICES

	A · Canon Decision Log	223
	B · High-Impact Conflict Register	251
	C · Source Authority Inventory	260
	E · Terminology Register	267

PART I · BUILD 2

HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

This Part teaches you to trust a page in under ten minutes. Every later Part assumes you know what a status marker permits, which source wins in which domain, and why a character can't know something just because you do.

§	SECTION	PAGE TYPE	PAGE
I.1	What the Tandem Companion Is	ORIENTATION	7
I.2	The Manuscript Outranks the Companion	RULE	10
I.3	How Source Authority Works	SOURCE AUTHORITY	12
I.4	Reading a Claim: Status Markers	STATUS KEY	15
I.5	Knowledge States	EXPLAINER	18
I.6	Open Canon, Decisions, and Updates	PROTOCOL	21
I.7	Using the Companion While Drafting	CHECKLIST	24

ORIENTATION · PART I · HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

I.1 WHAT THE TANDEM COMPANION IS

Frame the book as a working writer-room reference, not a wiki or workbook.

The Tandem Companion is the working reference for four novels set in one physical world: *3 Shadowmere Lane*, *For Their Entertainment*, *A Dream So Twisted*, and *The Sea Will Keep*. It holds the canon those books have already committed to, the rulings that settled their contradictions, and the open questions they haven't answered yet. It sits beside the manuscript while you draft. It isn't a replacement for it.

The Companion does five jobs. It remembers what's been ruled and drafted so you don't have to reread three generations of files to find out. It distinguishes things a drafter will blur: the Nightmare organization from the ancient entity, Katherine's Frost from Zephyr's, the forensic record of Remy's death from Melena's guilt about it. It connects the books only where a ruling or source connects them. It protects chronology and knowledge, so nobody in 3SL behaves as if they've read ADST. And it catches resurrected ideas, the retired concepts that keep sneaking back because they were once written down with confidence.

It refuses a few jobs on purpose. It won't fill a gap because the gap looks awkward in print. It won't pick the nicer version of a conflict. It won't invent a sigil, a motto, a date, a map coordinate, or a line of scripture to make a page feel finished. It isn't a fan wiki, a marketing synopsis, or a workbook of blank lines waiting for you to do the thinking. When the sources don't know something, the Companion says so plainly, and that sentence is worth more than a confident guess.

FOUR BOOKS, FOUR LANDS

BOOK	LAND	POINT OF VIEW	CONTROLLING GENERATION	WHERE THE DRAFTING STANDS
***3 Shadowmere Lane* (3SL)**	The Underside	Alternating Silas Graves / Isola Wraithmoor chapters (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)	*3 Shadowmere Lane First Draft*, 22 chapters, revised through 2026-08-19	Drafted through ch. 22; the draft stops with Remy alive and the transit route unresolved. The 32-chapter outline controls only its fixed anchors (TCD-002).
***For Their Entertainment* (FTE)**	Remnia	Katherine Nicholas / Melena Lockwood chapters (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)	*FTE Official Beta Reader Copy*, through ch. 29	Endgame heavily ruled but undrafted in the controlling generation. The Chapter 29 fragment and chs. 31–39 require rewrite before they count (TCD-001).
***A Dream So Twisted* (ADST)**	Somnoria	Reverie Hollow chapters confirmed on-page; any additional POV is confirmed in Part V†	*ADST*, 19 chapters	Draft ends before the rebuilt Network-rupture climax, which is ruled at outcome level (TCD-060–061).
***The Sea Will Keep* (TSWK)**	Thalara	Dual Azrine / Levi (established premise)	No manuscript. *Thalara Worldbuilding* and *Azrine and Levi* govern; the July 2026 44-chapter blueprint is provisional by claim	Ending open (TCD-012).

Why the table matters: a drafter who asks "what's true?" has to ask it about a specific book, because each book stands at a different stage. 3SL has a controlling draft and a partly retired outline. TSWK has no draft at all, so its most detailed plan is still only a plan. The same kind of question gets a different kind of answer depending on the row.

SOURCE *Audit, Source Inventory; TCD-001, TCD-002, TCD-003, TCD-012; 3SL draft chs. 1–12 (POV headings); FTE Beta chs. 8, 18 (POV headings); ADST ch. 18 (POV heading).*

SEE ALSO I.2 The Manuscript Outranks the Companion · **p.10**

I.3 How Source Authority Works · **p.12**

RULE · PART I · HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

I.2 THE MANUSCRIPT OUTRANKS THE COMPANION

State the single rule that keeps the Companion subordinate to the books.

Drafted prose controls drafted events. If a chapter in the controlling generation shows something happening, it happened, and the Companion records it. If that chapter deliberately changes something the Companion already printed, the Companion changes. A printed page never gets to veto a scene.

That rule has limits that matter as much as the rule. The manuscript controls what it actually shows: POV, scene order, revealed identities, performed magic, relationships, and immediate consequences. It doesn't automatically control national geography, deep history, or magical taxonomy just because a character says something about them. When Silas thinks nobody born in the Underside carries fire, that's a drafted fact about what Silas believes. It becomes world-level canon only if a ruling or the governing worldbuilding agrees. A manuscript can also be wrong by accident. A typo, a stray name from an older generation, or a detail that contradicts a ruling isn't a deliberate change; it's a drafting flag, and the Companion logs it as one instead of rewriting canon around it.

Open and provisional material works the other way. Where the Companion marks something ○ OPEN or ◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL, drafting is allowed to settle it. When a scene commits to an answer on purpose, that commitment becomes the new record, and the Companion's update protocol (I.6) moves the old version to the Legacy Recovery Index rather than deleting it.

GUARDRAIL

Never bend a scene to match a Companion page. If the scene is right and the page is wrong, fix the page. If the scene contradicts an author ruling (a TCD), stop and decide which one you mean; don't let either quietly win.

Why it matters: the Companion is only trustworthy if it can't become a second, rival manuscript. The moment a printed entry starts dictating prose, the books stop being written and start being transcribed from an index.

I.2 · THE MANUSCRIPT OUTRANKS THE COMPANION

CONTINUED

SOURCE *Audit, Preliminary Domain-Based Source Authority Map, rule 2; Production Master A1; 3SL draft ch. 3 (Silas's belief about Underside fire).*

SEE ALSO I.6 Open Canon, Decisions, and Updates · **p.21**

VII.12 Open Canon Queue → FTE concordance · **p.216**

I.3 HOW SOURCE AUTHORITY WORKS

Teach the domain-specific ladder so a reader knows why a claim is trusted.

Authority is domain-specific. A source can settle one kind of fact and have no say over another. The 3SL draft is the last word on what happens in Dante Mercer's office in chapter 3; it isn't the last word on how far Crownlight sits above sea level. The Thalara worldbuilding file governs Thalaran geography; it can't overrule a ruling about the Drowning. Every claim in this book is trusted because of the rung it stands on in its own domain.

THE AUTHORITY LADDER

RUNG	SOURCE TYPE	WHAT IT CONTROLS	WHAT IT CAN'T DO
1	Explicit author rulings (Canon Decision Log, TCD-001 onward)	Every domain a ruling addresses	Nothing outranks it except a later ruling
2	Current manuscript pages	What happened on-page: POV, scene chronology, revealed identity, performed magic, relationships, immediate consequences	Settle geography, history, or taxonomy by a character's say-so
3	Locked constraints (*Novel Constraints*, as corrected by rulings)	Intended premise and undrafted core engine	Override a drafted scene or a later ruling
4	Current outlines and chapter plans	Undrafted plot, once their generation is confirmed	Overwrite anything already drafted
5	Current book-specific worldbuilding, character, magic, and institutional files	Geography, institutions, culture, baseline magic, backstory where the manuscript is silent	Contradict a ruling or an on-page event
6	Shared Tandem lore	Its claims one at a time, only where they survive review	Serve as a blanket master plan
7	Supporting artifacts (timelines, placement tables, genealogy workbooks, poems, quote maps)	Their narrow domain, after consistency checks	Fill gaps outside that domain
8	Marketing files	Positioning language	Establish any canon

RUNG	SOURCE TYPE	WHAT IT CONTROLS	WHAT IT CAN'T DO
9	Legacy drafts and plans	Creative history and recovery leads	Answer a current question
10	TKC Companion materials	Structural and philosophical models only	Contribute any Tandem canon, ever

Two rules sit above the ladder. First, the Tandem Source Authority Audit's rulings override conflicting source material wherever they speak. Second, filenames and dates confer nothing. "FINAL," "Official," "New," and a recent year are labels a file picked up along the way. *FTE 2025 FINAL* is Legacy. *New FTE Chapters* predates the modern Remnia execution. A later date on the TSWK blueprint doesn't make it a ruling.

Worked example: the Beta versus the 2025 FINAL. *FTE 2025 FINAL* is a complete 47-chapter manuscript. The *FTE Official Beta Reader Copy* stops at chapter 29. A reader who trusts completeness picks the FINAL and gets the ending for free. TCD-001 says no: the Beta is the controlling prose generation, and nothing outside it becomes canon until it's rewritten into that generation. The FINAL still earns its shelf space as planning evidence for the unfinished half, but its simple Dyad/Crossblood explanation, its reveal shortcut, its cause for Atlas's deterioration, and its Tiran-only forfeit are all superseded by TCD-049 through TCD-052. The complete file lost to the incomplete one because the incomplete one is the book being written.

CURRENT CONTROLLING GENERATIONS AT A GLANCE

BOOK	CONTROLS DRAFTED EVENTS	SUPPORTS UNDRAFTED WORK	STATUS OF THE REST
3SL	*3 Shadowmere Lane First Draft*, 22 chapters	32-chapter outline for fixed anchors only; *3SL Character Outlines*; *3SL Full Worldbuilding*	The outline's chapter map no longer controls (TCD-002)
FTE	*FTE Official Beta Reader Copy*, through ch. 29	Chapter 29 fragment and chs. 31–39 (rewrite required); *The Challenges FTE Year*; *49th Chess Tournament Placements*	Every pre-Beta generation is Legacy (TCD-001)
ADST	*ADST*, 19 chapters	Revised 17-chapter plan; retained climax components from the older 42-chapter plan	The older plan's early execution and ending outcome are superseded (TCD-003, TCD-053)

BOOK	CONTROLS DRAFTED EVENTS	SUPPORTS UNDRAFTED WORK	STATUS OF THE REST
TSWK	No manuscript	*Thalara Worldbuilding*; *Azrine and Levi*; July 2026 44-chapter blueprint, provisional by claim	Ending open (TCD-012)

SOURCE NOTE

The Project copies of several files carry names without the version suffixes the audit used (*3 Shadowmere Lane First Draft* rather than *First Draft(9)*; *ADST* rather than *ADST(3)*). The Companion treats each as the audited generation because its content matches the audit's description. *The Imperial Lineage* appears in the Project but not in the audit inventory, so it holds no assigned authority until it's classified; nothing in Parts I–III relies on it.

Why it matters: most canon errors in a four-book universe aren't invented facts. They're real facts pulled from the wrong generation or the wrong domain. The ladder is how the Companion answers "which file?" before it answers "what's true?"

SOURCE *Audit, Preliminary Domain-Based Source Authority Map; Production Master A2; TCD-001, TCD-002, TCD-003, TCD-010, TCD-012.*

SEE ALSO Appendix C Source Authority Inventory · **p.260**

STATUS KEY · PART I · HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

I.4 READING A CLAIM: STATUS MARKERS

Teach the eight markers and the wording each allows.

A status marker attaches to a claim, not to a page. One dossier page can hold settled canon, a drafted fact, a plan, and an open question side by side, and each keeps its own label. The marker also controls the grammar. A ◌ POSSIBLE claim written in confident present tense is a canon error even with the ◌ POSSIBLE sitting next to it, because readers believe sentences before they believe badges.

STATUS KEY

MARKER	MEANING	PERMITTED WORDING	FORBIDDEN WORDING
● CANON	Established by an author ruling or a controlling source in its domain	Plain declarative present tense, with the TCD or source cited	Hedging that makes settled canon look optional
■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT	Established on-page in the controlling manuscript generation	"On-page, ..." · "As drafted, ..." · "In ch. 7, ..."	Treating it as immune to revision
◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL	A current plan, bible, blueprint, or artifact that hasn't become drafted canon	"The outline plans..." · "The blueprint proposes..." · "The worldbuilding file describes..."	Present-tense narration of events as though they happened
◌ POSSIBLE	A live candidate or recovery idea, not approved	"A candidate is..." · "One viable reading..." · "If recovered, ..."	"Is," "will," or "does" about the story world
○ OPEN	Unresolved; an author decision is needed if and when drafting forces it	State what's fixed, then name exactly what isn't	Filling the gap with a plausible answer
◇ CONFLICT	Current sources disagree and no ruling settles it	Name both sources and both claims	Picking the nicer version silently

I.4 · READING A CLAIM: STATUS MARKERS

CONTINUED

MARKER	MEANING	PERMITTED WORDING	FORBIDDEN WORDING
☐ RESEARCH	Needs outside factual research	State the research question	Presenting a guess as fact
~~LEGACY / SUPERSEDED~~	Creative history that no longer controls	Past tense, source named: "The 2025 FINAL had…"	Using it to answer a current question

HOW TO READ A CLAIM: SIX WORKED EXAMPLES

CLAIM AS PRINTED	STATUS	WHY IT'S LABELED THIS WAY
Katherine Nicholas is the current Tournament's Conqueror.	● CANON · TCD-034	An author ruling fixes it, so it takes plain present tense even though the scene that earns it isn't drafted yet. The ruling controls the outcome; the manuscript still has to build the causal path.
On-page, Katherine's Examination puts her through severe Fire trauma and still produces only Frost.	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT · FTE Beta; TCD-058	The Beta shows it. TCD-058 later explains why it happens (dominant Frost configuration, no ordinary stress trigger), but the event itself is anchored in drafted prose.
The July 2026 blueprint plans Azrine's ordination near the end of Book One.	◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL · blueprint, per audit HC-061	The most detailed TSWK plan proposes it. No ruling has adopted it, so it's written as a plan, never as "Azrine is ordained."
The Conduit Trials' final canon name hasn't been chosen.	○ OPEN · TCD-008	The concept and mechanics are current. The name is a working title, and every page that uses it flags it.
The blueprint's chapter 29 credits "Cael Dren" with designing the sacrificial route and First Anchor, while its chapters 38–39 identify twelve-year-old Caelen as the first sacrificed Anchor.	◇ CONFLICT · HC-059	Two passages in one plan disagree. The Companion names both and protects TCD-064's twelve-year-old Caelen without deciding who designed the route.

CLAIM AS PRINTED	STATUS	WHY IT'S LABELED THIS WAY
The 2025-era lore treated the Echo Gate as the singular sealed crossing between Remnia and Somnoria.	~~LEGACY / SUPERSEDED~~ · TCD-027	Past tense, source named. Its seal, spiral or mirrored glyph, and ancient-crossing imagery may come back only as ◌ POSSIBLE.

☐ RESEARCH appears when a scene needs real-world fact the sources can't supply. The clearest current case is the Remy death scene: once the weapon and wound are chosen, the blood-loss timing Melena works against is a research question, not a canon question (TCD-063 leaves weapon and anatomy open).

PAGE FURNITURE YOU'LL SEE THROUGHOUT

- *Source* — lines close each section. They're margin provenance in the manuscript and become small-type margin notes in layout.
- **GUARDRAIL** boxes hold locked constraints a drafter could break without noticing.
- **NOT THE SAME AS** callouts separate paired terms readers merge.
- **OPEN DEVELOPMENT** boxes carry four lines: Fixed / Undecided / Why it matters / Decide by.
- **TANDEM CANON DECISION** blocks appear only where a page genuinely can't proceed.
- **See also** lines point to related sections by number.

Why it matters: the status system is the reason this book can be trusted at 2 a.m. in the middle of a chapter. If a claim has no marker and no qualifying grammar, you're meant to be able to rely on it without checking.

SOURCE *Production Master A3, V6; TCD-008, TCD-027, TCD-034, TCD-058, TCD-063, TCD-064; Audit HC-059, HC-061.*

SEE ALSO Appendix A Canon Decision Log · **p.223** | Appendix E Terminology Register · **p.267**

EXPLAINER · PART I · HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

I.5 KNOWLEDGE STATES

Prevent backward knowledge promotion.

No later revelation travels backward into an earlier head. That sounds obvious until the fourth book is drafted and a character in the first one starts making choices that only make sense if she's read the Canon Decision Log. The Companion prevents that by keeping seven lanes of knowledge apart wherever a secret, identity, reveal, or piece of history is involved.

THE SEVEN LANES

LANE	WHAT IT RECORDS	EXAMPLE OF THE LANE IN USE
Objective truth	What is true in the universe	The gang leader's wound kills Remy (TCD-063).
Author knowledge	What Danyelle has ruled or knows, whether or not anyone on-page does	Katherine and Melena are paternal half-sisters through Tobias (TCD-040), long before either sister proves it.
Reader knowledge	What a reader knows at a specific point in a specific book	Tracked per chapter in each book's knowledge ledger; never assumed from author knowledge.
Character knowledge	What a named character knows, and from when	Melena enters the Challenge Six Duel with substantial suspicion about Katherine and no proof (TCD-050).
Character belief	What a character thinks is true when it's wrong or incomplete	Early Reverie believes she's an illegal, unlicensed Dreamwalker with a rare gift; she's also a natural conduit (TCD-029).
Institutional / public version	What Houses, the Sanctum, the Synod, Skyhold, schools, or governments teach or record	The Sanctum's likely "Dyad" label for Katherine, which is incomplete (TCD-049).
Suppressed / rewritten	What's sealed, censored, misfiled, mythologized, redacted, or lost	House Dren's willing-adult First Anchor mythology versus twelve-year-old Caelen (TCD-064).

The six levels of cross-land knowledge. Knowing another land exists doesn't mean knowing where it is, how its magic works, how to reach it, what its history is, or how the four lands actually relate. TCD-016 separates these into six levels, and none implies another:

1. **Existence** — the land is real.
2. **Location** — where it is.
3. **Functional** — how its people, magic, or institutions work.
4. **Route** — how to get there.
5. **Historical** — what happened between the lands.
6. **True Tandem knowledge** — the objective relationship among all four.

A drafted 3SL example shows why the ladder matters. In chapter 11, Remy jokes that the only place Melena can't reach the blackroot is Somnoria, and Silas hopes she won't ask what Somnoria is. On-page, that establishes that both men know Somnoria by name. It doesn't establish that either knows where it is, how to get there, or anything about dream magic. In chapter 3, Silas reads Melena's fire as proof she's Remnian because "fire belonged to Remnia." That's functional knowledge about one feature of Remnian magic, held as Silas's belief, and it says nothing about what the Synod teaches or what Silas knows of Remnian history.
■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (3SL chs. 3, 11).

Worked example: two clocks for one missing man. Elias Lockwood and Professor Alexander Thorne are one person with two public lives, and the two lives go missing on different schedules.

LANE	ELIAS LOCKWOOD / PROFESSOR ALEXANDER THORNE	STATUS
Objective truth	Elias voluntarily created and maintained Thorne as an established Somnorian researcher and instructor for years. The Nightmare organization targets Thorne's boundary/Network research and exploits the vulnerability it creates, compromising his dream and magical functioning so that ordinary return to Remnia becomes unsafe or impossible.	● CANON TCD-032, TCD-062
Author knowledge	The failure-to-return cause is fixed. The exact compromise technique, first crossing, alias credentials, helpers, later captivity, and physical status are not.	○ OPEN
Institutional / public version, Remnia	Remnia notices Elias missing first, because he fails to return on pattern.	● CANON TCD-062

LANE	ELIAS LOCKWOOD / PROFESSOR ALEXANDER THORNE	STATUS
Institutional / public version, Somnoria	Thorne initially remains publicly present but deteriorating; his Somnorian disappearance comes later.	● **CANON** TCD-062
Character belief	Breakdown rumors circulate in Somnoria. They reflect a real, patterned compromise, not the whole truth.	● **CANON** TCD-062
Character knowledge	Reverie encounters Thorne's collapsing dream. Whether and when she learns Thorne is Elias isn't established here.	Encounter ● **CANON** TCD-062; identity knowledge ○ **OPEN**
Reader knowledge	Set chapter by chapter in the ADST and FTE knowledge ledgers (V.16†, IV.22).	Tracked, not assumed

Why it matters: the two clocks are the whole trick of this plotline. Remnia is already searching while Somnoria still sees Thorne teaching. Collapse the lanes and one country reacts to news it hasn't received.

GUARDRAIL

In-world language survives as perspective, never as cosmology. A Somnorian calling Remnia "another world" is Somnorian framing (TCD-015). House Aether calling the Prism a "cage" is House Aether's interpretation (TCD-038). Caelum calling Melena his "asset" is Caelum's framing (TCD-043).

SOURCE *TCD-015, TCD-016, TCD-029, TCD-032, TCD-038, TCD-040, TCD-043, TCD-049, TCD-050, TCD-062, TCD-063, TCD-064; Production Master A5; 3SL draft chs. 3, 11.*

SEE ALSO II.4 Knowledge of the Other Lands · **p.29**

VII.5 Cross-Land Knowledge Matrix → FTE concordance · **p.216**

VII.10 Continuity Translation Pages → FTE concordance · **p.216**

PROTOCOL · PART I · HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

I.6 OPEN CANON, DECISIONS, AND UPDATES

Show how open material is displayed and how rulings enter the book.

Open stays open. The Companion doesn't close a question because a page looks unfinished with it, and it doesn't ask for a ruling just because the book reached that topic. It asks only when a page, a scene, or a publication-level commitment can't be written accurately without an answer.

The OPEN DEVELOPMENT box. Wherever an open point sits beside settled canon, it gets a four-line box. Here's a live one, reproduced from Part II:

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE REMNIA–UNDERSIDE CROSSING · ○ OPEN

FIXED	UNDECIDED
A current crossing exists near the London Town edge, in the no-man's-land associated with London Town, Old Prosperity, and Alea. It's physical-magical transit, not a portal. The singular Echo Gate is Legacy. (TCD-017, TCD-027)	Its precise map coordinate, and whether it arrives directly in Shadowmere, Tier 7.
WHY IT MATTERS	**DECIDE BY**
Arrival tier decides who controls the Underside end, who can trace a crossing, and how Melena's route from Remnia into Shadowmere reads on-page.	When Danyelle's Remnia map is reviewed, or earlier if a 3SL scene has to show the arrival point.

The "Decide by" line is the useful one. It names the actual drafting moment that forces the answer. If nothing forces it, the line says "safe to defer," and that's a complete answer.

The TANDEM CANON DECISION block. When a page truly can't proceed, the Companion uses this format and nothing looser: the exact issue, the sources creating it, options A through D where the evidence offers them, E for "Something else / I want to explain," one line of implication under each option, and a labeled recommendation only when the evidence strongly favors one path. No more than five at once; one to three is better. A recommendation is never canon until ruled.

TANDEM CANON DECISION — SPECIMEN (FORMAT ONLY; NOT ASKED NOW)

Issue: Who designed First Shellward's sacrificial route and First Anchor?

Sources: July 2026 TSWK blueprint ch. 29 ("Cael Dren" as designer) versus chs. 38–39 (twelve-year-old Caelen as first sacrificed Anchor); TCD-064.

A. Forged credit. House record credits a figure who didn't design it. *Implication:* the tablet becomes evidence of rewritten history.

B. Distinct adult designer. Cael Dren and Caelen are different people. *Implication:* two names need separate provenance.

C. Drafting error. The blueprint conflated names. *Implication:* one passage is corrected; no in-world lie.

E. Something else / I want to explain.

Recommendation: None. The evidence doesn't strongly favor one option, and HC-059 is deferred to the TSWK draft.

How a ruling enters the book. When a new ruling lands or drafted prose deliberately changes something:

1. Log it in the Canon Decision Log with its date, what it supersedes, and its downstream implications.
2. Update the High-Impact Conflict Register if it resolves or opens a conflict.
3. Update every Companion page listed in the ruling's affected-sections field.
4. Move superseded claims to the Legacy Recovery Index rather than deleting them.
5. Re-run the integrity checks on every touched page: no Legacy claim presented as canon, no ◌ POSSIBLE or ◩ SUPPORTED claim in declarative story-world tense, no conflict silently harmonized, no knowledge promoted backward, no symmetry assumed across the four lands, no duplicate or contradictory table, no invented canon, no open question phrased as settled, no TKC content imported.

GUARDRAIL

Asking a question assigns no TCD number. The audit's proposed TCD-065 through TCD-074 were never answered or adopted, so none of them is canon and none of those numbers is reserved.

I.6 · OPEN CANON, DECISIONS, AND UPDATES

CONTINUED

Why it matters: an open question that's clearly marked is safe to draft around. An open question that's been quietly answered by whoever wrote the page last is how three versions of the same backstory end up in print.

SOURCE *Production Master A8–A10, A12; Audit, Architecture Handoff; TCD-017, TCD-027, TCD-064; Audit HC-059.*

SEE ALSO VII.12 Open Canon Queue → FTE concordance · **p.216**

Appendix A Canon Decision Log · **p.223** | Appendix B High-Impact Conflict Register · **p.251**

CHECKLIST · PART I · HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

I.7 USING THE COMPANION WHILE DRAFTING

Make the book fast to use mid-scene.

Start with the book's draft-forward packet, not the front of the Companion. Each dossier ends with pages built to sit open beside the manuscript: III.19† for 3SL, IV.24 for FTE, V.17† for ADST, VI.13† for TSWK. They condense the locked beats, the current knowledge states, and the scene-level open choices, and they cross-reference the full sections behind them.

BEFORE A SCENE

- [ ] Check the packet for any GUARDRAIL that touches the characters or magic in the scene.
- [ ] Check the knowledge ledger for what each POV character knows *at this chapter*, not at the end of the book.
- [ ] Check whether the scene touches a ● CANON ruling. If it does, the outcome is fixed and the scene's job is to earn it.
- [ ] Check whether the scene touches an ○ OPEN item. If the open item doesn't affect this scene, keep drafting.

WHILE DRAFTING

- An open question that doesn't touch the next scene doesn't stop the next scene.
- If the scene needs an answer to an open item, make the choice in prose and flag it. You don't need a ruling first; you need a record afterward.
- If the scene seems to need something that contradicts a ruling, stop. That's the one case where the draft waits.
- Don't pull a fact from a Legacy file to fill a gap, however well it fits. Check the Legacy Recovery Index; if the idea is listed there as recoverable, it comes back as ◌ POSSIBLE and gets ruled on like anything new.

AFTER THE SCENE

- [ ] If the prose settled an open item on purpose, log it through the update protocol (I.6).
- [ ] If the prose changed a knowledge state, update the book's knowledge ledger.
- [ ] If the prose introduced a new name, place, route, or rule, add it to the relevant dossier with its chapter as provenance.

Navigation conventions. Sections are numbered Part.section (III.8†, VII.5), so insertions don't renumber the book. "See also" lines at each section's foot point outward. Rulings are cited by TCD number, conflicts by HC number, and manuscript facts by book and chapter.

Why it matters: the Companion should cost you seconds mid-scene, not an evening. If using it slows drafting down more than it protects the draft, the page is built wrong, and that's a Companion problem to fix.

SOURCE *Production Master I.7, A8; Audit, Architecture Handoff.*

SEE ALSO III.19 3SL Draft-Forward Packet † | IV.24 FTE Endgame Packet · **p.187**

V.17 ADST Climax Packet † | VI.13 TSWK Blueprint-to-Rulings Reconciliation Packet †

PART II · BUILD 2

II THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

This is what holds across all four books before any single story gets its own dossier. Nearly all of it comes straight from author rulings, which is why it can be written with confidence now. Its open slots are mostly cartographic and deep-historical: the Companion knows how the lands relate and how the ancient break worked in outline, and it doesn't yet know coastlines, dates, or the rupture's actual cause.

§	SECTION	PAGE TYPE	PAGE
II.2	Macro Geography	SCHEMATIC	27
II.4	Knowledge of the Other Lands	EXPLAINER · LADDER	29
II.5	Shared Magical Ancestry	EXPLAINER · TABLE	32
II.6	Crossblood: A Label, Not a Biology	EXPLAINER · NOT THE SAME AS	35
II.13	The Shattered Veil and Its Descendants	COMPARISON · VARIANT TEXTS	37
II.14	The Elders' Prayer	EXPLAINER · CAN/CANNOT	42
II.15	Recurring Institutional Misreadings	MISREADING TABLE	45
II.16	Shared Chronology	TIMELINE	47

This volume prints the Part II sections FTE stands on. II.1, II.3, and II.7–II.12 are in the full Tandem Companion.

GUARDRAIL

No symmetry assumed across the four lands.

SCHEMATIC · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

II.2 MACRO GEOGRAPHY

Place the lands relative to each other without inventing cartography.

The four lands occupy multiple major landmasses and regions in one world. ● CANON TCD-025. Four placements are fixed:

- **Remnia and Somnoria** are separate continental landmasses with ocean between them.
- **The Underside** attaches to the Zenithia side, or corner, of Remnia's broader geography and descends from there. ● CANON TCD-025, TCD-026
- **Thalara**, primarily underwater, lies farther outward in the island and sea region.
- **Relative position** is described by a Spain / France / Italy / Greek-islands comparison. That comparison controls relative placement only.

GUARDRAIL

What the analogy does not mean.

It doesn't import real borders, coastlines, scale, distances, climate, culture, languages, or history. It doesn't make any land a disguised version of a real country. It doesn't settle which way anything faces on a map. It tells you roughly where the lands sit in relation to one another, and nothing more.

The Underside's placement deserves its own sentence because it's the easiest to get wrong. It isn't a buried continent lying flat beneath Remnia. It's a vertically tiered nation that begins at or near the surface off Zenithia's side and descends. Its top tiers, Crownlight and Dawnveil, are above ground; by Ironcross the descent is fully subterranean. ● CANON TCD-026. Part III builds the full cross-section.

Schematic, not a map. Until Danyelle's canonical Remnia map is reviewed, the Companion uses a relative-position schematic: two continental masses separated by ocean, the Underside marked as a descending column off one side of Remnia near Zenithia, and Thalara marked as a sea region farther out with its territory below the surface. The schematic carries no coastlines, scale bar, compass rose, or place names beyond these.

SCHEMATIC · PLACEHOLDER

Relative-position schematic pending review of Danyelle's canonical Remnia map.
No coastlines, scale, compass, or place names are drawn in this volume.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · MACRO CARTOGRAPHY · ○ OPEN

FIXED
One world; the four placements above; the Underside's vertical attachment off Zenithia's side (TCD-015, TCD-025, TCD-026).

UNDECIDED
Coastlines, names of landmasses and oceans, scale, distances, islands, and borders. Zenithia's exact political classification is confirmed against the Remnian province index in Part IV rather than assumed here.

WHY IT MATTERS
Distance sets travel time, and travel time sets how long news takes to cross (VII.2).

DECIDE BY
Remnia layer when the Remnia map is reviewed; other layers safe to defer until a scene needs a distance.

Why it matters: geography is where cross-book continuity breaks quietly. A character who reaches Somnoria "by nightfall" has just committed the Companion to a distance, whether anyone meant to.

SOURCE *TCD-015, TCD-025, TCD-026. Record: Tandem Macro Geography Map (schematic stage).*

SEE ALSO III.3 The Underside: A Vertical Nation → FTE concordance · **p.216**

IV.2 Remnia at a Glance · **p.54** VI.2 Thalara at a Glance †

EXPLAINER · LADDER · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

II.4 KNOWLEDGE OF THE OTHER LANDS

Kill universal-awareness shortcuts.

There's no universal answer to "do people know about the other lands?" Awareness varies by nation, class, institution, profession, network, person, and time. ● CANON TCD-016. A smuggler, a Sanctum archivist, and a miner's kid in the same land can hold three different pictures, and all three can change between chapter 5 and chapter 25.

The six levels from I.5 do the sorting: existence, location, functional, route, historical, and true Tandem knowledge. None implies another. Someone can know Somnoria's name and nothing about where it is. Someone can use a route without knowing what's on the far side of the boundary it crosses. Someone can know a land's history as their own institution teaches it, which may be the least reliable version available.

Four kinds of source feed a character's picture, and the Companion tracks them separately: what their institution teaches or officially claims, what their network passes around as rumor or trade knowledge, what's been suppressed or rewritten, and what they've learned firsthand. An error counts as knowledge for drafting purposes. A character acts on what she believes, and the Companion records the belief with its lane label.

What the drafted pages already establish. These are seed entries for the full matrix in VII.5. Every row is dated to its chapter; none is a claim about what the character's whole society knows.

CHARACTER	CHAPTER	KNOWLEDGE ON-PAGE	LEVEL	STATUS
Silas Graves	3SL ch. 3	Reads Melena's fire as proof she's Remnian; believes nobody born in the Underside carries fire	Functional (as belief)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Silas Graves	3SL ch. 11	Knows Somnoria by name; hopes Melena won't ask what it is	Existence	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT

CHARACTER	CHAPTER	KNOWLEDGE ON-PAGE	LEVEL	STATUS
Remy	3SL ch. 11	Names Somnoria in a joke about distance	Existence; the joke implies he thinks it's far	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Dante Mercer	3SL ch. 3	Knows Melena is Remnia's Imperial Princess and Lucia's daughter; expects Remnia to treat her discovery as an act of war	Functional (Remnian politics); historical (personal, through Lucia)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Mother Rae (Maven Renae Vellum)	3SL chs. 3, 11	Knew Lucia; Lucia's final letter gave Melena Rae's name and a route phrase that should've been dead twenty years	Route (at least one route phrase)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Caelum	Series-level	Deep access to Nightmare-adjacent information, people, routes, and markets across lands	Varies by domain; not omniscient	● CANON TCD-031
Elias Lockwood	Series-level	Knows both Remnia and Somnoria from inside, having lived as Professor Alexander Thorne for years	Location, route, functional (personal)	● CANON TCD-032

GUARDRAIL

One character's knowledge never becomes their land's knowledge. Dante knowing Remnian politics says nothing about what the Synod teaches, and the Synod's teaching says nothing about what Gutterlight knows.

Why it matters: cross-land knowledge is the series' pressure valve. When isolation holds, each book can stay intimate and local. When knowledge starts leaking, the leak itself is plot, and it only reads as plot if the Companion knows exactly who knew what before.

SOURCE *TCD-016, TCD-031, TCD-032; 3SL draft chs. 3, 11. Record: Knowledge of the Other Lands Matrix (seeded).*

II.4 · KNOWLEDGE OF THE OTHER LANDS

CONTINUED

SEE ALSO I.5 Knowledge States · **p.18**

VII.2 Event Chronology vs Information Chronology → FTE concordance · **p.216**

VII.5 Cross-Land Knowledge Matrix → FTE concordance · **p.216**

EXPLAINER · TABLE · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

II.5 SHARED MAGICAL ANCESTRY

Explain shared deep origin without making magics interchangeable.

All four modern magical traditions ultimately draw from one primordial magical source or substrate that predates the modern division of the Tandem world. ● CANON TCD-035. The Divide didn't create four unrelated magics. Geography, environment, bodies, bloodlines, culture, survival, history, and institutions reshaped one shared power into systems that are now genuinely distinct, with their own access, costs, classifications, and cultural explanations.

Both halves of that ruling carry weight. The shared root means cross-land resonance is possible without anyone inventing a coincidence. The genuine distinctness means a Somnorian dream technique doesn't work in Remnia just because both descend from the same source, and a Thalaran seal cadence isn't a Silencecraft seal with a different accent. Long isolation after the Divide accelerated the specialization. ● CANON TCD-045

THE FOUR MODERN BRANCHES

LAND	MODERN BRANCH	KNOWN PRACTICES AND TERMS	WHO CLASSIFIES IT	FALSE EQUIVALENCE TO AVOID
The Underside	Life, death, grief, and memory magic, formally organized as the Six Disciplines	Thanomancy, Lamentcraft, Silencecraft, Underchant Cant, Funereal Engineering, Mycelial Memory (◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL, *3SL Full Worldbuilding*). On-page: Silencecraft and Silence seals, Quietcasters, Shrouds, funeral and grief thread, Hush, Underchant markings (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, 3SL chs. 1–12). **Graveshand** is inherited Graves-family magic outside the Six Disciplines. ● CANON TCD-004	The Synod regulates and enforces (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)	Graveshand is not a seventh Discipline.

LAND	MODERN BRANCH	KNOWN PRACTICES AND TERMS	WHO CLASSIFIES IT	FALSE EQUIVALENCE TO AVOID
Remnia	Elemental magic	Fire and Frost confirmed on-page; the full elemental roster is confirmed against *FTE Elemental Factions* in Part IV. Modern Dyads exist; Zephyr is a genuine Fire/Frost Dyad. ● CANON TCD-049	The Sanctum, within its semi-autonomous magical-regulation domain. ● CANON TCD-041	Katherine is not Zephyr's kind of Dyad (TCD-049, TCD-058).
Somnoria	Dream magic	Dreamwalking, licensing, Remote Viewing, natural conduits, the Dream Network. ● CANON TCD-029	The Dream Master's Guild regulates professional dream practice. ● CANON TCD-021	Somnoria's Network uses of the Oneiros Prism are not the Prism's original purpose (TCD-019).
Thalara	Seamwork and the Seal Song	The Seal Song works through breath and resonance; its components include the Breathline, the Anchor Verse, and the Seal Cadence; Sealhands and Seamworkers operate it (◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL, *Thalara Worldbuilding*)	Skyhold controls the sanctioned version and censors others (◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL)	The Seal Song is not the Drowned Canticle (TCD-028). Dren compatibility is not Leviathan identity (TCD-064).

NOT THE SAME AS

repeated nouns across branches.

Several words recur across the four magics, and none of them proves a shared mechanism. "Tether" names Silas and Isola's involuntary bond, the death tethers the Pit Wardens search for, and the tether-lines Silencecraft's Severing cuts. "Anchor" names Thalara's Anchor Verse, House Dren's Anchor program, and the ADST organization's living conduit/anchor configuration. "Severing" in the Silencecraft section of the worldbuilding and Graveshand Severance in 3SL are separate things until a source joins them. Each term is defined inside its own branch.

Resemblance isn't inheritance. The Underside treats memory as currency and names as anchors; Thalara's sea began holding memory after the Drowning, and shells hold impressions. The rhyme is real on the page. It isn't evidence of a shared mechanism, a shared origin event, or a transfer between lands. ● CANON Production Master A6

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE PRIMORDIAL LAYER · ○ OPEN

FIXED	UNDECIDED
One shared substrate; four genuinely distinct modern branches; isolation after the Divide accelerated specialization (TCD-035, TCD-045).	What the substrate was, how it was used before the Divide, the mechanism of divergence, which old principles survive in which branch, how branches interact when they meet, and which culture's theory of magic is most historically accurate.
WHY IT MATTERS	**DECIDE BY**
Katherine's ancestral reversion (TCD-049) and every future cross-branch encounter lean on this layer.	Safe to defer until a scene has to explain a cross-branch interaction rather than just show one.

Why it matters: shared ancestry gives the series its deep logic, and false equivalence is the fastest way to ruin it. When two lands' magics meet on-page, the scene should feel like two dialects of a lost language, mutually strange, not two brands of the same tool.

SOURCE *TCD-004, TCD-019, TCD-021, TCD-028, TCD-029, TCD-035, TCD-041, TCD-045, TCD-049, TCD-058, TCD-064;* 3SL Full Worldbuilding *(Six Disciplines);* Thalara Worldbuilding *(Seal Song structure); 3SL draft chs. 1–12. Record: Tandem Magic Ancestry Map.*

SEE ALSO II.6 Crossblood: A Label, Not a Biology · **p.35** | III.7 The Six Disciplines † | III.8 Graveshand, Deathwork, and Severance † | IV.5 Elemental Magic · **p.65** | V.4 Dream Magic and the Dream Network † | VI.3 The Seal Song and the Drowned Canticle †

EXPLAINER · NOT THE SAME AS · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

II.6 CROSSBLOOD: A LABEL, NOT A BIOLOGY

Stop one institutional theory from becoming taxonomy.

"Crossblood" is an institutional, scholarly, political, or historical label for people believed to carry inheritance associated with more than one separated Tandem tradition. It isn't an objectively correct universal biological category. ● CANON TCD-036. Institutions may define it differently through incomplete theory, bloodline politics, fear, or propaganda, and the label never establishes what a person's magic objectively is.

The older two-world lore treated Crossbloods as a settled pre-fracture biology and offered a candidate list that grouped Katherine, Cassius, and Zephyr. That list is ~~LEGACY / SUPERSEDED~~. Its three names don't share an anomaly: the rulings now explain Katherine and Zephyr in incompatible ways, and nothing established about Cassius puts him in either of their categories.

NOT THE SAME AS

Rare, ancient, hybrid, inherited, or anomalous magic is not Crossblood magic. "Crossblood" is a claim someone makes about a person. Whether it's true is a separate question, answered case by case.

Case table. Every row stays unclassified until a case earns evidence. The "what's actually established" column shows why each person needs individual review instead of a shared label.

PERSON	WHAT'S ACTUALLY ESTABLISHED ABOUT THEIR MAGIC	CROSSBLOOD STATUS
Katherine Nicholas	Ancestral reversion to a less-specialized earlier Remnian elemental inheritance; Frost-dominant, with Fire as a rerouted alternative expression. ● CANON TCD-049, TCD-058	○ OPEN · no case evidence; her ruled anatomy is a Remnian ancestral inheritance
Zephyr	A genuine modern Fire/Frost Dyad. ● CANON TCD-049	○ OPEN · no case evidence
Cassius Aether	House Aether heir; his Labyrinth scar regulates bond synchronization. ● CANON TCD-030	○ OPEN · no case evidence
Reverie Hollow	Dreamwalker, natural dream conduit, and Remote Viewer. ● CANON TCD-029	○ OPEN · no case evidence

PERSON	WHAT'S ACTUALLY ESTABLISHED ABOUT THEIR MAGIC	CROSSBLOOD STATUS
Silas Graves	Graveshand: inherited Graves-family magic outside the Six Disciplines. ● CANON TCD-004	○ OPEN · no case evidence
Levi (Leviathan Caelis Dren)	Fully human; inherited Dren compatibility with seal infrastructure. ● CANON TCD-064	○ OPEN · no case evidence

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · CROSSBLOOD AS AN INSTITUTION · ○ OPEN

FIXED
It's a contested label, not biology; the legacy candidate list doesn't control (TCD-036).

UNDECIDED
Which institutions use the term, how each defines it, what legal or social consequences follow, what each land calls the idea, and whether any real case ever fits.

WHY IT MATTERS
A label with consequences is a plot engine. Someone called Crossblood by the Sanctum faces different stakes than someone called Crossblood by a Somnorian scholar.

DECIDE BY
The first scene in which an institution applies the label to a named character.

Why it matters: a catch-all label is seductive because it explains everything unusual at once. That's exactly what makes it dangerous in a series built on distinct magics. The Companion lets characters and institutions use the word. It doesn't let the narration believe them.

SOURCE *TCD-004, TCD-029, TCD-030, TCD-036, TCD-049, TCD-058, TCD-064; Audit inventory note on* Full Tandem Lore Document\. *Record: Crossblood Classification Record.*\

SEE ALSO II.5 Shared Magical Ancestry · p.32

II.15 Recurring Institutional Misreadings · p.45

IV.10 Katherine's Elemental Anatomy · p.83

II.13 THE SHATTERED VEIL AND ITS DESCENDANTS

Separate author-level text from in-world textual history.

A complete *Prophecy of the Shattered Veil* exists at the author and universe level. ● CANON TCD-006. No intact, authoritative master copy of it is presently known in-world. ● CANON TCD-047. What the four lands have instead are four divergent historical descendants: Remnia's *Breathbound Law*, Somnoria's *Dreamwalker's Writ*, the Underside's *Mourning Verse*, and Thalara's *Drowned Canticle*. They aren't four physical pieces of one document. Nobody can assemble the prophecy by collecting them.

What characters can do is reconstruct. Comparing the variants against historical, magical, material, and testimonial evidence can recover wording, underlying truth, or both. No national version is presumed untouched. ● CANON TCD-047

The author-level text. Reproduced exactly from *The Poems*. This is universe canon. It isn't in any character's hands.

```text
The Prophecy of the Shattered Veil

Before the stars were taught to burn,

Before the tide was told to turn,

A voice was born in blood and breath—

A crown was forged, a vow to Death.

The Order rose with chains of grace,

To bind the world in rightful place.

But power kept is power sown,

And rot will bloom in gardens grown.

They danced beneath a gilded stage,

Their laughter hiding quiet rage.
```

They begged the flame to make things right,

Then fed it truth and turned from light.

They whispered wrongs they dared not speak,

And carved their grief into the weak.

They rose with crowns not earned but given—

A curse beneath their blood was written.

A dream unspooled across the sky,

A mirror cracked, a perfect lie.

A fate once fractured found its thread,

But stitched its hope through knots of dread.

These hollowed walls, now wrapped in mold,

Remember what they can't behold.

And from the ashes, sharp and bare—

The truth still waits, but never fair.

Four truths were cast to four-born lands,

Each gripped by time's decaying hands.

One held the storm with breath and bone—

Their names were laws, their heirs were known.

One broke the night to mine their dreams,

And built their gods from shattered schemes.

One walked where waves devoured the past,

With songs too cursed to ever last.

One slept beneath the smoking stone,

And taught the dead to die alone.

Four branches bent by shadow's thread,

Each blind to how the roots had bled.

When time unravels spine from soul,

When suns go dark and rivers toll,

When every oath is stripped of name,

And kin bear crowns they cannot claim—

The veil will split. The mask will fall.

No land will thrive. No voice will call.

But in the ruin, cracked and cold,

A single page remains to hold.

Not war, nor flame, nor faith will win—

But what was lost remembered in.

And those who rise with open eyes

Will curse the stars—and still survive.

```

*(In the source file, "remembered" in the final stanza is italicized.)*

**Four witnesses.** The comparison below describes each text as a document. It doesn't claim what any line means in the story world.

| | *THE BREATHBOUND LAW* (REMNIA) | *THE DREAMWALKER'S WRIT* (SOMNORIA) | *THE MOURNING VERSE* (UNDERSIDE) | *THE DROWNED CANTICLE* (THALARA) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **In-text attribution** | "From the Imperial Collection: Verse III – Author Unknown" | "Excerpted from the Somnorian Council of Abstract Futures, Archive 9.61A" | "Passed from Keeper to Keeper. Never written down." | "Collected by the Shellkeepers of Thalara." |
```

	THE BREATHBOUND LAW (REMNIA)	*THE DREAMWALKER'S WRIT* (SOMNORIA)	*THE MOURNING VERSE* (UNDERSIDE)	*THE DROWNED CANTICLE* (THALARA)
Relation to the master's wording	Keeps the first stanza and "The Order rose..." couplet, then departs	Almost entirely different wording; shares motifs, not lines	Closest to the master; nearly line-for-line	Different wording throughout; shares motifs
Notable additions	"And power kept by blood alone / Shall guard the heart of every throne"; a traitor's rage; closes on keeping the flame	"There were four— there are four— / There may be none, or maybe more"; "Time is spiral, not a line"	None identified	Directional lines (north, east, south, west, the deep); "The sea will keep what stars would hide"
Notable omissions	The four-lands section and the veil-splitting ending	The master's structure as a whole	The "mirror cracked" couplet and "found its thread" couplet, compressed into "A fate once fractured born from lies"	The master's structure as a whole
Custody form	Imperial written collection	Institutional archive	Oral, keeper to keeper	Collected by Shellkeepers
Who knows it, when	○ OPEN · tracked in VII.8	○ OPEN	○ OPEN	○ OPEN

The Drowned Canticle is Thalara's Shattered Veil descendant, and it survives within or alongside the broader Seal Song tradition as a historical and prophetic strand. It isn't the whole Seal Song. ● CANON TCD-028

GUARDRAIL

Readings are not rulings.

The master's four "one..." couplets invite an obvious land-by-land mapping. No ruling confirms it; treat any mapping as ◌ POSSIBLE. The Canticle's north/east/south/west lines are not cartography and don't set any land's compass position (II.2). "The Order" in the master text isn't identified with any institution in any book. Nothing in these texts may be paraphrased into new verse and presented as canon.

II.13 · THE SHATTERED VEIL AND ITS DESCENDANTS CONTINUED

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · RECONSTRUCTION · ○ OPEN

FIXED
Complete author-level text; no known intact in-world master; four divergent descendants; reconstruction by comparison plus evidence (TCD-006, TCD-047).

UNDECIDED
Each text's provenance chain; who first suspects a shared origin; who attempts reconstruction; what evidence thresholds recover wording versus truth; whether exact wording is recoverable at all; how reliable the prophecy is.

WHY IT MATTERS
The moment a character lines up two versions and notices the same first stanza, the series has changed. That moment needs a date, a person, and a reason.

DECIDE BY
Overdue in part. FTE Beta ch. 19 already sets the Breathbound Law beside an unmarked text carrying Writ lines, and Katherine registers the resemblance before dismissing it (IV.7). Decide that text's provenance before ch. 19 is next revised; the rest before any character compares versions deliberately.

SOURCE *TCD-006, TCD-028, TCD-046, TCD-047;* The Poems *(all five texts and attributions). Record: Shattered Veil Reconstruction Dossier (workspace in VII.8).*

SEE ALSO IV.7 The Challenges · **p.72** | VI.3 The Seal Song and the Drowned Canticle † | VII.8 Shattered Veil Reconstruction Workspace → FTE concordance · **p.216**

EXPLAINER · CAN/CANNOT · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

II.14 THE ELDERS' PRAYER

Define one inherited working across cultures.

The Elders' Prayer is one inherited magical working that survives in more than one culture under different language and ritual expression. ● CANON TCD-023. Its objective function is specific: it restores a living person's viable magical and life pattern when that pattern has been severed, corrupted, or catastrophically dysregulated. ● CANON TCD-057. Restored magical continuity can stabilize secondary bodily functions and call someone back from active dying, as long as a viable living pattern remains.

It has hard edges. It can't resurrect completed death. It can't regenerate destroyed anatomy. ● CANON TCD-057

WHAT THE PRAYER CAN AND CAN'T DO

CAN	CAN'T
Restore a viable living magical/life pattern that's been severed, corrupted, or catastrophically dysregulated	Resurrect someone whose death is complete
Stabilize secondary bodily functions when magical disruption is causal	Regenerate destroyed anatomy. Isola's leg remains ruined despite life-saving stabilization.
Call someone back from active dying while a viable pattern remains	Redistribute a burden automatically and universally from one person to another
Work through different cultural presentations with the same objective function	Serve as a Frost-only ritual

Two performances, about two years apart. Selah and Katherine perform the same inherited working independently, roughly two years apart. ● CANON TCD-048

	SELAH WRAITHMOOR	KATHERINE NICHOLAS
Book	3SL	FTE
Recipients	Silas and Isola	Atlas
Cultural form	Underside presentation	Remnian presentation

	SELAH WRAITHMOOR	KATHERINE NICHOLAS
Ruled outcome	Silas's returning breath and pulse is recovery of living function, not resurrection. Isola's leg stays ruined.	Effects on Atlas, and on Melena, remain open.
Drafting state	Performance record confirmed against the 3SL draft in III.16	Undrafted in the controlling generation; a rewrite-required candidate exists in Chapter 29.docx (IV.17)
Governing rulings	● CANON TCD-048, TCD-057	● CANON TCD-009, TCD-048, TCD-057

GUARDRAIL

No echo.

Selah's act leaves no specific echo, reservoir, transmitted route, or power that Katherine later accesses. The two performances are connected by shared magical ancestry and ritual tradition, not by causation. Katherine doesn't need to know Selah exists, or that the Prayer has an Underside form, or its history. (TCD-023, TCD-048)

NOT THE SAME AS

Selah's cold, which the 3SL draft shows fogging metal and spreading frost across a table (chs. 2, 6, 12), isn't evidence that the Prayer is a Frost working or that Selah and Katherine share an elemental affinity. The Frost-only reading of the ritual is superseded (TCD-057). Similar imagery isn't evidence.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE PRAYER'S MECHANICS · ○ OPEN

FIXED

Objective function; the death boundary; the anatomy boundary; two independent performances; no direct causation (TCD-023, TCD-048, TCD-057).

UNDECIDED

Eligibility; what serves as the original-pattern reference; whether a bond or physical contact is required; the exact death threshold; the caster's cost; the transmission history; whether and how the working survives in Somnoria and Thalara; who recognizes it across cultures.

WHY IT MATTERS

Katherine's performance for Atlas has to obey the same limits Selah's did. If Atlas's injury has already destroyed anatomy, the Prayer can stabilize him but can't make him whole.

DECIDE BY

Before the FTE endgame drafts Katherine's performance; caster cost before either performance is revised.

II.14 · THE ELDERS' PRAYER

CONTINUED

SOURCE *TCD-009, TCD-023, TCD-048, TCD-057; 3SL draft chs. 2, 6, 12 (Selah's cold). Record: Elders' Prayer Transmission + Variant / Functional Anatomy Record (registry in VII.7).*

SEE ALSO III.16 Selah and the Elders' Prayer in 3SL → FTE concordance · **p.216**

IV.17 The Elders' Prayer in FTE · **p.166**

VII.7 Repeated Working and Ritual Registry → FTE concordance · **p.216**

MISREADING TABLE · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

RECURRING INSTITUTIONAL MISREADINGS

II.15

Collect the ruled cases where an institution's label diverges from objective truth, so the pattern is visible.

Across all four books, institutions and powerful people keep naming things they don't fully understand, and the names outlive the misunderstanding. The rulings have already caught enough of these that the pattern deserves its own page. Each row below is a case where a label circulating in-world diverges from objective truth.

CLAIM IN CIRCULATION	WHO HOLDS IT	OBJECTIVE TRUTH	RULING
Katherine is a Dyad.	The Sanctum (likely)	One less-specialized ancestral Remnian capacity, Frost-dominant, with Fire as a rerouted alternative expression. Not Zephyr's kind of Dyad.	TCD-049, TCD-058
The House Aether piece is the original, whole Oneiros Prism.	House Aether; some records	One significant surviving piece of a fragmented artifact	TCD-018
The Prism is Nightmare's cage.	House Aether	The entity exists beyond or behind a boundary the Prism helps maintain; it isn't inside the artifact	TCD-038
The Prism is dream infrastructure.	Somnorian working knowledge	Accurate within scope, but a later application of a cross-land boundary artifact	TCD-019
Crossblood is a biological category.	Institutions and scholars	A contested label, not proven biology	TCD-036
The First Anchor was a willing adult.	House Dren mythology	The first currently established Anchor, Caelen, was twelve	TCD-064
The fragment belongs to House Dren.	Caelus	A claim, not automatic objective truth	TCD-039
The Drowning was one clean event that came without warning.	Skyhold's official curriculum	A staged regional catastrophe shaped by instability and political decisions	TCD-055; *Thalara Worldbuilding*

II.15 · RECURRING INSTITUTIONAL MISREADINGS

CONTINUED

CLAIM IN CIRCULATION	WHO HOLDS IT	OBJECTIVE TRUTH	RULING
The Leviathan is a symbol.	Skyhold's official curriculum	A living pressure entity bound into seal infrastructure	TCD-037, TCD-055
Melena is Caelum's asset.	Caelum	A transactional alliance with coercive leverage on both sides	TCD-043
The other lands are other worlds or realms.	Isolated cultures	One physical world; separate nations and territories	TCD-015

Why the pattern matters for drafting: an institutional misreading is a knowledge state with a budget and an enforcement arm. The Sanctum doesn't just believe Katherine is a Dyad; it tests, files, and treats her as one. When the truth surfaces, the scene isn't only a revelation. It's an institution discovering that its own paperwork was wrong, and deciding what to do about the people who saw.

GUARDRAIL

Characters and institutions may use these labels freely in dialogue, documents, and POV narration filtered through them. The Companion's own narration never adopts them.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · WHY EACH INSTITUTION HOLDS ITS VERSION · ○ OPEN

FIXED
The objective truth in every row.

UNDECIDED
Motive, where unruled: whether each misreading is honest error, convenient simplification, or deliberate suppression.

WHY IT MATTERS
An honest error gets corrected when evidence arrives. A deliberate one gets defended.

DECIDE BY
Before each institution's misreading is challenged on-page.

SOURCE *TCD-015, TCD-018, TCD-019, TCD-036, TCD-037, TCD-038, TCD-039, TCD-043, TCD-049, TCD-055, TCD-058, TCD-064;* Thalara Worldbuilding *(official record)*.

SEE ALSO I.5 Knowledge States · **p.18**

VII.10 Continuity Translation Pages → FTE concordance · **p.216**

TIMELINE · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

II.16 SHARED CHRONOLOGY

Place the books in time without chapter lockstep.

The books are placed in time by macro windows, not by chapter lockstep. ● CANON TCD-013. 3SL happens about two years before the main concurrent period. ADST begins when Elias goes missing, and FTE begins a couple of weeks later. The two then run largely concurrently and end around the same time, without requiring their chapters to line up one for one.

TSWK and the next Shadowmere installment form the next concurrent window. They begin directly after FTE and ADST, with no meaningful gap of months or years; a few days or small weeks for logistics are fine. They overlap each other substantially without needing identical opening dates. ● CANON TCD-014, TCD-024, TCD-054. The handoff is rolling: conditions for the later plots may already be active during late FTE and ADST, and still-later stories may begin activating before the prior pair fully resolves.

Four bands per book. Every book is tracked by four separate dates, because "when does it happen?" has four answers.

BOOK	BACKGROUND ACTIVATION	NARRATIVE OPENING	CLIMAX	RESOLUTION
3SL	○ OPEN	About two years before the FTE/ADST window; exact date ○ OPEN	Remy's death and Melena's catastrophic Fire; Tiran's cleanup follows (TCD-002, TCD-063)	Silas and Isola on separate immediate paths (TCD-044)
ADST	Elias's years-long double life as Thorne; the organization's compromise of his research and dream functioning (TCD-032, TCD-062)	When Elias goes missing (TCD-013)	The Nightmare organization's attempted Network rupture; the first established Convergence threshold, T0 (TCD-056, TCD-060)	Around the same time as FTE's (TCD-013)
FTE	○ OPEN beyond the 3SL aftermath and the Elias clock	A couple of weeks after ADST opens (TCD-013)	Challenge Six; the London Town forfeit (TCD-034, TCD-042, TCD-052)	Around the same time as ADST's (TCD-013)

II.16 · SHARED CHRONOLOGY

CONTINUED

BOOK	BACKGROUND ACTIVATION	NARRATIVE OPENING	CLIMAX	RESOLUTION
TSWK	May predate page one: the crackdown, Azrine's sanctuary, Levi's assignment (TCD-054)	Directly after FTE/ADST; days or small weeks (TCD-054)	○ OPEN (TCD-012)	○ OPEN (TCD-012)
Next Shadowmere book	May predate page one, including its character's continuing two-year life (TCD-054)	Directly after FTE/ADST; overlaps TSWK substantially (TCD-054)	○ OPEN	○ OPEN

GUARDRAIL

Temporal proximity isn't causation. Books that overlap in time don't cause each other's events unless a source says so. Local conflicts in TSWK and the next Shadowmere book stay independently rooted (TCD-054).

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE CALENDAR · ○ OPEN

FIXED
The macro windows, the two-year interval, the FTE/ADST sequence, the direct rolling handoff, the Shadowmere 3 / 5 / 7 numbering pattern (TCD-013, TCD-014, TCD-054).

UNDECIDED
A calendar anchor; exact dates in every band; the next Shadowmere installment's title and plot engine; the new canonical Remnian timeline (TCD-010).

WHY IT MATTERS
Information travels at the speed of routes. Without dates, the Companion can't say whether a character could have heard news by a given chapter (VII.2).

DECIDE BY
Remnian timeline before the FTE endgame fixes ages or years; the rest safe to defer until a cross-book appearance needs a date.

SOURCE *TCD-002, TCD-010, TCD-012, TCD-013, TCD-014, TCD-024, TCD-032, TCD-034, TCD-042, TCD-044, TCD-052, TCD-054, TCD-056, TCD-060, TCD-062, TCD-063. Record: Tandem Master Synchronization Timeline (full grid in VII.1).*

SEE ALSO VII.1 Master Synchronization Timeline → FTE concordance · **p.216**

VII.2 Event Chronology vs Information Chronology → FTE concordance · **p.216**

PART IV · BUILD 2

IV FOR THEIR ENTERTAINMENT / REMNIA

FTE is the book with the most canon fixed ahead of its own pages. The Beta has drafted twenty-eight and a half chapters; the rulings have already decided who wins, how, why London Town forfeits, what Katherine's magic is, how the sisters find each other, and where Atlas's injury comes from. What the rulings haven't done is write the scenes. This dossier holds both halves: the drafted book as it stands, and the ruled endgame it still has to reach.

SOURCE NOTE FOR ALL OF PART IV

The FTE Official Beta Reader Copy was read by chapter map and targeted passage search, not in one linear pass; chapter placements below come from that map and should be verified in a full read. *Chapter 29.docx*, *FTE 31–39*, *The Challenges FTE Year*, *49th Chess Tournament Placements*, *FTE Elemental Factions*, *Welcome to Remnia*, and *Character Bible* were read in full. Files the audit inventories but that aren't in this Project: FTE 2025 FINAL, the late chs. 44–48 plan, Chess Tournament Guidelines and Schedules, Education System in Old Prosperity, Events Leading Up To Novel Start, both FTE Remnian Timelines, Notable Figures, The Royal Lineage, The Remnian Provinces, and Novel Constraints. Where Part IV mentions them, it relies on the audit's record, not the file. *(Build 2 note, 2026-10-09: FTE 2025 FINAL, both FTE Remnian Timelines, and Full 4 Series Flesh Out have since been supplied. The IV.11 lineage record uses them claim by claim, and IV.11, IV.12, and IV.22 now cite the Before Story Start timeline where they had relied on the audit's record or the unaudited Imperial Lineage.)* The same goes for *New Opening*, which the audit and Production Master carry as a live alternative to the Beta's opening ◇ CONFLICT; it isn't in this Project, so the Companion can't compare the two.

§	SECTION	PAGE TYPE	PAGE
IV.1	Book Identity and Source Status	STATUS & PROVENANCE SHEET	51
IV.2	Remnia at a Glance	PLACE DOSSIER	54
IV.3	Power and Jurisdiction	POWER MAP	57
IV.4	The Sanctum	INSTITUTION DOSSIER	62
IV.5	Elemental Magic	FACTION TABLE	65
IV.6	The Tournament: Structure and Purpose	SYSTEM EXPLAINER	69

§	SECTION	PAGE TYPE	PAGE
IV.7	The Challenges	CHALLENGE TABLE	72
IV.8	Conqueror Rules	RULES TABLE	77
IV.9	Katherine Nicholas	DOSSIER · PROTAGONIST	80
IV.10	Katherine's Elemental Anatomy	COMPARISON SPREAD	83
IV.10	Your Pages: Katherine's Elemental Anatomy	YOUR PAGES	87
IV.11	Lineage: Biology, Law, Record, Succession	LINEAGE · FIVE LAYERS	98
IV.11	Record: Remnian Imperial + Royal Lineage	WORKING RECORD	102
IV.12	Katherine's Concealment	CONCEALMENT MATRIX	150
IV.13	The Sister Reveal	EVIDENCE CHAIN	153
IV.14	Melena Lockwood	DOSSIER · PROTAGONIST	157
IV.15	Caelum and Melena: The Leverage Ledger	LEVERAGE LEDGER	160
IV.16	Atlas: The Synchronization Injury	MECHANICS EXPLAINER	163
IV.17	The Elders' Prayer in FTE	PERFORMANCE RECORD	166
IV.18	Supporting Cast	CAST TABLE	169
IV.19	Minho Augustine	DOSSIER · ARC WORKSHEET	173
IV.20	The Endgame: Forfeit and Command Authority	CAUSAL CHAIN	176
IV.21	Plot State	PLOT STATE	179
IV.22	Knowledge Progression	KNOWLEDGE LEDGER	181
IV.23	Cross-Book Connections	CONNECTION TABLE	184
IV.24	FTE Endgame Packet	ENDGAME PACKET	187
IV.25	FTE Open Development	OPEN DEVELOPMENT	190
IV.25	Working Pages: FTE Open Development	WORKING PAGES	193
VII·FTE	Continuity Room: FTE Concordance	CONCORDANCE	216

IV.1 BOOK IDENTITY AND SOURCE STATUS

Separate canonized prose from usable development.

The Beta is the book. ● CANON TCD-001. Everything outside it, including the two newest development files, has to be rewritten into the Beta's generation before it becomes canon. That rule does real work in FTE, because the development chapters are good, specific, and in places flatly contradict rulings made after they were written.

FILE	WHAT IT IS	WHAT IT CONTROLS	WHAT IT CAN'T DO	STATUS
FTE Official Beta Reader Copy	Partial revised manuscript: Parts One–Three begun; chs. 1–28 complete, ch. 29 partial (Melena, med bay)	On-page POV, events, characterization, and rules for drafted chapters	Settle anything past ch. 29; override a ruling	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Chapter 29.docx	Katherine-POV chapter: the Elders' Prayer for Atlas at the end of Challenge Four	Nothing yet; candidate scene material	Count as ch. 29 (the Beta's ch. 29 is Melena's)	◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL · rewrite required
FTE 31–39	Development chapters: Naming Ceremony through the first Challenge Six bout	Nothing yet; usable scene and plot development	Stand as canon prose; override TCD-049–052, TCD-058	◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL · rewrite required
The Challenges FTE Year	Late-2025 plan for six executed Challenges	Challenge mechanics where the Beta is silent	Override the Beta's Challenge Two; control the endgame (TCD-042, TCD-050, TCD-052)	◩ SUPPORTED

IV.1 · BOOK IDENTITY AND SOURCE STATUS

CONTINUED

FILE	WHAT IT IS	WHAT IT CONTROLS	WHAT IT CAN'T DO	STATUS
49th Chess Tournament Placements	Roster table	Exact Piece positions and replacements	Settle magic classification (its "Dyad" notes are planning labels)	◩ **SUPPORTED** (current roster)
FTE Elemental Factions	Faction worldbuilding	Faction roster, culture, faction history	Define Dyads or Katherine's anatomy against rulings	◩ **SUPPORTED**
Welcome to Remnia	Mid-2025 setting primer	Public-facing lore where nothing better exists	Its selection count, Dax's rank, or superseded parentage	◩ **SUPPORTED**, several claims superseded
Character Bible	Early-modern character bible	Backgrounds and relationships where current sources are silent	Ages, titles, knowledge states without a current-generation check (audit)	◩ **SUPPORTED** by claim
The Imperial Lineage	Genealogy written as news bulletins; two copies in the Project	Nothing	It isn't in the audit's inventory, so it has no assigned authority	UNAUDITED · cited only as a flag
FTE Timeline	2024 timeline	Nothing	Anything	~~**LEGACY / SUPERSEDED**~~

GUARDRAIL

Development chapters are evidence of intent, not events. "In *FTE 31–39*, Houston kills Ellis" is a correct sentence. "Houston killed Ellis" isn't, yet.

NUMBERING FLAG

Chapter 29.docx is a Katherine chapter; the Beta's ch. 29 is Melena's, and no ch. 30 exists in any source. Where the Prayer scene lands in the sequence is a drafting decision, not a canon one.

IV.1 · BOOK IDENTITY AND SOURCE STATUS

CONTINUED

SOURCE *TCD-001, TCD-008; audit, FTE Source Inventory; FTE Beta (chapter map).*

SEE ALSO I.3 How Source Authority Works · **p.12** | IV.21 Plot State · **p.179** | Appendix C Source Authority Inventory · **p.260**

NOTES · IV.1

IV.2 REMNIA AT A GLANCE

Orient the reader in the Empire.

STATUS · AUTHOR CORRECTION 2026-10-09

● CANON	An empire on its own continental landmass, separated from Somnoria by ocean; the Crown at the highest public civil/dynastic level of the sovereignty structure.	TCD-025 · TCD-041
■ DRAFTED	Seventeen provinces.	FTE Beta

Remnia is an empire on its own continental landmass, separated from Somnoria by ocean; the Crown sits at the highest public civil/dynastic level of the Remnian sovereignty structure. ● CANON TCD-025, TCD-041. The Beta gives it seventeen provinces and confirms the count in three places: Melena's cover story is a tour of "all seventeen" provinces (ch. 2), the Delegation hall has seventeen archways "one for each province of the Empire", and seventeen Sanctum officials attend the Maze. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT) Its years are counted ER.

The Empire's borders are closed. Caelum says so in ch. 2 ("The Remnian Empire may have closed its borders, but there are still ways through"), and Melena, until he tells her otherwise, believes "There's nothing outside of Remnia anymore." That line is a character belief, dated to ch. 2, not a statement of what Remnia teaches (II.4).

Places on the page. Only what the sources actually put somewhere.

PLACE	WHAT THE BETA SHOWS	OTHER SOURCES	STATUS
London Town	The government province; the Imperial Palace; noble families; private tutors instead of group classes (as Katherine understands it)	*Welcome to Remnia*: ruled by King William and Queen Dalia Augustine under Empress Aracelia; Elemental Court has no power there. TCD-041: the Crown directly controls it	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT; Augustine rule ○ OPEN (IV.3)
Old Prosperity	The military province; University of Old Prosperity on its northern edge; High Command; frozen no-man's-land beyond the outer wall	*Welcome*: military; General Gareth Thorne	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT

PLACE	WHAT THE BETA SHOWS	OTHER SOURCES	STATUS
Havenwood	Tournament site; three Houses in a triangle, including the Sanctum's; Havenwood transports	*Welcome*: Tournament and Sanctum oversight	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Zenithia	Governor Anise; trade delegations; apricots; face paint worn by its people	*Welcome*: Countess Beatrice Montclair; *Character Bible*: Tiran heir to the Dukedom of Zenithia	Leadership ◇ CONFLICT (IV.3)
Alleia	Northern territories; a general nearly invades it over a shipping schedule	TCD-0027 spells it "Alea"	Spelling ○ OPEN
Verdant, Little Villa	Holiday and summer destinations Katherine was never allowed to visit (ch. 13)	—	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Rovencia	Maven's saltwater deliveries; a Rovencian field Melena visited as a child (ch. 2)	*FTE 31–39*: a "Regnant" of Rovencia at Challenge Six	Whether a province ○ OPEN
Easton / "Estonian"	An "Estonian trade minister" (Beta)	*31–39*: a Flight Academy in Easton	Spelling and relation ○ OPEN
Shadowmere	Where Melena has lived for two years as "Melena of Nowhere"	The Underside's Tier 7 city (Part III)	See knowledge flag below

KNOWLEDGE FLAG

How does Melena classify Shadowmere?

She has lived in the Underside for two years, yet in ch. 2 she answers Caelum's mention of Somnoria with "That's not a Remnian province… There's nothing outside of Remnia anymore." Both can be true only if she thinks of Shadowmere as something other than "outside": Remnian-adjacent, a lawless borderland, or not a nation at all. The page doesn't say which. ○ OPEN · decide before any Melena POV scene names what the Underside is.

SPELLING FLAG

The Beta writes "Alleia" three times; TCD-027 writes "Alea." This is a fine-detail spelling choice the audit leaves open, not a geography question. Pick one before the Remnia map is reviewed.

Welcome to Remnia says seventeen provinces in its text, lists eighteen names in its table, and says the Elemental Court controls "8 of 17" while marking nine. The Beta's seventeen controls. Precise provincial positions wait for Danyelle's Remnia map (TCD-027); nothing here places a province on a compass.

SOURCE *TCD-025, TCD-027, TCD-041; FTE Beta chs. 2, 7, 12–13, 19, 22; Welcome to Remnia; Character Bible (Tiran); FTE 31–39 chs. 31, 38.*

SEE ALSO II.2 Macro Geography · **p.27** | II.4 Knowledge of the Other Lands · **p.29** | III.3 The Underside: A Vertical Nation → FTE concordance · **p.216**

NOTES · IV.2

IV.3 POWER AND JURISDICTION

Replace "who's in charge" with a real power map.

Remnia doesn't have one ruler. It has several centers of authority that overlap, compete, and sometimes need each other. ● CANON TCD-041. The Crown is the highest public civil and dynastic authority and directly controls London Town and imperial affairs. Provincial Leaders administer their territories under titles that vary. The Provincial Leadership Board gives the provinces formal representation, and a Conqueror's one-year seat can change it. The Elemental Court is a separate political-magical bloc with influence over several provinces and over elemental policy, but not over London Town. The Sanctum is semi-autonomous in magical regulation, bloodlines, Tournament law, doctrine, security, and historical control. It isn't simply the Crown's agency, and it isn't legally omnipotent over the Crown either.

The practical consequence for drafting: when something goes wrong in FTE, the first question is never "who's in charge?" It's "whose jurisdiction is this, and who else thinks it's theirs?"

AUTHORITY	WHAT IT HOLDS (RULED)	ON THE PAGE	SUPPORTING-SOURCE DETAIL	OPEN
The Crown	Highest public civil and dynastic authority; direct control of London Town and imperial affairs ● CANON	Empress Aracelia signs the Tournament's opening letter; Melena is "the Lockwood second-in-line"; Helena runs Melena's schedule and complaints	*31–39*: a Privy Council pushed Elias into the Crown Prince role after Lucia's death	Aracelia's full name ◇ CONFLICT (IV.11); the Privy Council's standing

AUTHORITY	WHAT IT HOLDS (RULED)	ON THE PAGE	SUPPORTING-SOURCE DETAIL	OPEN
Provincial Leaders	Administer territories; titles vary ● CANON	Zenithia's Governor Anise files complaints against Melena	*Welcome*: Countess Beatrice Montclair (Zenithia), General Gareth Thorne (Old Prosperity), Director Rowan Mercer (Durant); *Character Bible*: Blackwood Dukedom of Zenithia	Zenithia's leadership ◇ CONFLICT; how London Town's Augustine monarchy sits under direct Crown control ○ OPEN
Provincial Leadership Board	Formal representation; the Conqueror's one-year seat ● CANON	Melena asks whether the Empress "summoned the entire Leadership Board"; the Board attends the masked reception	—	Powers, votes, benefits (IV.8)
Elemental Court	Political-magical bloc; not over London Town ● CANON	Never named in chs. 1–29	*Welcome*: controls "8 of 17" provinces (marks nine)	Which provinces; its powers
The Sanctum	Semi-autonomous: magic, bloodlines, Tournament law, doctrine, security, history ● CANON	Runs the Tournament end to end (IV.4)	—	Legal limits against the Crown

AUTHORITY	WHAT IT HOLDS (RULED)	ON THE PAGE	SUPPORTING-SOURCE DETAIL	OPEN
Military	Not placed by TCD-041, which rules the layered sovereignty framework. The structure is ■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (next table)	High Command's orders go out under General Gareth Thorne's signature; Old Prosperity's army has "three heads and one spine: the Legion in the sky, the Vanguard on the ground, the En Guard at sea"	*Character Bible*: Minho the youngest Captain ever to lead the En Guard	Command relationship to the Crown
"Regnants"	Not ruled	Absent	*31–39*: Regnants bet in their boxes at Challenge Six; Rovencia's Regnant calls the Sanctum "soft"	Whether this is a real title ○ OPEN

Old Prosperity's command, as drafted. It matters because Challenge Six turns on it.

DIVISION	DOMAIN	CAPTAIN AT FTE OPEN	SOURCE
En Guard	Sea	Minho Augustine, who took it when Michelle Nicholas stepped down two months before ch. 1	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (ch. 1, ch. 5)
Legion	Sky	Atlas Tolliver, transferred from the En Guard by Michelle's order	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (ch. 26 conversation)
Vanguard	Ground	Dax Tolliver	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT

Michelle is "Lieutenant Michelle Nicholas, undefeated Captain of the En Guard" on her mess-hall banner. Her rank and her command title differ; the Beta uses both.

◇ CONFLICT

Who leads Zenithia?

The Beta has Governor Anise. *Welcome to Remnia* has Countess Beatrice Montclair. The *Character Bible* makes Tiran heir to a Blackwood Dukedom of Zenithia. The Beta controls the on-page office; a duchy and a governorship can coexist under TCD-0041's "titles vary", but no source says they do. Don't let Tiran exercise Zenithian authority until this is settled.

◇ CONFLICT

London Town's royal house.

Welcome to Remnia: King William and Queen Dalia Augustine. *Character Bible*: Crown Princess Dalia and Prince Consort David Augustine. *FTE 31–39*: Dalia is "the Queen of London Town." All three are Supporting. TCD-0041's direct Crown control of London Town is canon, so whatever the Augustines are, they rule under it.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE JURISDICTION MAP · ○ OPEN

FIXED
The roster of authorities and their broad roles (TCD-041).

UNDECIDED
Appointments, vetoes, prosecution authority, funding, military command relationships; who adjudicates a Crown–Sanctum dispute; the Augustines' constitutional position; whether "Regnant" exists.

WHY IT MATTERS
The forfeit is a jurisdiction scene. Maxim authorizes, the Sanctum accepts, the Crown watches its heir walk off a board (IV.20). Each of them has to be acting inside powers the reader can believe.

DECIDE BY
Before the forfeit is drafted; Zenithia before Tiran's title does anything on-page.

WORKING SPACE · THE JURISDICTION MAP

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-034, TCD-041, TCD-042; FTE Beta chs. 1, 2, 5, 7, 26; Welcome to Remnia; Character Bible; FTE 31–39 chs. 31, 33, 38. Record: Remnian Power + Jurisdiction Map.*

SEE ALSO IV.4 The Sanctum · **p.62**

IV.20 The Endgame: Forfeit and Command Authority · **p.176**

VII.10 Continuity Translation Pages → FTE concordance · **p.216**

IV.4 THE SANCTUM

Dossier for the institution behind most FTE secrets.

The Sanctum is the institution FTE is actually about. It regulates magic, bloodlines, Tournament law, doctrine, security, and historical control. ● CANON TCD-041. It runs the Tournament in public as a sacred tradition and a political reward, and in private uses it to classify, cultivate, control, exploit, monitor, suppress, or eliminate dangerous people. ● CANON TCD-034. It is the principal enforcer of Katherine's concealment and custodian of the records. ● CANON TCD-059.

It also doesn't get to be the villain of everything. The rulings are careful: the Sanctum accepts and may exploit the London Town forfeit but doesn't cause it (TCD-042, TCD-052), and it didn't originate Katherine's erasure (TCD-059). An institution that frightening is more frightening when it's also bounded.

What the Beta shows the Sanctum doing. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)

FUNCTION	ON THE PAGE
Membership	Members are "chosen from the highest ranks of each province, then stripped of their identities"; officials wear black and gold, and gray robes at the Maze
Selection	Places Pieces at Delegation "by the power vested in the Sanctum"; runs full identity scans of candidates
Ownership of Pieces	Nico: "The moment you stepped off the Board at Delegation, you stopped belonging to Old Prosperity. You belong to the Tournament now. To the Sanctum."
Surveillance	The Houses' common areas are monitored around the clock, audio and visual; the Sanctum reviews all footage and broadcasts select clips
Challenge design	Builds Challenges from Piece performance data; fields non-human combatants and constructs in Challenge One
Discipline	Sanctum Protocol 17 (Melena and Cordelia's violation, chs. 8–9); Code Sixteen; probation for Jarom Fairchild and Olivia Rembrandt after the augmenter incident (ch. 12)
Presence	Seventeen officials at the Maze; sixteen hand out blindfolds; the seventeenth is taller, with robes "shimmering faintly wrong" (ch. 22)
Handlers	Nico for Old Prosperity; Raven for London Town, who carries neutralizing cuffs and a suppressor rod

Code Sixteen, as the Beta quotes it: "No Piece shall wield, develop, or demonstrate a second elemental affinity beyond the one registered at birth, whether innate, enhanced, or artificially induced. Penalty: immediate removal from the Tournament and Imperial discipline." "Imperial law didn't bother splitting hairs. If a second element answered when you called, you were in violation."

What the development chapters add. (◪ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL · *FTE 31–39*) The Sanctum writes the Naming Ceremony scripts, which King Pieces "approve" and Queen Pieces read (ch. 32). Elite mages administer Heart's Mirror. Pieces are isolated before Challenge Six. Ceiling cameras show a tally light that never truly goes off. A no-kill order is issued for Challenge Six, then a non-verbal yield is ruled invalid and a surrendering Piece dies (ch. 39).

REVISION FLAG (DEVELOPMENT CHAPTERS)

The penalty for a second element.

FTE 31–39 ch. 38 says dualists have been illegal "since the Faction Wars" and that "the punishment for being a dualist was death." The Beta's Code Sixteen says removal from the Tournament and Imperial discipline. The Beta controls. "Imperial discipline" can be as dark as the book needs, but it has to be introduced as that, not as a death statute.

THE SANCTUM IN EACH KNOWLEDGE LANE.

LANE	WHAT IT HOLDS
Public version	Custodian of a sacred tradition; broadcaster of the spectacle; neutral referee
What the Pieces learn on-page	They are owned, watched, scored, and edited for broadcast; rules can be enforced selectively
Objective truth	Also a covert classifier and eliminator of dangerous people (TCD-034); enforcer and record-keeper of Katherine's concealment (TCD-059)
Open	The seventeenth figure at the Maze; the Sanctum's internal factions; how much it knows about Katherine's magic before Challenge Six

GUARDRAIL

"The Sanctum knows" is never a complete sentence. Which office, which official, since when, and on what evidence? An institution this compartmentalized can hold a secret in one room and be ignorant of it in the next.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE SANCTUM · ○ OPEN

FIXED
Its domains and semi-autonomy (TCD-041); dual Tournament purpose (TCD-034); enforcement role in the concealment (TCD-059); accepting, not causing, the forfeit (TCD-042, TCD-052).

UNDECIDED
Internal structure; the seventeenth official; what its Katherine file says; what it believes about Dyads versus what it records; its legal limits.

WHY IT MATTERS
Katherine's exposure (IV.10) and the sister reveal's verification stage (IV.13) both run through Sanctum records. The scenes need to know which office holds what.

DECIDE BY
Before the verification stage of the sister reveal is drafted.

WORKING SPACE · THE SANCTUM

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-034, TCD-041, TCD-042, TCD-052, TCD-059; FTE Beta chs. 8–9, 11–13, 15, 22; FTE 31–39 chs. 32–39.*

SEE ALSO II.15 Recurring Institutional Misreadings · **p.45** | IV.7 The Challenges · **p.72** | IV.12 Katherine's Concealment · **p.150**

IV.5 ELEMENTAL MAGIC

Teach the system before Katherine's exception.

Remnian magic is elemental, organized into factions, and registered at birth. It descends from the same primordial substrate as the other three lands' magic and is now its own system, with its own access, costs, and classifications. ● CANON TCD-035. Nothing in this section makes a Remnian element equivalent to a Somnorian or Underside practice (II.5).

The seven factions. The roster and descriptions come from *FTE Elemental Factions* (◩ SUPPORTED). The right-hand column is what the Beta actually shows.

FACTION	FACTIONS FILE: ABILITIES	FACTIONS FILE: SOCIAL ROLE	ON THE PAGE (BETA)	PIECES
Frost	Ice and water	Naval command, water management, burn healing	Katherine's shields, ice bridges, air filtering; Frost weakened by jungle humidity and ambient heat (C1); marks on the wrist	Katherine, Atlas, Houston (OP)
Flamer	Fire and energy	Siege warfare, industry, energy supply	Melena's volatile fire; Tiran's controlled fire and off-grid "patch" of old fire; Dax's flames	Melena, Tiran (LT); Sebastian, Dax, Zephyr (registered, OP)
Terrain	Earth, stone, plant life	Agriculture, fortification, heavy infantry	Vine "alarm system" in the jungle; the Maze built to suppress Terrain	Maxim, Seraphina, Luke (LT); Reign (OP)
Blockers	Shapeshifting and mimicry	Espionage, diplomacy, performance	Minho (little shown in chs. 1–29)	Minho (OP); Ellis (LT)
Dawners	Strength, speed, often flight	Airborne forces, couriers, policing	Blair, "the only Dawner on our team," valued for vision	Blair (OP pawn)
Elite	Older arcane magic: teleportation, enchantment, time, forbidden spellcraft	Scholars, archivists, advisors, priests	Allison St. James (LT pawn) per *31–39*; Elite mages run Heart's Mirror (*31–39*)	Allison (LT)

FACTION	FACTIONS FILE: ABILITIES	FACTIONS FILE: SOCIAL ROLE	ON THE PAGE (BETA)	PIECES
Flight	Technology and high-speed movement; magic integrated into devices	Engineering, surveillance, data, airships	Astor; Justin Duran	Astor (LT); Justin (OP)

NOT THE SAME AS

Dawners and Flight.
In the Factions file, Dawners fly with their bodies and Flight flies with machines. Old Prosperity's Legion is "in the sky," but that doesn't make it a Dawner or Flight unit; Atlas is a Frost who commands it.

One element, registered at birth. The Beta treats an elemental affinity as something recorded when you're born and marked on the wrist. Code Sixteen forbids a second one "whether innate, enhanced, or artificially induced" (IV.4). An **augmenter**, "concentrated elemental compound, smuggled in from black-market labs," forces a second element into someone's system "for a few brilliant, illegal minutes"; Olivia Rembrandt uses one in ch. 12. Raven's suppressor rod and neutralizing cuffs shut elements down, and Tiran counters with an off-grid "patch" of old fire. "Dyads were illegal." (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 12)

History the Factions file supplies. (◩ SUPPORTED; every date awaits the rebuilt timeline, TCD-010)

EVENT	FACTIONS FILE DATE	WHAT IT SAYS
Frost–Flamer War (War of the Scorched Sea)	108–113 ER	Over naval control and energy; Flamers burn the Ice Sanctum in Alleia, "where the Frost primarily live"
Treaty of the Scorched Sea	114 ER	Flamers lose naval control; Frost loses industrial power
Treaty of Concord	500 ER	Elemental Court rules, "established after the first Chess Tournament"; naval command permanently Frost
Council of Balances	511 ER	Nine-person oversight body; reviews Tournament rulings
Province Limit Law	514 ER	At least two factions influence each province
First Great Rebellion	298–303 ER	Coalition against the Elemental Court

EVENT	FACTIONS FILE DATE	WHAT IT SAYS
Modern scandals	2090–2095 ER	Rigged selection, a missing Queen candidate, the 2092 "two survivors" Tournament

CALENDAR FLAG

These dates don't yet sit in one chronology. The Factions file puts the first Tournament before 500 ER and this one in 2096 ER; the Placements file calls this the 49th; the Beta's Challenge Two dates an archive copy to "Year 847." Forty-nine Tournaments across that span isn't impossible, but nothing yet explains the interval. ○ OPEN · TCD-010.

GUARDRAIL

Repeated names aren't connections.

The Factions file's 2092 survivor is a Dawner named **Zephyr Windrider**. He is not Zephyr Augustine, and nothing connects them. The file's "The Veil" conspiracy has nothing to do with the Shattered Veil (II.13).

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · REMNIAN ELEMENTAL TAXONOMY · ○ OPEN

FIXED
Shared substrate, distinct system (TCD-035); Code Sixteen and the augmenter as drafted; Katherine's and Zephyr's anatomies (IV.10).

UNDECIDED
What "registered at birth" physically involves; how wrist marks appear; whether factions are purely magical or also social castes; the faction history's dates; whether Elite, Dawner, and Flight abilities on the page will match the Factions file.

WHY IT MATTERS
The Duel is fought element against element, and Katherine's exposure is an element that shouldn't exist. Both need rules the reader already trusts.

DECIDE BY
Wrist-mark mechanics before Katherine's marks change on-page (IV.10).

WORKING SPACE · REMNIAN ELEMENTAL TAXONOMY

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-010, TCD-035; FTE Beta chs. 12, 15–17, 22; FTE Elemental Factions; 49th Placements; FTE 31–39 chs. 31, 33.*

SEE ALSO II.5 Shared Magical Ancestry · **p.32**

II.6 Crossblood: A Label, Not a Biology · **p.35**

IV.10 Katherine's Elemental Anatomy · **p.83**

SYSTEM EXPLAINER · PART IV · FOR THEIR ENTERTAINMENT / REMNIA

IV.6 THE TOURNAMENT: STRUCTURE AND PURPOSE

Explain both faces of the Tournament.

The Chess Tournament pits two provinces against each other with living Pieces on a chessboard's positions. This year it's Old Prosperity against London Town. The Empress's opening letter sets the public terms: thirty-two Pieces, "sixteen from each province, eight men and eight women"; the goal is to "capture the opposing King. Achieve Checkmate. Win."; and "to the victor, I offer a seat on the Provincial Leadership Board — a year of power, a year of favor, a year to reshape your province's future." (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, front matter)

That's the public half. The private half is canon too: the Sanctum uses selection, assignments, challenges, stress, injuries, alliances, and survival to classify, cultivate, control, exploit, monitor, suppress, or eliminate dangerous people. ● CANON TCD-034. Neither half cancels the other. The Board seat is real, and so is the cull.

The Tournament is designed around seven Challenges, and reaching the Seventh isn't guaranteed. Attrition, Checkmate, disqualification, intervention, or another decisive outcome can end it early. In the current FTE, the Sanctum declares Challenge Six decisive and terminates the Tournament. ● CANON TCD-007

REVISION FLAG (FTE BETA)

"Six challenges."

The Empress's letter calls the Tournament "survival distilled into six challenges." TCD-007 makes the design seven, with the Sixth ending this one. The letter's wording needs revising to fit the ruling. It doesn't compete with it.

HOW IT RUNS, AS DRAFTED.

STAGE	ON THE PAGE
Candidacy	Twenty is within the "Tournament candidate range"; High Command's order to Katherine arrives under General Gareth Thorne's signature
Delegation	Candidates are assessed, then placed on the Board at a ceremony "by the power vested in the Sanctum"; Delegation members are exempt from the identity scan

STAGE	ON THE PAGE
Houses	Each province lives in a Havenwood House under a handler; common areas are filmed around the clock
Welcome Feast	Seventeen tables; the first time Katherine and Melena share a room
Challenges	Designed by the Sanctum; briefed by handlers; broadcast
No-kill order	"You are not to intentionally kill another Piece" (Nico, before the Maze; Katherine invokes a "no killing rule" in Challenge One). Environments and constructs still kill

The Board. Backline positions from the *49th Chess Tournament Placements* (◪ SUPPORTED, current roster). Elements are as registered.

POSITION	LONDON TOWN	OLD PROSPERITY
Queen's Rook	Astor (Flight)	Reign Woods (Terrain)
Queen's Knight	Seraphina (Terrain)	Zephyr Augustine (Flamer)
Queen's Bishop	Tiran Blackwood (Flamer)	Atlas Tolliver (Frost)
Queen	Melena Lockwood (Flamer)	Katherine Nicholas (Frost)
King	Maxim Augustine (Terrain)	Minho Augustine (Blocker)
King's Bishop	Luke (Terrain)	Sebastian Augustine (Flamer)
King's Knight	Viv (replacing Jarom Fairchild, suspended)	Dax Tolliver (Flamer)
King's Rook	Ellis Vale (Blocker)	Houston Maddison (Frost)

Pawns, London Town: Allison St. James, Volt Aran, Ivy Lennox, Cael Navarro, Sine Cauldren, Leo Keene, Jin Voss, Alexei Rhae (Olivia Rembrandt removed before Challenge One). Pawns, Old Prosperity: Tegan Morrows, Griffin Hale, Noah Everhart, Beckett Rhodes, Kamal Voss, Nova Chen, Justin Duran (Flight), Blair Faelan (Dawner).

Four Augustine brothers are on the Board, split across the two sides: Maxim is London Town's King, while Minho is Old Prosperity's King and Sebastian and Zephyr play beside him. The Beta makes the split hurt in the Maze, which is built to suppress Terrain, and Maxim is a Terrain.

SUPERSEDED

Welcome to Remnia's eight selections per province and its Dax-as-Rook are superseded by the Beta's sixteen and the Placements file's King's Knight. The *Character Bible*'s "Elias was supposed to be the King" belongs to an older generation; Maxim is King.

NAMING FLAG

FTE 31–39's Naming Ceremony calls two London Town pawns "Sine Cauldiste" and "Jin Wang"; the Placements file has Sine Cauldren and Jin Voss. It also gives Ivy Lennox two ages (twenty and eighteen) and two younger siblings. Copyedit when the chapters are rewritten.

Why it matters. Every Tournament scene is performing for three audiences at once: the crowd, the provinces' politicians, and the Sanctum's evaluators. A Piece can win the broadcast and lose the evaluation. Katherine's exposure is exactly that kind of event.

SOURCE *TCD-007, TCD-034; FTE Beta front matter, chs. 1, 8–9, 11, 13, 15, 21–22; 49th Chess Tournament Placements; Welcome to Remnia; Character Bible; FTE 31–39 ch. 31.*

SEE ALSO IV.7 The Challenges · **p.72** | IV.8 Conqueror Rules · **p.77** | IV.20 The Endgame: Forfeit and Command Authority · **p.176**

NOTES · IV.6

IV.7 THE CHALLENGES

Current challenge architecture.

The Beta drafts Challenges One through Three and opens Four. *Chapter 29.docx* closes Four; *FTE 31–39* drafts Five and opens Six. *The Challenges FTE Year* plans all six. Each Challenge below carries its own status, because they sit at three different levels of authority.

#	NAME	FORMAT	DRAFTING STATE	RESULT	DEATHS ON RECORD
1	War Simulation (plan)	Live tactical exercise; terrain rotates jungle → volcanic → tundra; Sanctum constructs; command nodes claimed by "a minimum of four active Pieces plus a King or Queen"	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (chs. 15–18)	Old Prosperity	None identified in this read
2	Empirical History (plan)	Document authentication: choose the authentic primary source	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (chs. 19–20)	Old Prosperity; London Town penalized	—
3	The Maze	Entered blindfolded by shadow travel; multi-level, disorienting; hostile to Terrain	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (chs. 21–24)	○ OPEN not confirmed in this read; the plan has Old Prosperity lose three pawns and London Town four	Beckett Rhodes (OP), Ivy Lennox (LT)
4	The Conduit Trials (working title)	Four pillars; bonded-pair synchronization; runes in white and black	Briefing and opening ■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (ch. 28); close ◩ SUPPORTED . rewrite required (*Chapter 29.docx*)	London Town, which "secures their second conduit" (*Ch. 29*; confirmed by *31–39*)	By its end, per *31–39*, all sixteen pawns are dead: eight named for each province

#	NAME	FORMAT	DRAFTING STATE	RESULT	DEATHS ON RECORD
5	Heart's Mirror	Elite mages; a mask; the Piece relives what the Mirror finds; elements don't work; groups separated by gender	◩ SUPPORTED · rewrite required (*31–39* chs. 33–36)	"Completed"; no winner stated	None stated
6	The Duel	Mirrored Pieces in single combat on sixteen isolated platforms; victory by yield, incapacitation, or death; lower Pieces first	Opening bout ◩ SUPPORTED · rewrite required (*31–39* ch. 39)	Decisive by Sanctum declaration; London Town forfeits ● CANON TCD-007, TCD-009	Ellis Vale (LT), killed by Houston after a non-verbal yield is refused (*31–39*)
7	—	Never held	—	—	—

Two challenges down, two wins: that's where Old Prosperity stands in ch. 21 as the Maze begins. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)

Challenge Two carries a cross-book event. One document is "The Breathbound Law, as recorded in the Imperial Archives, Year 847." The other is older, unmarked, with no seal and no cited year, and it carries lines from Somnoria's Dreamwalker's Writ: "Time is a spiral, not a line"; "The script was written, not the death"; "What sings in blood does not decide." Katherine notices it "felt related to the Breathbound Law," briefly suspects a draft from before "the Empire picked the lines it liked best," and dismisses the thought: "Conspiracy theories didn't win challenges." Old Prosperity wins by choosing the Breathbound Law. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 19)

That makes ch. 19 the first on-page moment where anyone holds two national descendants of the Shattered Veil side by side (II.13). The Companion reads what it shows and no more:

LANE	WHAT CH. 19 ESTABLISHES
Character knowledge	Katherine registers resemblance and a possible editorial history, then rejects it. She doesn't know the second text is Somnorian.
Institutional / public version	The Imperial record is the authentic one by every official test. The Sanctum's archive can produce the Writ-bearing text on demand.

LANE	WHAT CH. 19 ESTABLISHES
Objective truth	Both are divergent descendants of one master (TCD-047). Neither is untouched.
Open	Why the Sanctum's archive holds a Writ-bearing text; who selected it for a Tournament challenge; whether anyone else in the room noticed

SUPERSEDED

The Challenges FTE Year plans Challenge Two around Orlin Vasquez documents with London Town winning. The Beta's Breathbound/Writ challenge and Old Prosperity's win control.

Challenge Four and the pair mechanic. Nico's briefing sets four pillars and bonded pairs who must synchronize; by the end of ch. 28, Atlas's black veins have spread to his cheekbones. That's the ruled origin of his injury (IV.16). *Chapter 29.docx* has Katherine perform the Elders' Prayer to stop it, at the cost of the conduit (IV.17). *31–39* then treats the Katherine–Atlas link as a fading "tether" with echoes of Dax. The plan names three pair roles (Anchor, Channel, Solve) with penalties; the Beta hasn't drafted them yet.

OPEN

Challenge Four's final canon name. "The Conduit Trials" is a working title. ○ OPEN TCD-008

Challenge Five as the development chapters draft it. Melena relives Ivy's four minutes and thirty-seven seconds of dying, a confrontation with her father Tobias, and repeated scenarios in which she chooses "power over people," ending with Elias falling while she stands at the throne. Katherine relives falling through lake ice at ten with her friend Mara Kingston, then a Mirror-Atlas who beats her and strips her Frost until she shouts "I can wield fire." (◪ SUPPORTED · rewrite required) Under the 2026-09-26 author ruling, Katherine's half survives only as foreshadowing. Nothing she experiences inside the Mirror is automatically a recovered memory, and she leaves it still Frost-dominant (IV.10).

Challenge Six as the development chapters draft it. The Sanctum announces mirrored single combat: "Victory is determined by yield, incapacitation, or death." Cordelia reports a Sanctum no-kill order and a crowd chanting for blood. In the first bout, Houston freezes Ellis's throat; Ellis signals surrender with an open palm; the Sanctum rules that "verbal confirmation is required"; the crowd chants FINISH; Houston kills him. (◩ SUPPORTED · rewrite required) Before the bouts, Minho names Corporal Katherine his successor for the En Guard and Atlas names her for the Legion, and she refuses the premise. That scene sits directly on the command-authority rules in IV.20.

SUPERSEDED

The plan's Duel ending (Melena realizes the sisterhood mid-fight, burns away Katherine's emblems, Katherine performs the Prayer on Melena, Tiran finds Melena and the forfeit follows) conflicts with the staged reveal (TCD-050) and the command-authorized forfeit (TCD-042, TCD-052). Its Frost-severance beat is compatible with TCD-058 and is a live candidate for the climax ◌ POSSIBLE.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE CHALLENGES · ○ OPEN

FIXED
Seven-stage design; Six decisive (TCD-007); Four's concept (TCD-008); Old Prosperity's wins in One and Two; the drafted deaths in the Maze.

UNDECIDED
Challenge Three's result; Four's name and full rules; whether Five produces a winner; Six's bout order and the Sanctum's real kill policy; what Challenge Seven would have been.

WHY IT MATTERS
The forfeit only means something if the reader can feel what continuing to Challenge Seven would cost (TCD-042).

DECIDE BY
Six's rules before the Duel is drafted; Seven's shape before Melena's choice is drafted, because she is choosing against it.

WORKING SPACE · THE CHALLENGES

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-007, TCD-008, TCD-009, TCD-042, TCD-047, TCD-050, TCD-051, TCD-052, TCD-058; FTE Beta chs. 15–24, 28; Chapter 29.docx; FTE 31–39 chs. 31–39; The Challenges FTE Year.*

SEE ALSO II.13 The Shattered Veil and Its Descendants · **p.37**

IV.16 Atlas: The Synchronization Injury · **p.163** IV.17 The Elders' Prayer in FTE · **p.166**

IV.20 The Endgame: Forfeit and Command Authority · **p.176**

IV.8 CONQUEROR RULES

Define the title correctly.

The Conqueror isn't the King, and isn't whoever lands the last hit. The Conqueror is the surviving Piece whose decisive sanctioned action earns victory, and that Piece holds the winning province's Provincial Leadership Board seat for the next year. ● CANON TCD-034. Under a forfeit, the Conqueror is the surviving Piece whose final sanctioned action or matchup directly produces the decisive state that causes the forfeit.

Katherine Nicholas is this Tournament's Conqueror. ● CANON TCD-034. Atlas and Tiran's confrontation is officially a draw by intervention; Katherine and Melena produce the decisive sequence.

SITUATION	WHO IS CONQUEROR	STATUS
Ordinary Checkmate	The surviving Piece whose decisive sanctioned action earns it; not automatically the King	● CANON TCD-034; the precise Checkmate definition ○ OPEN
Forfeit	The surviving Piece whose final sanctioned action or matchup directly produces the decisive state	● CANON TCD-034
This Tournament	Katherine, because her sanctioned action against or for Melena prevents catastrophe, saves or stabilizes Melena, and creates the decisive state	● CANON TCD-034, TCD-042
The last physical attack before an intervention	Doesn't decide it; Atlas doesn't win by landing it	● CANON TCD-034
The Conqueror is dead or incapacitated	Not ruled	○ OPEN

The Beta's own words fit the ruling: Old Prosperity's mess hall hangs banners "embroidered with the names of the Conquerors who had led Old Prosperity to glory," and Part Three of the Beta is titled THE CONQUEROR. Michelle Nicholas "secured one of Old Prosperity's greatest Tournament victories"; whether she was its Conqueror isn't stated.

GUARDRAIL

The Empress's letter says the goal is to capture the King. That's the public rule, and the Beta should keep saying it. It isn't how this Tournament ends, and the Conqueror rule already covers why.

POSSIBLE PRECEDENT POSSIBLE

The Factions file describes a 2092 ER Tournament whose last two survivors forfeited rather than accept victory, and an Empire that covered it up. If recovered, it would give the London Town forfeit an institutional memory. It isn't canon, and its survivor Zephyr Windrider has nothing to do with Zephyr Augustine.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · CONQUEROR BYLAWS · ○ OPEN

FIXED
Definition; forfeit rule; Katherine as Conqueror; the Atlas–Tiran draw (TCD-034).

UNDECIDED
Checkmate and "final move" definitions; deliberate setups; death, incapacity, proxy, and succession; the title's effect on rank; the Board seat's actual powers; what the winning province gains.

WHY IT MATTERS
A Corporal on the Leadership Board is a political earthquake. What the seat can do decides what Katherine's victory costs everyone else.

DECIDE BY
Katherine's exact sanctioned action before the climax; Board powers before the aftermath.

WORKING SPACE · CONQUEROR BYLAWS

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.8 · CONQUEROR RULES

CONTINUED

SOURCE *TCD-034, TCD-042; FTE Beta front matter, ch. 1, Part Three heading; FTE Elemental Factions. Record: Conqueror Rules + Political Reward.*

SEE ALSO

IV.6 The Tournament: Structure and Purpose · **p.69**

IV.20 The Endgame: Forfeit and Command Authority · **p.176**

IV.24 FTE Endgame Packet · **p.187**

NOTES · IV.8

IV.9 KATHERINE NICHOLAS

Protagonist dossier.

Katherine is a soldier who has been told her whole life that she's exactly what she looks like: Michelle Nicholas's daughter, a Frost, a Corporal with a rank she has to keep earning. Every one of those things is true. None of them is complete. The book is the slow discovery that the fence around her life was built on purpose (ch. 13), and the Companion's job is to make sure she discovers it in the right order.

	KATHERINE NICHOLAS	STATUS
Full name on her orders	Corporal Katherine Medina Celeste Nicholas	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (front matter)
Age at FTE	Twenty	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Piece	Old Prosperity's Queen	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Registered element	Frost	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Objective magic	One less-specialized ancestral capacity, Frost-dominant, with Fire as a later rerouted expression	● CANON TCD-049, TCD-058 (IV.10)
Mother	Lieutenant Michelle Nicholas, former Captain of the En Guard; stepped down two months before ch. 1	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Biological father	Tobias Lockwood	● CANON TCD-040
What Katherine knows about her father	Nothing shown on-page in chs. 1–29	○ OPEN
Where she grew up	Old Prosperity; never beyond its borders until the Havenwood transport, except once to a border base	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (ch. 13)
Appearance	Brown skin; braids appear on her in *31–39*; the *Character Bible* gives brown eyes flecked with gold, 5'9"	◪ SUPPORTED
Birth year	2076 ER (*Character Bible*)	◪ SUPPORTED; calendar unruled (TCD-010)

The fence. "On paper, there were explanations. War. Security. The Nicholas name." When classmates went to Verdant, Zenithia, or Little Villa, "Michelle always had a reason ready." In ch. 13, watching Old Prosperity shrink behind the transport, Katherine sees the pattern "less like caution and more like a fence she hadn't realized she'd been living inside." (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT) That's the first on-page crack in the concealment (IV.12), and it's Katherine's, not Melena's.

WHO SHE IS UNDER PRESSURE, AS DRAFTED.

MOMENT	WHAT SHE DOES	CHAPTER
The Examination	Her jacket catches fire in an urban-warfare simulation; she screams a shatter pulse and freezes the whole square. Fire trauma produces Frost.	7
Challenge One, volcanic phase	Builds ice bridges over lava, past her limits, to save Houston and then London Town Flamers: "I meant to keep as many people off the lava as possible. Old Prosperity or London Town."	15–16
Challenge One, tundra phase	Filters poisoned air for Nova; leads the search for Zephyr; finds him guarding an ice cave with Melena inside; resets Melena's shoulder and carries her out. "I wouldn't have done this for you." "I know. That's why I'm the one doing it."	17
Challenge Two	The team's answer key; nearly sees the history behind the Breathbound Law, and chooses the official answer	19
Atlas	They become intimate	26

The pattern is consistent: she protects first and calculates second, and she'll protect the enemy. That matters because the ruling requires Katherine to save or stabilize Melena "because of her own moral arc, not only sisterhood" (TCD-050). The Beta has already built that arc; the endgame only has to keep faith with it.

HER PEOPLE.

PERSON	RELATIONSHIP ON THE PAGE
Michelle Nicholas	Mother; former En Guard Captain; taught her chess ("Assess, commit, move your pieces"); the voice behind the fence
Atlas Tolliver	Her superior, once Michelle's First Mate in the En Guard; now Legion Captain; lovers from ch. 26
Reign Woods	Closest friend; Queen's Rook
Minho Augustine	Her King and En Guard Captain; in *31–39*, names her his successor
Dax Tolliver	Atlas's twin; Vanguard Captain; provocation and heat (*31–39* ch. 32)
Sebastian and Zephyr Augustine	Friends; Zephyr's secret (IV.10)
Melena Lockwood	Enemy Queen; paternal half-sister she doesn't know she has

REVISION FLAG (DEVELOPMENT CHAPTERS)

Zephyr's secret.

In *FTE 31–39* ch. 38, Zephyr's two elements are news to Katherine ("He's a Dyad, too"). In the Beta, she has already seen his fire and frost in the tundra (ch. 17). The Beta controls; the rewrite has to account for what she saw, even if she chose not to name it.

SUPERSEDED

Welcome to Remnia says Ethan Medina "gave Katherine his name." Ethan as her biological father is superseded (TCD-040). "Medina" is on her orders, so a social or naming role for Ethan remains possible ◌ POSSIBLE, but no ruling makes it canon.

SOURCE *TCD-040, TCD-049, TCD-050, TCD-058; FTE Beta front matter, chs. 1, 5, 7, 13, 15–17, 19, 26; Character Bible; Welcome to Remnia; FTE 31–39 chs. 32, 38–39.*

SEE ALSO IV.10 Katherine's Elemental Anatomy · p.83

IV.12 Katherine's Concealment · p.150 IV.13 The Sister Reveal · p.153

COMPARISON SPREAD · PART IV · FOR THEIR ENTERTAINMENT / REMNIA

IV.10 KATHERINE'S ELEMENTAL ANATOMY

Replace the Dyad label with the ruled anatomy.

This is the most carefully ruled magic in FTE, and the development chapters get it wrong in instructive ways, so read this before touching any scene where Katherine's element changes.

Katherine genuinely possesses Frost and Fire. ● CANON TCD-049. They aren't two ordinary channels. They're alternative expressions of one less-specialized ancestral Remnian elemental capacity, an older inheritance resurfacing in a modern body. From childhood that capacity organized itself around a dominant Frost expression, and Frost training reinforced it. ● CANON TCD-058. Ordinary stress and Fire exposure don't activate Fire. In FTE's climax, catastrophic severance or unavailability of her established Frost configuration lets the older capacity reroute through what modern Remnia calls Fire. No deliberate magical suppression is established.

Zephyr is the contrast case. He is a genuine modern Fire/Frost Dyad. ● CANON TCD-049. The Sanctum would likely call Katherine a Dyad too, because its taxonomy has no better word; that diagnosis is incomplete or wrong (II.15).

	KATHERINE	ZEPHYR
Objective anatomy	One ancestral capacity; alternative expressions	Two modern channels, Fire and Frost
Registered as	Frost	Flamer
Institutional label	"Dyad" (likely; wrong or incomplete)	"Dyad" (correct)
Before FTE	Frost only, from childhood	Two elements; *31–39* says since thirteen, after a training accident
On the page	Examination: Fire trauma, Frost response (ch. 7)	Tundra: "orange fire edged with blue" in one hand, something else in the other; Melena sees both elements (ch. 18); Katherine sees them (ch. 17)
What opens the second expression	Catastrophic Frost failure, in the climax	Already open

	KATHERINE	ZEPHYR
Fire caused by Melena?	No. Fire isn't borrowed, temporary, or a reaction to Melena (TCD-049)	—
Status	● CANON TCD-049, TCD-058	● CANON TCD-049; drafting details ◩ SUPPORTED

The Examination is the baseline. In ch. 7, Fire is on her body, the stress is extreme, her output spikes, and what comes out is Frost. The ruling was built on that scene. Any later scene in which ordinary fear, anger, heat, or grief pulls Fire out of her contradicts the drafted baseline, not just the ruling.

AUTHOR RULING, 2026-09-26

TCD-058 clarified (no new TCD number assigned).

● CANON Heart's Mirror may foreshadow Katherine's hidden ancestral capacity through Fire imagery, fear, symbolic or ambiguous memory, lineage recognition, or other Mirror-generated material. Her Fire doesn't become objectively active during Challenge Five or its aftermath; she leaves the Mirror still operating through her Frost-dominant configuration. Material inside the Mirror isn't automatically an objective recovered memory. Her first objective Fire manifestation stays in the Challenge Six climax, after her established Frost pathway catastrophically fails or becomes unavailable and her broader capacity reroutes through the expression modern Remnia calls Fire.

What the ruling does to *FTE 31–39*. The rewrite rule is simple: whatever the Mirror shows her, Katherine walks out with Frost and only Frost.

DEVELOPMENT MATERIAL	CHAPTER	UNDER THE RULING	KEEP AS
Heat in her palm while drowning at ten; the lake turning gold	34	Literal childhood Fire use is removed	Mirror imagery of undetermined truth; it can't establish that she used Fire at ten
Mirror-Atlas strips her Frost; "I can wield fire"	36	Mirror-generated	Fear and foreshadowing; a possible echo of the climax's Frost failure
Mirror-Atlas's cold severing her Frost emblems	36	Mirror-generated	Foreshadowing only

DEVELOPMENT MATERIAL	CHAPTER	UNDER THE RULING	KEEP AS
Scorch marks on the chamber floor after the mask comes off	36	Real-world Fire before Challenge Six; removed	Rewrite as something that stays within Frost or stays ambiguous
Blue and orange flickering in her hands; frost and fire from her palms	36–37, 39	Dual-element casting before the climax; removed	—
Flamer emblems on her wrists forty-eight hours later	38	Persistent Flamer marks; removed	—
The war room: Katherine as "a Dyad," "There are two of you"	38	Katherine as Zephyr's kind of Dyad; removed	Zephyr's exposure to the team may survive only with a different trigger ○ OPEN
Her ice answering Melena's grief at the Naming	32	Frost only	Compatible as recognition (IV.13)

The Mirror material is still valuable. It shows the reader what Katherine is afraid of before the climax makes it real, which is what foreshadowing is for.

◇ CONFLICT

Zephyr's registration.

The Placements file registers Zephyr as a Flamer. *31–39* ch. 38 describes his Frost emblem as old, "maybe as old as Zephyr himself," and the Flamer marks as new. Both are Supporting. Which element is his birth registration?

NOT THE SAME AS

Katherine's Frost "reaching" toward Melena across the lava field (ch. 15), and her ice answering Melena's grief in *31–39* ch. 32, are recognition, not Fire and not proof. Under TCD-050 they may reinforce suspicion; under TCD-049 they may not create or explain Fire.

IV.10 · KATHERINE'S ELEMENTAL ANATOMY

CONTINUED

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · KATHERINE'S EXPRESSION ARCHITECTURE · ○ OPEN

FIXED
One capacity, Frost-dominant, Fire by rerouting after catastrophic Frost failure in the climax; no objective Fire before the Challenge Six climax, with Heart's Mirror as foreshadowing only (author ruling, 2026-09-26); no established suppression; Zephyr a true Dyad (TCD-049, TCD-058).

UNDECIDED
The objective name for what she is; the ancient norm it reverts to; which parent it comes from; the exact climax beat that breaks her Frost; whether she can switch back or use both; the cost; what the Sanctum's tests show; whether Frost survives the reroute at all.

WHY IT MATTERS
The Frost failure and the Fire reroute are the decisive state's engine. If they're vague, Katherine's Conqueror title is vague.

DECIDE BY
The exact failure beat before the Duel is drafted.

WORKING SPACE · KATHERINE'S EXPRESSION ARCHITECTURE

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-036, TCD-049, TCD-050, TCD-058; FTE Beta chs. 7, 12, 16–18; 49th Placements; FTE 31–39 chs. 32, 34, 36–39; author ruling, 2026-09-26. Record: Katherine Elemental Classification + Expression Architecture.*

SEE ALSO II.6 Crossblood: A Label, Not a Biology · **p.35**
II.15 Recurring Institutional Misreadings · **p.45** IV.5 Elemental Magic · **p.65**
IV.24 FTE Endgame Packet · **p.187**

IV.10 KATHERINE VS ZEPHYR

Replace the Dyad label with the ruled anatomy.

	KATHERINE NICHOLAS	ZEPHYR
CLASSIFICATION	● CANON One less-specialized ancestral capacity TCD-049 · TCD-058	● CANON Modern Fire/Frost Dyad TCD-049
DOMINANT	● CANON Frost, from childhood TCD-058	
FIRE	● CANON Rerouted expression after catastrophic Frost failure, in the Challenge Six climax TCD-058 · author ruling 2026-09-26	● CANON One of two modern channels TCD-049 ◩ SUPPORTED Since thirteen, after a training accident FTE 31–39
ON-PAGE BASELINE	■ DRAFTED The Examination: severe Fire trauma still producing Frost Beta ch. 7	■ DRAFTED Tundra: "orange fire edged with blue" in one hand, something else in the other; Melena sees both elements (ch. 18); Katherine sees them (ch. 17) Beta chs. 17–18
SUPPRESSION	● CANON No established magical suppression TCD-058	
SANCTUM'S LABEL	● CANON "Dyad": the Sanctum's incomplete diagnosis TCD-049	● CANON "Dyad": correct TCD-049
REGISTERED AS	■ DRAFTED Frost Beta	◇ CONFLICT Flamer (Placements) vs a Frost emblem older than the Flamer marks (31–39 ch. 38) 49th Placements · FTE 31–39

	KATHERINE NICHOLAS	ZEPHYR
OPEN	○ OPEN Objective name; exact climax failure beat; later switching and simultaneous use; costs; inheritance side	

Zephyr's column is filled only where a source speaks (IV.10, IV.9). Ruled cells are yours: fill them from the controlling source on the next page.

Ancestral capacity → **Organized around Frost** → **Frost configuration fails** → **Reroutes to Fire**

● CANON WHAT'S RULED

The Sanctum would call Katherine a Dyad. It'd be wrong. Zephyr is a modern Fire/Frost Dyad; Katherine is one older, less-specialized capacity that organized itself around Frost. Fire isn't a second channel waiting behind a door. It's where the capacity reroutes when the Frost configuration fails.

TCD-036 · 049 · 058 · DRAFTED: FTE Official Beta Reader Copy · RECORD: Katherine Elemental Classification + Expression Architecture

○ OPEN

QUESTION TO CARRY INTO THE DRAFT

Where does the Frost configuration fail on the page, and what does the reader see before Fire arrives?

TIED TO
Open · exact climax failure beat
p.92

IV.10 THE RECORD

■ DRAFTED

1 · THE BASELINE ON THE PAGE

List every drafted moment where Frost holds under pressure, with chapter. Start with the Beta Examination.

TIED TO
Beta Examination: severe Fire trauma still producing Frost

CH.	MOMENT	WHAT IT SHOWS

TO FILL

2 · COMPLETE ZEPHYR'S COLUMN

Fill the fields the reference page leaves open, from the controlling source. Mark each claim's status and cite the chapter. Registration is a live conflict: record the evidence, not a guess.

TIED TO
Zephyr column
p.87

FIELD	ZEPHYR	STATUS	CH.
DOMINANT		☐ C ☐ D ☐ S	
SUPPRESSION		☐ C ☐ D ☐ S	
REGISTERED AS	◇ **CONFLICT** Placements: Flamer · 31–39 ch. 38: Frost emblem older	☐ C ☐ D ☐ S	
OPEN		☐ C ☐ D ☐ S	

SOURCE FTE Official Beta Reader Copy · FTE Elemental Factions · 49th Placements

NOTES · THE RECORD

NOTES · IV.10

IV.10 THE FAILURE BEAT

● CANON

WHAT'S RULED

Ancestral capacity → Organized around Frost → Frost configuration fails → Reroutes to Fire

TCD-049 · TCD-058 author ruling 2026-09-26

p.87

○ OPEN

1 · WHERE IN THE CLIMAX

Where in the Challenge Six climax does the Frost configuration fail? Name the chapter and what the scene is fighting over when it happens.

TIED TO TCD-058 · author ruling 2026-09-26

IV.24 · p.187

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

2 · BEFORE FIRE ARRIVES

What does the reader see before Fire arrives? Build the failure from the Frost side: what holds, what slips, what breaks.

TIED TO Frost configuration fails → reroutes to Fire

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.10 DRAFT THE BEAT

● CANON

3 · WHAT THE BEAT MUST NOT IMPLY

Fire isn't a second channel waiting behind a door. No established magical suppression is lifting. Note any drafted line that implies either.

TIED TO
TCD-049 · TCD-058
Suppression row
p.87

○ OPEN

4 · THE BEAT, IN SCENE ORDER

Draft or outline the failure beat here, from the last moment Frost holds to the first moment Fire answers.

TIED TO
Open · exact climax failure beat

DECISION RECORD

STATUS ☐ C ☐ P ☐ ? ☐ X ☐ R DECIDED _____ LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ AFFECTED PAGES _____

When drafted prose deliberately changes an entry, the entry changes.

IV.10 OPEN ANATOMY

○ OPEN

5 · OBJECTIVE NAME

The Sanctum's label is incomplete. What is the capacity actually called, and who in the story could know that name?

TIED TO
Open · objective name

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

6 · LATER SWITCHING AND SIMULTANEOUS USE

After the reroute, can she move between Frost and Fire, or hold both at once? What would the page have to show first for either to read as earned?

TIED TO
Open · later switching and simultaneous use

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

7 · COSTS

What does the reroute cost her, and when does the reader first see the cost?

TIED TO
Open · costs

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.10 LABEL AND LINEAGE

● CANON

8 · WHO REPEATS THE LABEL

The Sanctum's "Dyad" is an incomplete diagnosis. Who in FTE repeats it, and where does the text let it stand uncorrected?

TIED TO
TCD-049 · TCD-058
II.6 · p.35
II.15 · p.45

○ OPEN

9 · INHERITANCE SIDE

Which side of her lineage carries the ancestral capacity? Check the five layers in IV.11 (Biological, Legal, Recorded, Public, Succession) before deciding.

TIED TO
Open · inheritance side
IV.11 · p.98
IV.11 · p.102

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

NOTES

WHAT THIS ENTRY STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH

Carry anything unresolved to the Open Canon Queue with a date.

VII.12 → FTE concordance · p.216

IV.11 LINEAGE: BIOLOGY, LAW, RECORD, SUCCESSION

Keep four kinds of "family" in four columns.

One fact about Katherine's family is settled, and it doesn't settle anything else. Tobias Lockwood is the shared biological father of Katherine Nicholas and Melena Lockwood. Katherine's biological parents are Michelle Nicholas and Tobias; Melena's are Lucia Hastings-Lockwood and Tobias. They are paternal half-sisters. ● CANON TCD-040. That truth doesn't independently establish Katherine's legal status, her records, her legitimacy, her title, her succession rights, or what the public knows.

So the Companion keeps five layers apart, and every scene touching Katherine's parentage should know which layer it's operating in.

LAYER	QUESTION	CURRENT ANSWER	STATUS
Biological	Who are her parents?	Michelle and Tobias	● CANON TCD-040
Legal	What is she under Remnian law: legitimate, illegitimate, royal, not royal?	Not ruled	○ OPEN
Recorded	What do the documents say, and who holds them?	The Sanctum is principal custodian of the records (TCD-059); their contents aren't ruled	○ OPEN
Public	What do ordinary Remnians know?	Not ruled; sources conflict (IV.12)	○ OPEN
Succession	Does she have any claim?	Not ruled	○ OPEN

THE LOCKWOOD FAMILY, SOURCE BY SOURCE.

PERSON	WHAT'S ESTABLISHED	SUPPORTING DETAIL	STATUS
Aracelia	Empress; reigns during FTE; Melena's grandmother	Beta letter: "Aracelia Meson Mignonette, Empress of the Remian Empire"; *31–39*: "Empress Aracelia Lockwood"; *Welcome*: Hastings line, matrilineal succession Eden → Aracelia → Lucia → Elias	Name ◇ CONFLICT

PERSON	WHAT'S ESTABLISHED	SUPPORTING DETAIL	STATUS
Lucia Hastings-Lockwood	Crown Princess; Melena's mother; dead before FTE; originated Katherine's public and legal erasure ● CANON TCD-059	*31–39*: died in a car accident; *Remnian Timeline Before Story Start*: a "nighttime medical crisis" at the Imperial Palace, 7 Sept 2094. Beta ch. 8: "one of the most powerful" Frosts in the empire; 31–39 calls her a Flamer (revision flag)	Cause of death ◇ CONFLICT
Tobias Lockwood	Father of both sisters ● CANON TCD-040; dead before FTE	*Character Bible*: Prince Consort; *31–39*: died six months after Lucia, officially a fall on wet stairs, which Melena believes was suicide; in the Mirror he calls himself a Frost, against the Beta's Melena who "took after their father — fire running through her veins" (ch. 8)	All ◩ SUPPORTED
Elias Lockwood	Eldest; Crown Prince; lives a second life as Professor Alexander Thorne ● CANON TCD-032	Beta: "never the same after his Tournament"	● CANON / ■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Melena	Second in line ("the Lockwood second-in-line," Beta)	—	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Cordelia	Seventeen; crimson hair and amber eyes like Melena's (Beta)	*31–39*: prepared to take the crown	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Louis	Youngest	—	◩ SUPPORTED

◇ CONFLICT

Melena's eyes, now with more evidence.

The Beta gives her "Lockwood amber eyes" and says Cordelia shares them. 3SL gives her green. *FTE 31–39* has Tobias's eyes "the same shade as hers" and green. The *Character Bible* says emerald. The *Remnian Timeline Before Story Start* says green "associated with the Hastings lineage" and gives Elias golden Lockwood eyes; the unaudited *Imperial Lineage* repeats it. The Companion preserves the conflict (III.20). The Beta controls FTE's drafted page; nobody has ruled which book changes.

REVISION FLAG (DEVELOPMENT CHAPTERS)

The parents' elements.

One Mirror line in *31–39* makes Tobias a Frost and Lucia a Flamer. The Beta has it the other way round: Lucia was "one of the most powerful" Frosts in the empire, Cordelia inherited her Frost ("Second generation"), and Melena "took after their father — fire running through her veins instead of ice" (ch. 8). The Beta controls; the Mirror lines need revising. Neither version says which side Katherine's ancestral capacity comes from (TCD-049). A parent's element isn't evidence of an inherited anatomy.

Succession as the sources frame it. *Welcome to Remnia* describes a strictly matrilineal Hastings succession and a Crown that named Elias heir after Lucia's death to preserve its image. *31–39* has a Privy Council push Elias into the role. The *Remnian Timeline Before Story Start* (repeated in the unaudited *Imperial Lineage*) has Lucia decree at Melena's birth that daughters keep their place ahead of younger brothers. None of this is ruled. The one drafted fact is that Melena is second in line.

GUARDRAIL

Proving Tobias's paternity (IV.13) doesn't make Katherine a princess, a Lockwood, or an heir. Each of those is a separate decision, and some of them are the Crown's to make in-story.

SOURCE

TCD-032, TCD-040, TCD-049, TCD-059; FTE Beta front matter, chs. 2, 8, 12; Welcome to Remnia; Character Bible; FTE 31–39 chs. 31, 33, 35; FTE Remnian Timeline Before Story Start; FTE Remnian Timeline Early; FTE 2025 FINAL and Full 4 Series Flesh Out (legacy, corroboration only); The Imperial Lineage (unaudited, comparison only). Record: Remnian Royal Lineage (the working record follows this section) + Katherine Secrecy/Concealment Architecture.

IV.11 · LINEAGE: BIOLOGY, LAW, RECORD, SUCCESSION

CONTINUED

SEE ALSO III.20 3SL Open Development → FTE concordance · **p.216**

IV.12 Katherine's Concealment · **p.150**

VII.1 Master Synchronization Timeline → FTE concordance · **p.216**

NOTES · IV.11

WORKING RECORD · 1 OF 48 · REMNIAN IMPERIAL + ROYAL LINEAGE

IV.11 REMNIAN LINEAGE: THE WORKING RECORD

Rebuilt from the evidence, 2026-10-09. A derived record, not a source.

This record rebuilds the Remnian imperial and royal lineage from the sources, claim by claim. Each line names the source it comes from and carries the status that source earns under the authority order: rulings, then the Beta, then current author decisions, development, reference, shared lore, supporting artifacts, and legacy. It isn't a source itself, and it settles nothing a ruling leaves open.

Five layers stay apart, as IV.11 requires: biological, legal family status, public and recorded, title, and succession. A parent never fills a succession slot, and a title never proves a parent. Where two sources disagree, both stay on the page with their sources, and the disagreement gets a number (LC-nn) and a working block in lane D.

LOCKED ANCHOR · ● CANON TCD-040

Tobias Lockwood is the biological father of Katherine (with Michelle Nicholas) and of Melena (with Lucia Hastings-Lockwood). Katherine and Melena are paternal half-sisters.

That doesn't make Katherine legally acknowledged, a Lockwood by law, a princess, publicly known, or an heir. TCD-059 governs the concealment only.

GUARDRAIL

Agreement between two weak sources isn't canon. Two timelines that agree are still two timelines.

IN THIS RECORD

	PART	PAGE
A	Genealogy spread: the imperial line; London Town	p.106
B	Lineage ledger, by person and layer; collateral lines; name checks	p.108–125
C	Succession lane: current and historical, kept apart from the tree	p.126–128

	PART	PAGE
D	Open and conflict lane: the conflict ledger, then working space for each decision	p.129–136

SOURCE KEY · AUTHORITY TREATMENT IN THIS RECORD

LABEL	FILE · AVAILABILITY	AUTHORITY IN THIS RECORD
Beta	**FTE Official Beta Reader Copy** Not in this session; its lineage facts are taken as the Content Master records them, with chapter.	Controlling FTE prose (TCD-001). Statuses: CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT.
31–39	**FTE 31–39 (development chapters)** Through the Content Master. The uploaded FTE 2025 FINAL file contains the same passages.	Supporting; rewrite required before any line is canon (TCD-001).
BSS	**FTE Remnian Timeline Before Story Start** Uploaded 2026-10-09; read in full.	Historical/development pool, claim by claim. Latest expanded ER generation; Supporting / needs ruling (audit). Never controls chronology (TCD-010).
TLE	**FTE Remnian Timeline Early** Uploaded 2026-10-09; read in full (it ends in 2066 ER).	Earlier pool for genealogy, old succession and names; every later source outranks it. Claims only it makes are LEGACY until separately supported (audit).
F2025	**FTE 2025 FINAL** Uploaded 2026-10-09; searched for every lineage passage.	Legacy prose (TCD-001). Corroboration only; never establishes a claim.
F4	**Full 4 Series Flesh Out** Uploaded 2026-10-09; searched for every lineage passage.	Shared lore pool / legacy recovery source (TCD-022). Claim by claim; cross-series mechanisms are not imported.
CB	**Character Bible** Not in this session; through the Content Master.	Supporting by claim (audit). Its Michelle/Tobias and Lucia/Tobias parentage is confirmed by TCD-040.
WTR	**Welcome to Remnia** Not in this session; through the Content Master.	Supporting.
3SL	**3 Shadowmere Lane draft** Through the Content Master.	Controlling 3SL prose.
Placements	**49th Placements** Through the Content Master.	Supporting.

IV.11 · LINEAGE RECORD

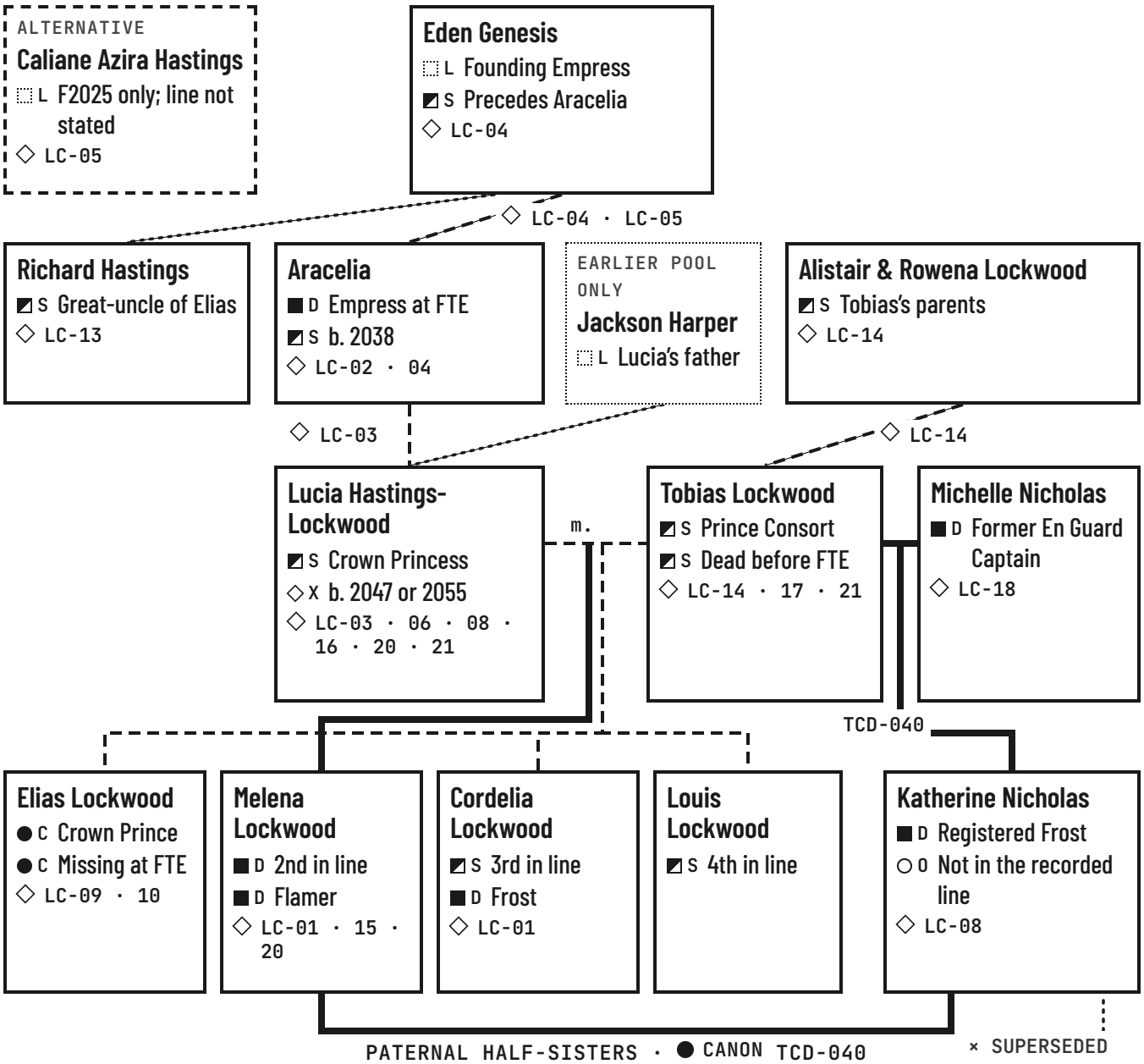
CONTINUED

LABEL	FILE · AVAILABILITY	AUTHORITY IN THIS RECORD
IL	**The Imperial Lineage (unaudited)** Not in this session; the Content Master quotes it.	Comparison only. Not imported.
TCD-nnn	**Canon Decision Log rulings** Audit, Sep 26, 2026 (Appendix A).	Highest authority. The only route to CANON.

Status words: DRAFTED = CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT; LEGACY = LEGACY / SUPERSEDED. In the genealogy, each line in a box carries a status letter: ● C ■ D ◪ S ◌ P ○ O ◇ X ⬚ L.

NOTES · IV.11

IV.11 THE IMPERIAL LINE



KEY

CANON link (ruling) ——— DRAFTED link

SUPPORTED link - - - - LEGACY / earlier pool only

◇ LC-nn: conflict, see D

● C ■ D ◩ S ◌ P ○ O ◇ X L status of each line in a box

alternative person earlier pool only

SUPERSEDED LINK

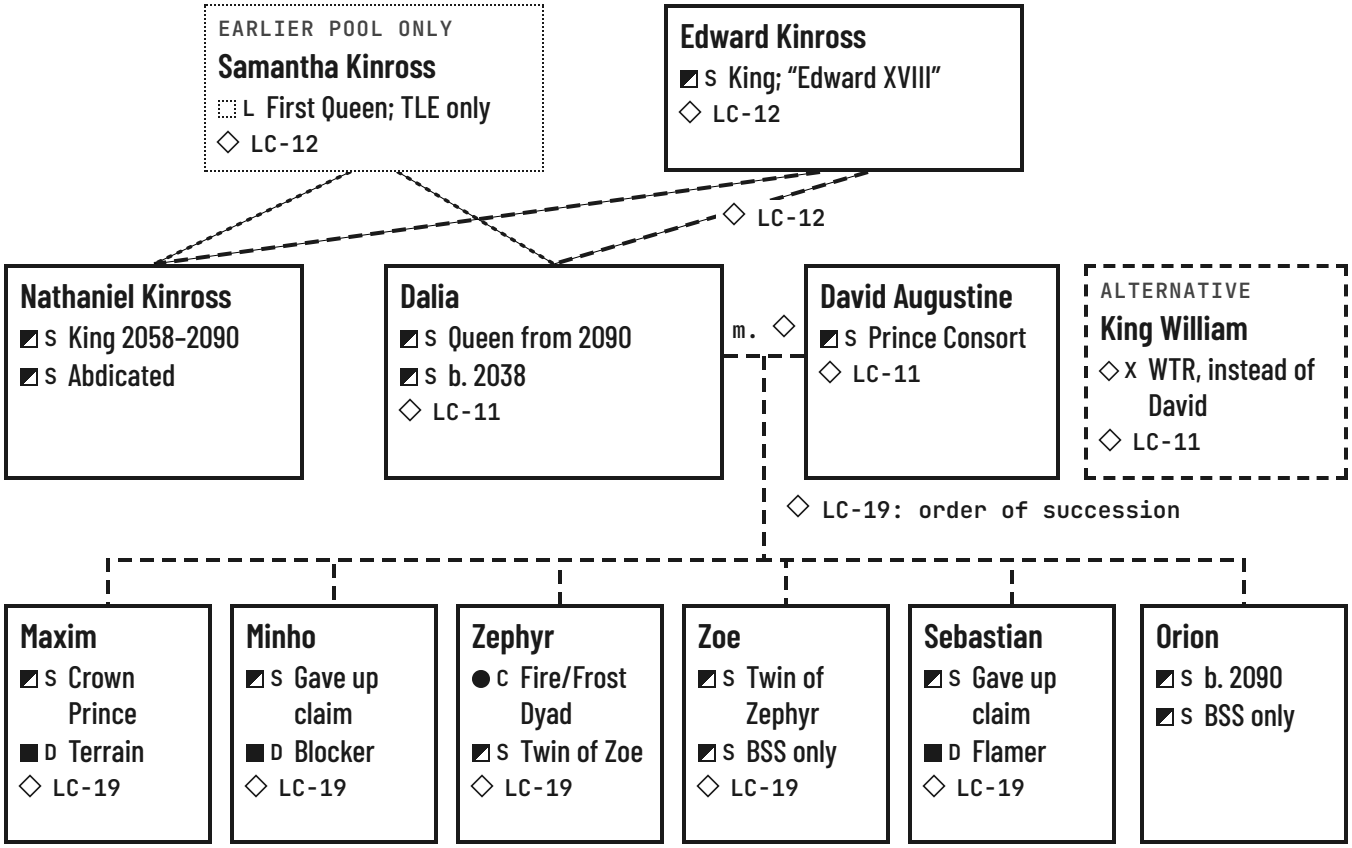
Ethan

◇ X Medina or Nicholas

L Bio. father: superseded

◇ LC-18

IV.11 LONDON TOWN



Arielle Monet Kinross
◩ S The Princess Royal
○ O Parent not named · 0-05

KEY

CANON link (ruling) — DRAFTED link
SUPPORTED link — LEGACY / earlier pool only
◇ LC-nn: conflict, see D
● C ■ D ◩ S ◌ P ○ O ◇ X ⬚ L status of each line in a box
[ ] alternative person ⬚ earlier pool only

The tree shows parentage only. Who rules and who is next is in lane C, and nothing in the tree is evidence for it. Collateral lines that only the earlier timeline records (Eden's other children, Lucia's sisters, Dalia's sisters) are in the ledger, not the tree.

IV.11 LINEAGE LEDGER

Every claim, by person and layer, with its source and status.

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
Eden Genesis HOUSE · Hastings (also styled Mignonette) · also Eden Genesis Hastings (TLE); Eden Mignonette / Migonnette (TLE); Eden Genesis (BSS)				
BIOLOGICAL Spouse	Stephen Abraham Hastings, Emperor Consort	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	
BIOLOGICAL Children	Richard, Madeleine, Victoria, and the twins Aracelia and Alexandria	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	Richard and Alexandria are also in BSS; their parentage there is not stated.
BIOLOGICAL Death	“Deceased for decades” by 2091	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	LC-04: the same file has her reigning and blessing Lucia’s decree in 2073–76
BIOLOGICAL Generation	Elias’s grandmother (BSS 2073) vs great-grandmother (TLE, WTR line)	◇ CONFLICT	BSS · TLE · WTR	LC-04
TITLE Public title	Founding Empress of Remnia (Year 1 ER)	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	
SUCCESSION Dynastic position	Predecessor of Aracelia on the throne; matrilineal line Eden → Aracelia → Lucia → Elias	◩ SUPPORTED	WTR · TLE	LC-04
Caliane Azira Hastings HOUSE · Hastings				
BIOLOGICAL Generation	Melena’s great-grandmother	◇ CONFLICT	F2025	LC-05: TLE and WTR put Eden in that place
TITLE Public title	Empress; signed the Tournament augmentation law	~~LEGACY~~	F2025	

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
Aracelia HOUSE · Hastings (house) · surname in conflict · also Aracelia Meson Mignonette; Aracelia Mignonette Hastings; Aracelia Meson Mignonette Hastings; Aracelia Lockwood (31–39)				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Empress Eden and Emperor Consort Stephen	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	Matrilineal Eden → Aracelia in WTR
BIOLOGICAL Born	7 October 2038, elder twin of Alexandria	◪ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS	BSS gives her age as 57 in 2095; it agrees with TLE. Not canon (TCD-010).
BIOLOGICAL Spouse	Duke Jackson Harper (married 9 Sept 2060)	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	No later source names her husband
BIOLOGICAL Children	Lucia (with Charlotte, twins), Elaine, Arianne	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	Lucia as her daughter is supported: BSS calls the Lockwood children her grandchildren; WTR line
BIOLOGICAL Element	Frost (attunement shown 2060)	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	
PUBLIC / RECORDED Grandmother of the Lockwood heirs	Melena's grandmother; guardianship orders for the children after Lucia's death (11 Sept 2094)	■ DRAFTED	Beta · BSS	Grandmother: Beta. Guardianship orders: BSS only (SUPPORTED).
PUBLIC / RECORDED Knowledge of Katherine	Not ruled	○ OPEN	TCD-059	Aracelia's role in the concealment is open
TITLE Public title	Empress; reigns during FTE	■ DRAFTED	Beta	

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
TITLE Styled name	“Aracelia Meson Mignonette” (Beta letter) · “Aracelia Meson Mignonette Hastings” (BSS) · “Aracelia Mignonette Hastings” (TLE) · “Empress Aracelia Lockwood” (31–39)	◇ CONFLICT	Beta · BSS · TLE · 31–39	LC-02
SUCCESSION Dynastic position	Reigning Empress at FTE opening	■ DRAFTED	Beta	
SUCCESSION Accession	Reigned while Lucia preceded Elias in succession	● CANON	TCD-032	Accession date OPEN (LC-04)
Jackson Harper HOUSE · Harper · also Duke Jackson Hastings (TLE, once)				
BIOLOGICAL Spouse	Aracelia (married 2060)	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	
BIOLOGICAL Children	Lucia, Charlotte, Elaine, Arianne	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	
TITLE Public title	Duke; styled “The Crown Prince” on marriage	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	
Richard David Elliot Hastings HOUSE · Hastings · also Richard David Elliot (TLE)				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Empress Eden and Emperor Consort Stephen (eldest child)	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	
BIOLOGICAL Relation	Elias’s and Louis’s great-uncle; “the only male born into a line of powerful sisters”	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	Consistent with TLE (Aracelia’s brother)
BIOLOGICAL Spouse	Princess Ember	◩ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Children	Olympia (2058), Estelle (2059)	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	
BIOLOGICAL Born	3 September 2024 (TLE) vs about 2039 (BSS: 55 in 2094)	◇ CONFLICT	TLE · BSS	LC-13
LEGAL FAMILY Guardianship	Files for Elias’s guardianship (2094); granted guardianship of Louis (11 Sept 2094)	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
TITLE Public title	Prince; Crown Prince at birth (TLE)	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	Displaced as heir by Aracelia in 2055 (TLE)
Alexandria Melena Mignonette HOUSE · Hastings (by marriage to Clyde Hastings)				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Empress Eden and Emperor Consort Stephen; younger twin of Aracelia	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	
BIOLOGICAL Spouse	Lord Clyde Hastings (d. Nov 2096)	◪ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Children	Amalia Danyelle (b. 2 May 2062), Evangeline Kelly (b. 4 Aug 2063)	◪ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS	BSS ages (34, 33 in 2096) match TLE
TITLE Public title	Princess of Remnia, Duchess of Alleia	◪ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS	
Lucia Noelle Marie Hastings-Lockwood HOUSE · Hastings; Lockwood by marriage · also Lucia Hastings (BSS 2073); Lucia Noelle Marie (TLE)				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Aracelia and Jackson Harper	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	Aracelia as mother: SUPPORTED (BSS, WTR)
BIOLOGICAL Born	2047 (BSS: 47 at death) vs 26 October 2055 (TLE)	◇ CONFLICT	BSS · TLE	LC-03
BIOLOGICAL Spouse	Tobias Lockwood, Prince Consort	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS · CB	
BIOLOGICAL Children	Melena (with Tobias)	● CANON	TCD-040	
BIOLOGICAL Children	Elias, Cordelia, Louis (with Tobias)	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	Elias, Cordelia and Louis as Lucia's children are also the Beta's family (Melena's siblings)

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
BIOLOGICAL Element	Frost: “one of the most powerful” in the empire	■ DRAFTED	Beta	31–39 makes her a Flamer: REVISION FLAG (LC-21)
BIOLOGICAL Death	Dead before FTE	■ DRAFTED	Beta	
BIOLOGICAL Death · when, how	7 Sept 2094, Imperial Palace, “nighttime medical crisis” (BSS) vs a car accident (31–39)	◇ CONFLICT	BSS · 31–39	LC-16
LEGAL FAMILY Act	Originated Katherine’s public/legal and dynastic erasure	● CANON	TCD-059	
LEGAL FAMILY Act (as drafted in BSS)	Treason decree on discussion of Katherine’s birth; legal action leaving her no claim; forbade her raising in London Town	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	Mechanism SUPPORTED only; publicity OPEN (LC-08)
LEGAL FAMILY Act (as drafted in BSS)	2076 decree: daughters keep their place regardless of younger brothers	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	LC-06
TITLE Public title	Crown Princess; “Duchess of Zenithia”	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	Crown Princess also CB, WTR; Zenithia title: LC-20
TITLE Earlier style	The Princess Imperial (from birth, 2055)	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	
SUCCESSION Position	Heir to Aracelia; preceded Elias	● CANON	TCD-032	
Alistair Lockwood HOUSE · Lockwood				
BIOLOGICAL Children	Tobias	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Spouse	Duchess Rowena Lockwood	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
BIOLOGICAL Born	About 2027 (67 in 2094)	◇ CONFLICT	BSS	LC-14: about eight at Tobias's TLE birth date
LEGAL FAMILY Guardianship	Petitions for Elias (July 2094, delayed by the Sanctum); granted Cordelia with Rowena (11 Sept 2094)	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
TITLE Public title	Duke	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
Rowena Lockwood HOUSE · Lockwood				
BIOLOGICAL Spouse · children	Alistair Lockwood · Tobias	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
TITLE Public title	Duchess	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
Tobias Lockwood HOUSE · Lockwood				
BIOLOGICAL Children	Katherine (with Michelle Nicholas) and Melena (with Lucia)	● CANON	TCD-040	LOCKED ANCHOR
BIOLOGICAL Children	Elias, Cordelia, Louis (with Lucia)	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Duke Alistair and Duchess Rowena Lockwood	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Born	2 August 2035, Lockwood Manor, Highcrest	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	LC-14
BIOLOGICAL Element	Fire, by implication: Melena "took after their father — fire running through her veins"	■ DRAFTED	Beta	31-39 Mirror: Tobias calls himself a Frost (REVISION FLAG, LC-21)
BIOLOGICAL Death	Dead before FTE	◪ SUPPORTED	CB · 31-39	
BIOLOGICAL Death · when, how	Six months after Lucia; officially a fall on wet stairs; Melena believes suicide	◪ SUPPORTED	31-39	LC-17: BSS never places him in 2094-96

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
LEGAL FAMILY Marriage	Lucia's husband; Prince Consort	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS · CB	
LEGAL FAMILY Role in Katherine's concealment	Cooperates by non-acknowledgment; not established as the architect	● CANON	TCD-059	
PUBLIC / RECORDED Relationship with Michelle	"Tried to make it work for years"; Dalia was one of three people who knew	◪ SUPPORTED	31–39	F2025 has the same passage
TITLE Public title	Prince Consort	◪ SUPPORTED	CB · BSS	TLE styles him "Head of the Lockwood House" from birth (LEGACY; LC-14)
Celeste (Tobias's late aunt) HOUSE · Lockwood side · surname not given				
BIOLOGICAL Relation	Tobias's aunt, dead by 2076; Katherine's middle name honours her	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	Not Lady Celeste Blackwood: NV-02
Elias Louis Alexander Lockwood HOUSE · Lockwood				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Lucia and Tobias	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS · WTR	Melena's brother (Beta); full parentage not ruled
BIOLOGICAL Born	3 October 2073, Imperial Palace, London Town	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	Calendar unruled (TCD-010)
BIOLOGICAL Eyes	Golden, "associated with the Lockwood lineage"	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	IL repeats it
PUBLIC / RECORDED Status at FTE	Missing from Remnia: failed to return on pattern; Professor Alexander Thorne in Somnoria	● CANON	TCD-032 · TCD-013	

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
TITLE Public title	Crown Prince, after Lucia's death	● CANON	TCD-032	
TITLE Title at birth	"Crown Prince of Remnia" from 2073	~~LEGACY~~	BSS	Superseded by TCD-032 (LC-09)
TITLE Public title	Duke of Somnoria, the heir apparent's "traditional title"	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	LC-09, LC-10
SUCCESSION Position	First in line (heir apparent) at FTE opening	● CANON	TCD-032	
Melena Elizabeth Beatrix Lockwood HOUSE · Lockwood				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Lucia Hastings-Lockwood and Tobias Lockwood	● CANON	TCD-040	LOCKED ANCHOR
BIOLOGICAL Relation to Katherine	Paternal half-sister	● CANON	TCD-040	
BIOLOGICAL Born	9 Sept 2076 (BSS) vs 2077 (CB); age unstated in the Beta	◇ CONFLICT	BSS · CB	LC-15
BIOLOGICAL Element	Flamer; volatile	■ DRAFTED	Beta	
BIOLOGICAL Eyes	Amber (Beta) vs green (3SL, BSS, CB, 31–39)	◇ CONFLICT	Beta · 3SL · BSS · CB · 31–39	LC-01
LEGAL FAMILY Guardianship	Granted to Lorelei and Lady Helena's household (11 Sept 2094)	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
PUBLIC / RECORDED Knows Katherine is her sister	Nothing on the page in chs. 1–29	■ DRAFTED	Beta	
TITLE Public title	Princess	■ DRAFTED	Beta	
TITLE Further title	Duchess of Avalon	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	No province of that name in TLE's seventeen (LC-20)

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
SUCCESSION Position	Second in line, after Elias	■ DRAFTED	Beta	
Cordelia Gwendolyn Marie Lockwood HOUSE · Lockwood				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Lucia and Tobias	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	Melena's sister (Beta)
BIOLOGICAL Born	2 September 2079	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	Beta: seventeen at FTE. Consistent.
BIOLOGICAL Element	Frost, inherited from Lucia ("Second generation")	■ DRAFTED	Beta	
BIOLOGICAL Eyes · hair	Amber eyes and crimson hair, like Melena's	■ DRAFTED	Beta	LC-01
LEGAL FAMILY Guardianship	Granted to Duke Alistair and Duchess Rowena Lockwood (11 Sept 2094)	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
TITLE Public title	Princess of Remnia	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
SUCCESSION Position	Third in line	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	Consistent with the Beta's Melena second
Louis Reginald Henry Lockwood HOUSE · Lockwood · also Louis Reginal Henry (BSS, once)				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Lucia and Tobias	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Born	14 May 2081	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	The youngest (CM: SUPPORTED)
LEGAL FAMILY Guardianship	Granted to Prince Richard Hastings, his great-uncle (11 Sept 2094)	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
TITLE Public title	Prince of Remnia	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
SUCCESSION Position	Fourth in line	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
Michelle Nicholas HOUSE · Nicholas				
BIOLOGICAL Children	Katherine (with Tobias Lockwood)	● CANON	TCD-040	LOCKED ANCHOR
BIOLOGICAL Family	Her maternal grandmother is the “Medina” of Katherine’s name	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	LC-18
LEGAL FAMILY Role in the concealment	Raises and protects Katherine inside imposed constraints; not the architect	● CANON	TCD-059	
PUBLIC / RECORDED Who knew of her and Tobias	Queen Dalia was one of three people who knew of the relationship	◪ SUPPORTED	31–39	Whether Dalia knows Katherine is Tobias’s child is unstated
TITLE Rank	Lieutenant; former Captain of the En Guard, stepped down two months before ch. 1	■ DRAFTED	Beta	BSS: Captain of the En Guard in 2076
Ethan HOUSE · surname in conflict · also Ethan Medina (WTR); Ethan Nicholas (TLE); Ethan (F2025)				
BIOLOGICAL Katherine’s biological father	Superseded	~~LEGACY~~	TCD-040	
BIOLOGICAL Born	18 Nov 2035, Nicholas Estate, Meridion; “Head of the Nicholas House”	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	
LEGAL FAMILY Social or naming role	“Gave Katherine his name” (WTR); sits beside Michelle as “her father, Ethan” (F2025)	◌ POSSIBLE	WTR · F2025	No ruling (CM IV.9)
TITLE Surname	Medina (WTR) vs Nicholas (TLE)	◇ CONFLICT	WTR · TLE	LC-18
Katherine Medina Celeste Nicholas HOUSE · Nicholas				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Michelle Nicholas and Tobias Lockwood	● CANON	TCD-040	LOCKED ANCHOR

IV.11 · LINEAGE RECORD

CONTINUED

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
BIOLOGICAL Relation to Melena	Paternal half-sister	● CANON	TCD-040	
BIOLOGICAL Born	2076 (CB); 14 July 2076, Military Hospital, Old Prosperity (BSS)	◪ SUPPORTED	CB · BSS	Before Melena in both sources: O-01
BIOLOGICAL Element	Registered Frost; objectively one ancestral capacity, Frost-dominant, Fire by later reroute	● CANON	Beta · TCD-049 · TCD-058	Registered Frost: DRAFTED. Which parent the capacity comes from: OPEN
LEGAL FAMILY Legal status	Not ruled: legitimacy, name at law, royal or not	○ OPEN	TCD-040	Biology settles none of it
LEGAL FAMILY Name on her orders	Corporal Katherine Medina Celeste Nicholas	■ DRAFTED	Beta	BSS gives the same full name
LEGAL FAMILY Erasure	Public/legal and dynastic erasure originated by Lucia / the Lockwood Crown; the Sanctum enforces and keeps the records	● CANON	TCD-059	
PUBLIC / RECORDED Public knowledge	Not ruled; sources conflict	○ OPEN	TCD-059	LC-08
PUBLIC / RECORDED As BSS drafts it	“Highly publicized” birth; treason decree; 2091 Sanctum suppression order; “legally protected identity”	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	Not adopted (LC-08)
PUBLIC / RECORDED Knows Tobias is her father	Nothing on the page in chs. 1–29	■ DRAFTED	Beta	
TITLE Title	None. Not a princess, not a Lockwood by law	○ OPEN	TCD-040	Each is a separate decision

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
TITLE “Katherine Lockwood”	Legacy naming	~~LEGACY~~	F4	Rejected: R-01
SUCCESSION Position	Not in the recorded line; any claim at law not ruled	○ OPEN	TCD-040 · TCD-059	
SUCCESSION Named heir apparent (Book 3)	Legacy sequel plot	~~LEGACY~~	F4	Rejected: R-02
Samantha Ruby Kinross HOUSE · Kinross				
BIOLOGICAL Spouse	King Edward Kinross (2038 entry) vs King Brenton (2058 entry)	◇ CONFLICT	TLE	LC-12
BIOLOGICAL Children	Lauren, Angelica, Dalia, Nathaniel, Fallon	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	Dalia and Nathaniel as siblings: SUPPORTED (BSS)
TITLE Public title	First Queen of London Town; “what will later become the House of Augustine”	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	
Edward Kinross HOUSE · Kinross · also King Edward XVIII (BSS)				
BIOLOGICAL Children	Dalia, Nathaniel	◩ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS	BSS: Maxim’s maternal grandfather “King Edward XVIII”; Nathaniel is Dalia’s brother in both
TITLE Public title	King (of London Town)	◩ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS	LC-12
Nathaniel Reece Isaiah Kinross HOUSE · Kinross				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Queen Samantha and King Edward Kinross; Dalia’s younger brother	◩ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Born	24 November 2039	~~LEGACY~~	TLE	

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
LEGAL FAMILY Act	2090 decree: daughters keep their place regardless of birth order, if born to the Queen and Prince Consort	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	
TITLE Public title	King of London Town (from 2058, TLE) until his abdication (15 June 2090, BSS)	◩ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS	
Dalia Clementine Lexington HOUSE · Kinross (birth); Augustine (marriage) · also Dalia Clementine Lexington Kinross (BSS); Queen Dalia Augustine (WTR)				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Queen Samantha and King Edward Kinross	◩ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS	Edward: both. Samantha: TLE only
BIOLOGICAL Born	31 October 2038	◩ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS	BSS: 34 in 2072
BIOLOGICAL Spouse	David Augustine, Prince Consort (BSS, CB) vs King William (WTR)	◇ CONFLICT	BSS · CB · WTR	LC-11
BIOLOGICAL Children	Maxim, Minho, Zephyr and Zoe (twins), Sebastian, Orion	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	The four sons: Beta (Augustine brothers). Zoe and Orion: BSS only
PUBLIC / RECORDED Knowledge	Knew of Michelle and Tobias; whether she knows Katherine's paternity is unstated	◩ SUPPORTED	31–39	
TITLE Public title at FTE	Queen of London Town (from 30 June 2090)	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS · 31–39	CB: Crown Princess (LC-11)
SUCCESSION Accession	Nathaniel abdicates in her favour (15 June 2090)	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	
David Augustine HOUSE · Augustine				
BIOLOGICAL Spouse	Dalia	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS · CB	WTR names King William instead (LC-11)
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Lord Alexander Augustine (father); Lord George Augustine is his uncle	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
TITLE Public title	Prince Consort	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS · CB	LC-11
William HOUSE · Augustine (as WTR names him)				
TITLE Public title	King of London Town, with Queen Dalia Augustine	◇ CONFLICT	WTR	LC-11
Maximillian Edward George Augustine HOUSE · Augustine · also Maxim				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Dalia and David Augustine	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Born	7 September 2072	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	Eldest of the brothers (F2025 agrees)
BIOLOGICAL Element	Terrain	■ DRAFTED	Beta	
TITLE Public title	Crown Prince of London Town	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
SUCCESSION Position	First in London Town's line	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	LC-19
Minho Alexander David Augustine HOUSE · Augustine				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Dalia and David Augustine	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Born	12 August 2074 (BSS); 2074 (CB)	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS · CB	
BIOLOGICAL Element	Blocker	■ DRAFTED	Beta	
TITLE Rank	En Guard Captain; Old Prosperity's King Piece	■ DRAFTED	Beta	
SUCCESSION Position	Gave up his claim to join Old Prosperity's military (CB); relinquished 3 March 2091 (BSS)	◪ SUPPORTED	CB · BSS	F2025 corroborates; LC-19

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
Zephyr David Augustine HOUSE · Augustine				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Dalia and David Augustine; twin of Zoe	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Born	7 September 2075	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Element	Genuine modern Fire/Frost Dyad; registered Flamer (registration in conflict)	● CANON	TCD-049 · Placements	Registration: CONFLICT (IV.10)
SUCCESSION Position	Fourth in the 2090 list; “sixth” at birth	◇ CONFLICT	BSS	LC-19
Zoe Dalia Augustine HOUSE · Augustine				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Dalia and David Augustine; twin of Zephyr	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
TITLE Styled name	“Princess Zoe Dalia Lockwood Augustine”, styled “Princess Dalia”	○ OPEN	BSS	NV-14: no Lockwood parent is given
SUCCESSION Position	Fifth in the 2090 list	◇ CONFLICT	BSS	LC-19
Sebastian Bartholomew Dominic Augustine HOUSE · Augustine				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Dalia and David Augustine	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Born	15 August 2076	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	
BIOLOGICAL Element	Flamer	■ DRAFTED	Beta	
SUCCESSION Position	Third in the 2090 list; relinquished (9 April 2095)	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	LC-19
Orion Nathaniel Augustine HOUSE · Augustine				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	Dalia and David Augustine	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS	

LAYER · FIELD	CLAIM	STATUS	SOURCE	NOTE
BIOLOGICAL Born	1 October 2090	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	
TITLE Styled name	“Orion Nathaniel Lockwood Augustine”	○ OPEN	BSS	NV-14
Arielle Monet Kinross HOUSE · Kinross				
BIOLOGICAL Parents	“Eldest daughter of a son of the crown”; Dalia’s niece	○ OPEN	BSS	Which son is not named
TITLE Public title	The Princess Royal	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	
SUCCESSION Position	Placed before Dalia’s unborn son (2090)	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS	

COLLATERAL LINES · KEPT, NOT CHARTED

PERSON	WHAT THE SOURCE SAYS	STATUS	SOURCE
Stephen Abraham Hastings	Eden’s spouse; Emperor Consort; once Flamer Regnant	~~LEGACY~~	TLE
Madeleine Beatrix	Eden’s second child (b. 2028); m. Lord Felix D’Arcy; daughters Aveline, Isabella, Arabella	~~LEGACY~~	TLE
Victoria Cassiopeia	Eden’s third child (b. 2035); Flamer; m. Lord Adrian Wells; daughter Fiona	~~LEGACY~~	TLE
Charlotte Elizabeth Anai	Lucia’s younger twin (b. 26 Oct 2055)	~~LEGACY~~	TLE
Elaine Marie Hastings	Aracelia’s third daughter (b. 21 Nov 2056)	~~LEGACY~~	TLE
Arianne Jessamine Hastings	Aracelia’s fourth daughter (b. 2 April 2066)	~~LEGACY~~	TLE
Ember Hastings	Richard’s wife (53 in 2094); daughters Olympia (b. 2058), Estelle (b. 2059)	◩ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS
Clyde Hastings	Alexandria’s husband; dies Nov 2096	◩ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS
Amalia Danyelle · Evangeline Kelly Hastings	Alexandria and Clyde’s daughters (b. 2062, 2063)	◩ SUPPORTED	TLE · BSS

PERSON	WHAT THE SOURCE SAYS	STATUS	SOURCE
Lauren Felicity · Angelica Demeter · Fallon Valentina Kinross	Dalia's sisters (b. 2024, 2035, 2040)	~~LEGACY~~	TLE
Brenton	King whose death in 2058 makes Nathaniel King; relation to Samantha unstated	~~LEGACY~~	TLE

DUPLICATE-PERSON AND NAME-VARIANT CHECKS

CHECK	WHAT THE SOURCES NAME	HOW THE RECORD TREATS IT
NV-01 Alistair	Duke Alistair Lockwood (BSS, Tobias's father) · Duke Alistair Blackwood "of London Town" (BSS, Tiran's father) · High Chancellor Alistair Blackwood (TLE, Year 2 ER)	Kept as three people. No source makes any two of them one person; Lockwood and Blackwood aren't merged on spelling.
NV-02 Celeste	Tobias's late aunt (BSS; Katherine's middle name) · Lady Celeste Blackwood (BSS, alive 2072) · Celeste Morningstar (TLE, Dawner Regnant 2064)	Kept apart. No source connects them.
NV-03 Ethan	Ethan Medina (WTR) · Ethan Nicholas (TLE) · "her father, Ethan" (F2025)	One slot with a surname conflict (LC-18): each is Katherine's father figure in its own generation.
NV-04 Aracelia	Meson Mignonette · Mignonette Hastings · Meson Mignonette Hastings · Lockwood	One person (LC-02).
NV-05 Eden	Eden Genesis Hastings · Eden Mignonette · "Migonnette" · Eden Genesis	One person; spelling and house drift inside TLE.
NV-06 Jackson	Duke Jackson Harper · "Duke Jackson Hastings" (TLE, once)	One person; TLE spelling drift.
NV-07 Richard	Richard David Elliot (TLE) · Richard David Elliot Hastings (BSS)	One person; birth year in conflict (LC-13).
NV-08 Louis	Louis Reginald Henry · "Louis Reginal Henry" (BSS, once)	One person; typo.

CHECK	WHAT THE SOURCES NAME	HOW THE RECORD TREATS IT
NV-09 Thorne	Lord Commander Gareth Thorne (TLE, Old Prosperity) · General Gareth Thorne (WTR) · Professor Alexander Thorne (Elias's alias, TCD-032)	No connection established. Don't infer one.
NV-10 Zephyr	Elder Zephyr Windrider (TLE, Dawners) · the Factions file's 2092 survivor Zephyr Windrider · Zephyr Augustine	Not the same person (IV.5 guardrail).
NV-11 Elias	Flight Regnant Elias Windwalker (TLE, 2063) · Elias Lockwood	Not connected.
NV-12 Harper	Duke Jackson Harper (TLE) · Elite Regnant Annemarie Harper (TLE 2061; BSS 2091)	No family link stated.
NV-13 Melena / Beatrix	Alexandria Melena Mignonette · Madeleine Beatrix · Melena Elizabeth Beatrix Lockwood	Possible namesakes; no source says so.
NV-14 "Lockwood" in Augustine names	"Princess Zoe Dalia Lockwood Augustine" · "Orion Nathaniel Lockwood Augustine" (BSS)	No Lockwood parent is given in the Augustine line. Flagged, not inferred.

IV.11 SUCCESSION LANE

Positions, and the act or law behind each. Not the family tree.

GUARDRAIL

A place in a line needs a law or an act. A parent isn't one.

CURRENT · THE IMPERIAL THRONE, AT FTE'S OPENING

POSITION	PERSON	BASIS	STATUS	SOURCE
Reigning	**Empress Aracelia**	Reigning at FTE	■ DRAFTED	Beta
1	**Elias, Crown Prince**	Elevated after Lucia's death; missing from Remnia at FTE's opening	● CANON	TCD-032 · TCD-013
2	**Melena**	"The Lockwood second-in-line"	■ DRAFTED	Beta
3	**Cordelia**	Announced third in line at birth (2079)	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS
4	**Louis**	Announced fourth in line at birth (2081)	◪ SUPPORTED	BSS
5+	**Hastings collateral lines**	Not ruled. TLE's 2063 list orders them branch by branch (LEGACY).	○ OPEN	TLE
—	**Katherine**	Not in the recorded line. Lucia/the Crown originated her dynastic erasure (TCD-059); any claim at law isn't ruled (TCD-040).	○ OPEN	TCD-040 · TCD-059
Law	**The rule that orders this line**	Not ruled (LC-06).	◇ CONFLICT	WTR · BSS · TLE · 31–39

CURRENT · LONDON TOWN, AT FTE'S OPENING

POSITION	PERSON	BASIS	STATUS	SOURCE
Reigning	**Queen Dalia**	Since 30 June 2090 (BSS); "the Queen of London Town" (31–39). CB calls her Crown Princess.	◇ CONFLICT	BSS · 31–39 · CB · WTR
1	**Maxim, Crown Prince of London Town**	2090 list	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS
—	**Minho**	Relinquished 3 March 2091	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS
—	**Sebastian**	Relinquished 9 April 2095	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS
?	**Zephyr, Zoe, Arielle, Orion**	Order in conflict inside BSS (LC-19)	◇ CONFLICT	BSS

HISTORICAL · HOW THE LINES GOT HERE, AS THE SOURCES TELL IT

WHEN	THRONE	WHAT CHANGED	STATUS	SOURCE
2024	**Imperial**	Richard born "Crown Prince of Remnia," heir apparent	~~LEGACY~~	TLE
2038	**London Town**	Dalia born first in line to the Kinross throne	~~LEGACY~~	TLE
2039	**London Town**	Nathaniel born heir apparent; Dalia heir presumptive ("The Grand Princess")	~~LEGACY~~	TLE
2055	**Imperial**	Aracelia becomes Eden's heir apparent over Richard; Lucia "The Princess Imperial"	~~LEGACY~~	TLE
2058	**London Town**	Nathaniel King; Dalia his heir apparent	~~LEGACY~~	TLE

IV.11 · LINEAGE RECORD

CONTINUED

WHEN	THRONE	WHAT CHANGED	STATUS	SOURCE
2063	**Both**	Succession announcements: Imperial line Eden, Aracelia, Lucia, Charlotte, Elaine, Richard, Olympia, Estelle, Madeleine, Aveline, Isabella, Victoria, Alexandria, Amalia, Evangeline; London Town line Nathaniel, then his sisters Lauren, Angelica, Dalia, Fallon	~~LEGACY~~	TLE
2073	**Imperial**	Elias born second in line after Lucia; succession “shifts” to House Lockwood	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS
2076	**Imperial**	Lucia’s decree: daughters keep their place ahead of younger brothers; Melena second in line	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS
2076	**Imperial**	Lucia’s legal action: Katherine has no claim and no place in the line	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS
2079 · 2081	**Imperial**	Cordelia third; Louis fourth	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS
2090	**London Town**	Nathaniel abdicates to Dalia; daughters keep birth order; Arielle placed before Dalia’s unborn son	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS
2091 · 2095	**London Town**	Minho, then Sebastian, relinquish their places	◩ SUPPORTED	BSS
After Lucia’s death	**Imperial**	Elias elevated to Crown Prince	● CANON	TCD-032
Book 3 plan	**Imperial**	Katherine named heir apparent	~~LEGACY~~	F4

WORKING RECORD · 28 OF 48 · D · OPEN AND CONFLICT LANE

IV.11 CONFLICT LEDGER

Where the sources disagree, and what would settle it.

CLAIM	SOURCE A	SOURCE B	HIGHER-AUTHORITY EVIDENCE	CURRENT STATUS	WHAT WOULD NEED TO CHANGE
LC-01 **Melena's eye colour**	Beta: "Lockwood amber eyes," shared by Cordelia. F2025 also has amber.	BSS: "eyes as green as emeralds," a Hastings trait. CB: emerald. 3SL: green. 31–39: green, Tobias's eyes "the same shade." IL repeats BSS.	Beta controls FTE prose (TCD-001). No ruling on which book changes.	◇ CONFLICT CONFLICT	An author ruling on the colour, naming which manuscript revises (Beta or 3SL).
LC-02 **Aracelia's surname and house**	Beta letter: "Aracelia Meson Mignonette." BSS: "Aracelia Meson Mignonette Hastings." TLE: "Aracelia Mignonette Hastings."	31–39: "Empress Aracelia Lockwood."	The Beta's styling controls the drafted page. No ruling on her house; WTR, BSS and TLE all put her in the Hastings line.	◇ CONFLICT CONFLICT (name) · house Hastings SUPPORTED	A ruling on her full styled name and house; then the 31–39 line is revised.
LC-03 **Lucia's birth year**	BSS: born 2047 (47 at her death on 7 Sept 2094).	TLE: born 26 Oct 2055, elder twin of Charlotte, to Aracelia (17) and Jackson Harper.	None. TCD-010: no existing timeline controls chronology. Both files give Aracelia's birth as 2038, so BSS's 2047 would make Aracelia nine at Lucia's birth.	◇ CONFLICT CONFLICT	The new canonical Remnian timeline (TCD-010) fixes Aracelia's and Lucia's births together.

CLAIM	SOURCE A	SOURCE B	HIGHER-AUTHORITY EVIDENCE	CURRENT STATUS	WHAT WOULD NEED TO CHANGE
LC-04 **Eden's generation and reign**	BSS 2073: Empress Eden "becoming a grandmother" at Elias's birth. BSS 2076: Lucia's decree issued "with the blessing of Empress Eden."	BSS 2091: "Eden Genesis has been deceased for decades," Aracelia's reign "long-established." TLE and WTR: Eden → Aracelia → Lucia → Elias (Eden is Elias's great-grandmother).	TCD-032 has Aracelia reigning while Elias built the Thorne life as an adult; it doesn't date her accession.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT	A ruling on when Aracelia acceded and when Eden died. BSS's 2073 and 2076 Eden lines, or its 2091 line, then change.
LC-05 **Melena's great-grandmother**	F2025: a Tournament law signed by "Empress Caliane Azira Hastings – Melena's great-grandmother."	TLE, WTR: Eden is Aracelia's mother, so Eden holds that place.	None in this session. The Beta isn't available here, so whether it keeps the Caliane line is unchecked.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT (Caliane LEGACY unless the Beta keeps her)	Check the Beta's Tournament-law passage. If it names Caliane, she becomes CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT and Eden's place needs a ruling.
LC-06 **Imperial succession law**	WTR: strictly matrilineal Hastings succession; the Crown named Elias heir after Lucia's death to protect its image. 31–39: a Privy Council pushes Elias into the role.	BSS: Lucia's 2076 decree lets daughters keep their place ahead of younger brothers. TLE: in 2055 Aracelia jumps her elder brother "due to having children before her brother"; the 2063 list runs branch by branch.	TCD-032: Elias is elevated to Crown Prince after Lucia's death. Beta: Melena is second in line. Neither states the law.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT (the law) · positions CANON / DRAFTED	A ruling on the succession law in force at FTE, and on whether Lucia's decree exists.
LC-07 **Which house the throne passes through**	BSS: Elias's birth "shifts the royal succession from the House of Hastings to the House of Lockwood"; a fused Hastings–Lockwood crest.	WTR: a matrilineal Hastings line through Elias. 31–39: the Empress herself is "Aracelia Lockwood."	Beta: the heirs are Lockwoods ("the Lockwood second-in-line"). TCD-040 names Lucia "Hastings-Lockwood."	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT (dynastic house) · children's surname DRAFTED	A ruling on the dynastic house name for Lucia's children and the Crown.

CLAIM	SOURCE A	SOURCE B	HIGHER-AUTHORITY EVIDENCE	CURRENT STATUS	WHAT WOULD NEED TO CHANGE
LC-08 **Was Katherine's birth public?**	BSS: a "highly publicized and controversial birth," a treason decree, a 2091 Sanctum suppression order, a "legally protected identity." CB: "whispered scandals."	WTR: "a lineage no one dared to say out loud." 31–39: Dalia was one of three people who knew about Michelle and Tobias. Beta: no character treats Katherine as a known scandal.	TCD-059 leaves initial publicity OPEN.	○ **OPEN** OPEN (sources conflict)	An author ruling on initial publicity, before any character reacts to the Nicholas name on-page (IV.12).
LC-09 **Elias's titles**	BSS: "Crown Prince of Remnia, Duke of Somnoria" from his birth in 2073.	TCD-032: elevated to Crown Prince after Lucia's death.	TCD-032 (CANON).	● **CANON** Crown Prince from Lucia's death CANON · from birth SUPERSEDED · Duke of Somnoria SUPPORTED	Nothing for "Crown Prince." Duke of Somnoria waits on LC-10.
LC-10 **Does the Remnian public know Somnoria exists?**	BSS: a televised address gives the heir the "traditional title of Duke of Somnoria … fostering relations with the neighboring empire of Somnoria." IL repeats it.	Beta ch. 2: Melena believes "There's nothing outside of Remnia anymore." 31–39: Cordelia says Elias "vanished into a foreign country."	TCD-016: awareness varies by class, institution and time; Remnia's case isn't ruled.	○ **OPEN** OPEN	A ruling on public knowledge of Somnoria before any Remnian character names it on-page again (IV.22).

CLAIM	SOURCE A	SOURCE B	HIGHER-AUTHORITY EVIDENCE	CURRENT STATUS	WHAT WOULD NEED TO CHANGE
LC-11 **London Town's royal house**	WTR: King William and Queen Dalia Augustine.	CB: Crown Princess Dalia and Prince Consort David Augustine. BSS: Queen Dalia from 30 June 2090, styled "Dalia Clementine Lexington Kinross," consort David Augustine. 31–39: "the Queen of London Town." TLE: House of Kinross, "what will later become the House of Augustine."	TCD-041: the Crown directly controls London Town, so whoever reigns there rules under it. Beta: the four brothers are Augustines.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT	A ruling on who reigns in London Town at FTE, Dalia's consort, and the house name.
LC-12 **Dalia's father and the king before Nathaniel**	TLE 2038: Dalia born to Queen Samantha and King Edward Kinross. BSS: Maxim honours his maternal grandfather "King Edward XVIII."	TLE 2058: Nathaniel becomes King "following the death of King Brenton," while Samantha abdicates to her son.	None.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT (inside TLE) · Edward SUPPORTED	Timeline ruling; Brenton's relationship to Samantha stated or dropped.
LC-13 **Richard's birth year**	TLE: born 3 Sept 2024, Eden's first child (36 in 2060).	BSS: "Prince Richard David Elliot Hastings (55)" in 2094, so about 2039.	TCD-010.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT	Canonical timeline.
LC-14 **Tobias's birth vs his parents' ages**	TLE: born 2 Aug 2035 at Lockwood Manor, Highcrest; "Head of the Lockwood House" from birth.	BSS: Duke Alistair Lockwood (67) and Duchess Rowena (64) in 2094, so born about 2027 and 2030. Alistair would be about eight at Tobias's birth, and still heads the house in 2094.	TCD-010.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT	Canonical timeline: one of the dates moves.

CLAIM	SOURCE A	SOURCE B	HIGHER-AUTHORITY EVIDENCE	CURRENT STATUS	WHAT WOULD NEED TO CHANGE
LC-15 **Melena's birth year and age**	BSS: born 9 Sept 2076; 17 when Lucia dies; "turns 19" on 9 Sept 2095.	BSS (same file): "19, turning 20" at the start of 2095. CB: 2077. 31–39: nineteen once, twenty twice. F2025: turns twenty on Examination day.	The Beta doesn't state her age (IV.14).	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT	A ruling on her birth date, checked against the Tournament age rule.
LC-16 **How and where Lucia died**	BSS: 7 Sept 2094, 2:41 AM, at the Imperial Palace; a "nighttime medical crisis."	31–39 (and F2025): a car accident, with Melena on a call with her.	None. The Content Master's IV.11 had "cause of death SUPPORTED" from 31–39 alone; corrected to CONFLICT.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT	A ruling on cause of death.
LC-17 **Where Tobias is in 2094–95**	31–39: Tobias dies six months after Lucia (officially a fall).	BSS: guardianships for Melena, Cordelia and Louis go to others on 11 Sept 2094, two days after Lucia's death; his parents petition for Elias in July 2094, while Lucia is alive. BSS never places Tobias after 2081.	None. The Content Master: dead before FTE (SUPPORTED).	○ **OPEN** OPEN	Timeline placement of Tobias's death, and whether he was alive and passed over when the guardianships were granted.
LC-18 **Ethan's surname and role**	WTR: "Ethan Medina gave Katherine his name."	TLE: "Ethan Nicholas," Head of the Nicholas House, born 2035. F2025: "her father, Ethan," an academic. BSS: "Medina" honours Michelle's maternal grandmother.	TCD-040: Ethan as biological father is superseded.	◇ **CONFLICT** Biological LEGACY / SUPERSEDED · social role POSSIBLE · surname CONFLICT	A ruling on whether Ethan exists in the current generation, and in what role.

CLAIM	SOURCE A	SOURCE B	HIGHER-AUTHORITY EVIDENCE	CURRENT STATUS	WHAT WOULD NEED TO CHANGE
LC-19 **London Town's order of succession**	BSS 2090 list: Maxim, Minho, Sebastian, Zephyr, Zoe, Arielle, the unborn son.	BSS birth entries: Zephyr and Zoe (2075) are older than Sebastian (2076); the twins are "sixth and seventh in line"; Sebastian is "fifth in line to the throne of Remnia."	Nathaniel's 2090 decree (BSS) keeps daughters in birth order. No ruling.	◇ CONFLICT CONFLICT (inside BSS)	A ruling on London Town's line, and on whether "throne of Remnia" in the Sebastian entry means London Town's.
LC-20 **Dukedom titles vs provincial rule**	BSS: Lucia is "Duchess of Zenithia"; Melena "Duchess of Avalon"; Tiran's father is Duke Alistair Blackwood "of London Town."	CB: Blackwood Dukedom of Zenithia. Beta: Governor Anise of Zenithia. WTR: Countess Montclair. TLE's seventeen provinces include no Avalon.	TCD-041: provincial leaders' titles may vary. Zenithia's leadership is already a CONFLICT (IV.3).	◇ CONFLICT CONFLICT	A ruling on Zenithia's leadership, and on whether royal dukedoms are honorific (TLE's Dukedom Act).
LC-21 **The parents' elements**	Beta ch. 8: Lucia was "one of the most powerful" Frosts; Cordelia inherited Frost; Melena "took after their father — fire."	31–39 Mirror (and F2025): Tobias a Frost, Lucia a Flamer.	Beta (TCD-001).	■ DRAFTED Beta CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT · 31–39 needs revising	Nothing in the Beta; the 31–39 lines are rewritten. Neither side says where Katherine's capacity comes from (TCD-049).

OLD CLAIMS REJECTED OR DOWNGRADED

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	WHY	NOW
R-01	Katherine as "Katherine Lockwood"	F4	The Beta names her Nicholas; TCD-040 doesn't make her a Lockwood by law.	LEGACY / SUPERSEDED
R-02	Katherine named heir apparent, Melena heir presumptive, after the Empress dies (Book 3 plan)	F4	A post-FTE legacy plot (TCD-022); biology doesn't make Katherine an heir (TCD-040).	LEGACY / SUPERSEDED · not imported

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	WHY	NOW
R-03	Melena finds “the bloodline suppression docs” bearing Tobias’s signature	F4	TCD-058: no established suppression. TCD-059: Tobias isn’t the architect. TCD-050 stages the reveal.	LEGACY / SUPERSEDED
R-04	Ethan as Katherine’s biological father	TLE generation (audit), WTR, F2025	TCD-040.	SUPERSEDED · social role POSSIBLE
R-05	Lucia as Katherine’s mother	Earlier lineage generations (audit)	TCD-040. Not in the uploaded TLE text, which ends in 2066.	SUPERSEDED
R-06	Elias as Crown Prince from birth	BSS	TCD-032: elevated after Lucia’s death.	Downgraded: SUPERSEDED on timing
R-07	Empress Eden reigning in 2073–76	BSS	TCD-032 and BSS’s own 2091 entry.	Downgraded to CONFLICT (LC-04)
R-08	Tobias “Head of the Lockwood House” from birth	TLE	BSS has his father as Duke in 2094.	LEGACY
R-09	Katherine’s birth was “highly publicized”	BSS (repeated in IL)	TCD-059 leaves it open; the Beta shows no scandal.	Not adopted: OPEN (LC-08)
R-10	Melena as “heir presumptive to London Town’s throne”	F2025	Legacy prose. The Beta has her second in line to the imperial throne.	LEGACY
R-11	Aracelia becomes heir “due to having children before her brother”	TLE	Unique to the earlier pool; no later source repeats it.	LEGACY

ID	CLAIM	SOURCE	WHY	NOW
R-12	The Imperial Lineage as a source	IL	Not audited. Every lineage claim the Content Master quotes from it appears word for word in BSS, which is audited; citations move to BSS.	Not imported

WORKING RECORD · 36 OF 48 · D · OPEN AND CONFLICT LANE

DECISIONS THE RECORD CAN'T MAKE

IV.11

Each conflict and open item, with room to work it out. Rulings go to Appendix A with a log number.

◇ CONFLICT — LC-01 · MELENA'S EYE COLOUR

Amber or green? Name the colour, the manuscript that revises, and every page that carries the other colour (Melena and Cordelia in the Beta; Melena in 3SL).

TIED TO CONFLICT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT — LC-02 · ARACELIA'S SURNAME AND HOUSE

What is the Empress's full styled name, and which house is she? If Hastings, the 31–39 "Aracelia Lockwood" line is revised.

TIED TO CONFLICT (name) · house Hastings SUPPORTED

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT LC-03 · LUCIA'S BIRTH YEAR

Fix Lucia's birth year against Aracelia's (2038 in both timelines). If Lucia was born in 2047, Aracelia's year moves; if in 2055, Lucia dies at 38 or 39, not 47.

TIED TO CONFLICT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT LC-04 · EDEN'S GENERATION AND REIGN

When did Aracelia take the throne, and when did Eden die? Either Eden blessed Lucia's 2076 decree, or she had been dead "for decades" by 2091. Not both.

TIED TO CONFLICT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT **LC-05 · MELENA'S GREAT-GRANDMOTHER**

Does Empress Caliane exist? Check the Beta's Tournament-law passage. If she stays, say which of Melena's lines she belongs to and when she reigned.

TIED TO CONFLICT (Caliane LEGACY unless the Beta keeps her)

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT **LC-06 · IMPERIAL SUCCESSION LAW**

Write the succession law in force at FTE: matrilineal, eldest child regardless of sex, male preference amended by Lucia in 2076, or another rule. Then check that it still puts Elias first and Melena second.

TIED TO CONFLICT (the law) · positions CANON / DRAFTED

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT

LC-07 · WHICH HOUSE THE THRONE PASSES THROUGH

After Lucia's marriage, is the dynasty Hastings or Lockwood? Name the throne's house, and say whether Aracelia is ever styled Lockwood.

TIED TO CONFLICT (dynastic house) · children's surname DRAFTED

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

LC-08 · WAS KATHERINE'S BIRTH PUBLIC?

Was Katherine's birth ever public? If it was (BSS), what do ordinary Remnians remember, and why does no one in the Beta treat her as a scandal? If it never was, who knew, starting from Dalia and the three people of 31–39?

TIED TO OPEN (sources conflict)

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

● CANON

LC-09 · ELIAS'S TITLES

Keep or drop "Duke of Somnoria" once LC-10 is settled. If it stays, who in Remnia understands what the title names?

TIED TO
Crown Prince from Lucia's death CANON · from birth SUPERSEDED · Duke of Somnoria SUPPORTED

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

LC-10 · DOES THE REMNIAN PUBLIC KNOW SOMNORIA EXISTS?

What does the Remnian public know about Somnoria? Reconcile Melena's "nothing outside of Remnia," Cordelia's "foreign country," and a publicly announced Duke of Somnoria.

TIED TO
OPEN

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT

LC-11 · LONDON TOWN'S ROYAL HOUSE

Who reigns in London Town at FTE, who is Dalia's consort, and what is the house called: Queen Dalia with Prince Consort David, King William and Queen Dalia, or Crown Princess Dalia?

TIED TO CONFLICT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT

LC-12 · DALIA'S FATHER AND THE KING BEFORE NATHANIEL

Who was Dalia's father, and who was King Brenton? Keep Edward (TLE, BSS), or explain Brenton.

TIED TO CONFLICT (inside TLE) · Edward SUPPORTED

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT

LC-13 · RICHARD'S BIRTH YEAR

Richard's birth year: 2024 (TLE) or about 2039 (BSS). It decides whether he is Aracelia's elder brother by fourteen years or her younger brother.

TIED TO CONFLICT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT

LC-14 · TOBIAS'S BIRTH VS HIS PARENTS' AGES

Tobias's birth year against his parents' ages: move Tobias (TLE 2035), or move Alistair and Rowena (BSS: 67 and 64 in 2094).

TIED TO CONFLICT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT

LC-15 · MELENA'S BIRTH YEAR AND AGE

Melena's birth date (BSS 9 Sept 2076, or CB 2077), checked against the Tournament age rule and Katherine's twenty.

TIED TO CONFLICT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT

LC-16 · HOW AND WHERE LUCIA DIED

How did Lucia die: a nighttime medical crisis at the palace (BSS), or a car accident while on a call with Melena (31–39)? List the drafted scenes that change.

TIED TO CONFLICT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

LC-17 · WHERE TOBIAS IS IN 2094–95

When did Tobias die, and was he alive when the guardianships were granted? If he was, why did the Crown pass him over?

TIED TO OPEN

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT

LC-18 · ETHAN'S SURNAME AND ROLE

Does Ethan exist in the current generation? If so: his surname, his tie to Michelle, and what "gave Katherine his name" means now that "Medina" honours Michelle's grandmother.

TIED TO Biological LEGACY / SUPERSEDED · social role POSSIBLE · surname CONFLICT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT

LC-19 · LONDON TOWN'S ORDER OF SUCCESSION

London Town's order of succession after 2090, by the 2090 decree's own rule. Zephyr and Zoe were born before Sebastian.

TIED TO CONFLICT (inside BSS)

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◇ CONFLICT

LC-20 · DUKEDOM TITLES VS PROVINCIAL RULE

Are royal dukedoms (Zenithia, Avalon, Alleia, Meridion) honorific titles or provincial offices? Then reconcile Lucia's Duchy of Zenithia with Governor Anise and a Blackwood dukedom.

TIED TO CONFLICT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

■ DRAFTED

LC-21 · THE PARENTS' ELEMENTS

List the 31–39 Mirror lines to revise so that Tobias carries Fire and Lucia Frost, as the Beta has them.

TIED TO
Beta CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT · 31–39 needs revising

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◪ SUPPORTED

O-01 · BIRTH ORDER OF THE SISTERS

Is Katherine older than Melena? If yes, say what that does and doesn't change. Biology alone gives her no place (TCD-040).

TIED TO
BSS · CB

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

O-02 · KATHERINE'S LEGAL STATUS

Write Katherine's legal status as Remnian law records it: legitimacy, name at law, and whether she is royal.

TIED TO
TCD-040 · TCD-059

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

~~LEGACY~~

O-03 · ARACELIA'S SPOUSE AND LUCIA'S FATHER

Who is Aracelia's husband and Lucia's father? Keep Duke Jackson Harper (TLE only), or replace him.

TIED TO
TLE

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

◪ SUPPORTED **O-04 · LUCIA'S SISTERS**

Who are Lucia's sisters? Confirm Charlotte (her twin) and Elaine, or drop them; BSS's "Charlotte's oldest" and "Elaine's oldest" depend on it.

TIED TO
TLE · BSS

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN **O-05 · ARIELLE'S PARENT**

Arielle Monet Kinross: whose daughter is she? Name the "son of the crown."

TIED TO
BSS

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.12 KATHERINE'S CONCEALMENT

Assign each layer of the secret to its owner.

Katherine wasn't hidden by one person. Each layer of the concealment has its own owner.

● CANON TCD-059

LAYER	OWNER	WHAT THEY CONTROL	EVIDENCE ON THE PAGE	OPEN
Public and legal erasure; dynastic exclusion	Lucia / the Lockwood Crown	The decision that Katherine is not acknowledged	None drafted	Motive; Aracelia's role
Enforcement; records; surveillance	The Sanctum	What the files say and who can see them	None specific to Katherine yet	Exact record alterations; the file's current contents
Non-acknowledgment	Tobias	His silence; he's not established as the architect	None drafted	Consent or coercion
Raising and protection inside the constraints	Michelle	Katherine's daily life; the fence	The travel ban and its ready excuses (ch. 13)	What she was told she could and couldn't do; why

Michelle is the only owner with a drafted footprint, and it's the right one. She didn't design the erasure; she managed a daughter inside it. The fence in ch. 13 is protection that looks like caution. The reader should be able to reread every Michelle excuse later and see a woman keeping her child out of rooms where someone might look at her too closely.

What the development chapters add about Michelle. (◪ SUPPORTED · *31–39* ch. 31) Michelle and Tobias "tried to make it work for years before it all fell apart." Queen Dalia "was one of three people who knew about Michelle and Tobias," and after Lucia and Tobias died she sat with Michelle night after night, then sent her sons Maxim and Minho when she couldn't come herself. Michelle can't tell the room "that she wasn't just some bastard captain's daughter." The chapter doesn't say that Dalia knows Katherine is Tobias's child; it says she knew about the relationship.

OPEN, WITH A SOURCE SPREAD

Was Katherine's birth ever public?

TCD-059 leaves open whether it was publicly known before suppression or never meaningfully acknowledged. The sources pull in different directions:

The *Remnian Timeline Before Story Start* describes a "highly publicized and controversial birth" followed by a royal decree making any discussion of it treason, and, in 2091, a Sanctum suppression order; the unaudited *Imperial Lineage* repeats the birth and the decree. The *Character Bible* speaks of royal decrees and "whispered scandals." *Welcome to Remnia* says she was raised with "a name that wasn't hers and a lineage no one dared to say out loud," and that acknowledging her would mean "admitting Tobias violated Imperial marriage law." The audit flags that file's public-scandal framing as unresolved.

Nothing in the Beta shows any character treating Katherine as a known scandal. Do not smooth this into "everyone half-knew." It's a real choice with real consequences for how people have looked at Katherine for twenty years.

WHO KNOWS WHAT, AT FTE'S OPENING.

PERSON OR BODY	KNOWS KATHERINE IS TOBIAS'S DAUGHTER?	BASIS
Michelle	Yes	Objective truth (TCD-040)
Tobias, Lucia	Yes, both dead	TCD-059
The Sanctum	Holds the records; which offices know ○ OPEN	TCD-059
Aracelia	○ OPEN	Not ruled
Dalia	Knows of the relationship; paternity unstated	*31–39* (◩ SUPPORTED)
Katherine	Nothing on the page	Beta chs. 1–29
Melena	Nothing on the page	Beta chs. 1–29
Minho, Atlas, others	Nothing on the page	Don't infer from proximity
The public	○ OPEN	See the source spread above

IV.12 · KATHERINE'S CONCEALMENT

CONTINUED

PERSON OR BODY	KNOWS KATHERINE IS TOBIAS'S DAUGHTER?	BASIS

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE CONCEALMENT CHAIN · ○ OPEN

FIXED
Four owners and their layers (TCD-059).

UNDECIDED
Motives; consent and coercion; what records were altered and how; Aracelia's part; whether the birth was ever public; whether "Medina" was chosen to hide or to honor someone.

WHY IT MATTERS
The verification stage of the reveal (IV.13) needs a document to find. The document's author, custodian, and wording come from this chain.

DECIDE BY
Initial publicity before any character reacts to the Nicholas name on-page; the record chain before verification is drafted.

WORKING SPACE · THE CONCEALMENT CHAIN

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-040, TCD-050, TCD-059; FTE Beta ch. 13; FTE 31–39 ch. 31; Character Bible; Welcome to Remnia; FTE Remnian Timeline Before Story Start; The Imperial Lineage (unaudited, comparison only); audit (Remnian Timeline inventory row).*

SEE ALSO II.15 Recurring Institutional Misreadings · **p.45**

IV.11 Lineage: Biology, Law, Record, Succession · **p.98** IV.13 The Sister Reveal · **p.153**

IV.13 THE SISTER REVEAL

Stage the reveal across evidence, not exposition.

No single moment tells the sisters the truth. The reveal is built in four stages, and each stage has a different kind of evidence. ● CANON TCD-050

STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS	WHO DRIVES IT	KIND OF EVIDENCE	CAN IT PROVE PATERNITY?
1. Investigation	Melena finds inconsistencies before Challenge Six, because 3SL destroyed her trust in official history. By the Duel she suspects Katherine is biologically connected to the Lockwoods or Tobias.	Melena	Documentary and circumstantial	No
2. Confrontation	In the climax, magical, behavioral, and inherited recognition reinforces her suspicion. Melena tells or confronts Katherine directly.	Melena	Magical and behavioral	No
3. Verification	Authenticated lineage, birth, or Sanctum evidence proves Tobias's paternity.	○ OPEN	Authenticated record	Yes
4. Personal confirmation	Michelle supplies the human history and the concealment.	Michelle	Testimony	Confirms; explains

Katherine's reason for saving Melena comes from her own moral arc, not only from sisterhood. ● CANON TCD-050. The Beta has already built that arc (IV.9).

The four tracks. Tracked separately at each point in the book.

POINT	MELENA KNOWS	KATHERINE KNOWS	EVIDENCE AVAILABLE	OBJECTIVE TRUTH
FTE open	Nothing about Katherine	Nothing about Tobias	Sanctum records (unseen)	Half-sisters
Welcome Feast	—	A "weird lurch in Katherine's stomach she'd blamed on nerves" at eye contact	—	Same

POINT	MELENA KNOWS	KATHERINE KNOWS	EVIDENCE AVAILABLE	OBJECTIVE TRUTH
C1, lava field (ch. 15)	Watches Katherine save London Town Flamers; considers sabotaging the bridge and doesn't (ch. 16)	Her Frost "reaching" toward Melena, "not to attack, not to defend"	Recognition only	Same
C1, tundra (ch. 17)	Carried out by the enemy Queen: "I wouldn't have done this for you"	Chose to save her anyway	—	Same
Before C6 (required)	Suspicion, from her own investigation	○ OPEN	First clue ○ OPEN	Same
***31–39* (◩ SUPPORTED)**	No suspicion drafted; Michelle and Dalia see Tobias in her on the broadcast	Her ice answers Melena's grief across a broadcast; Dax: figure out "what's going on with you and the Princess"	—	Same
The Duel	Confronts Katherine	Told	Recognition reinforces, doesn't prove	Same
After	Proof	Proof; then Michelle's history	Authenticated records; testimony	Same

DRAFTING GAP

The ruling needs Melena investigating before Challenge Six. This read of chs. 1–29 found no suspicion drafted yet, and *31–39* doesn't draft it either. Stage 1 has to be planted in the unwritten half, early enough that her suspicion at the Duel is earned rather than announced.

SUPERSEDED

The Challenges FTE Year has Melena realize the sisterhood mid-fight from a magical reaction. One reaction can't carry the reveal (TCD-050). Recognition in the Duel reinforces what she already suspects.

GUARDRAIL

Resemblance is a clue, not a finding. When Michelle or Dalia sees Tobias in Melena's face (*31–39*), that's their knowledge and their grief. It doesn't move either sister forward a single stage.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE EVIDENCE CHAIN · ○ OPEN

FIXED
Four stages in order; Melena's suspicion before the Duel; confrontation in the climax; authenticated verification; Michelle's testimony (TCD-050); concealment owners (TCD-059).

UNDECIDED
Melena's first clue and where she finds it; what she already knows from Shadowmere; which record verifies; who authenticates it; when Michelle testifies; whether the reveal goes public, and when.

WHY IT MATTERS
Melena is the investigator. If her clues aren't on the page, the reveal happens to her instead of because of her.

DECIDE BY
The first clue before the next Melena chapter is drafted.

WORKING SPACE · THE EVIDENCE CHAIN

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.13 · THE SISTER REVEAL

CONTINUED

SOURCE *TCD-040, TCD-050, TCD-059; FTE Beta chs. 14–17; FTE 31–39 chs. 31–32; The Challenges FTE Year. Record: Sister-Reveal Evidence Architecture.*

SEE ALSO IV.12 Katherine's Concealment · **p.150** | IV.14 Melena Lockwood · **p.157** | IV.22 Knowledge Progression · **p.181**

NOTES · IV.13

IV.14 MELENA LOCKWOOD

Dossier that protects her from villain framing.

Melena comes into FTE two years after Remy died in front of her, carrying guilt for a death a gang leader caused (TCD-063) and a Fire she still can't hold. She isn't the villain of this book, and nothing in FTE may make her one. ● CANON TCD-009. She can make destructive, dangerous, even catastrophic choices, but they have to grow from the woman 3SL built.

	MELENA LOCKWOOD	STATUS
Name and title	Princess Melena Elizabeth Beatrix Lockwood	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT; *31–39*
Place in succession	Second in line, after Elias	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Element	Flamer; volatile	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Piece	London Town's Queen	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Where she's been	Two years in Shadowmere as "Melena of Nowhere," under cover of a provincial tour; Aracelia is about to cancel it ("it doesn't take two years to visit all seventeen")	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (ch. 2)
Why she went	Lucia's letter: "Find the woman with the silver bells. Tell her Lucia's daughter needs a passage to nowhere."	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (ch. 2); Part III
Eyes	Amber (Beta) versus green (3SL, *31–39*, *Character Bible*)	◇ CONFLICT (IV.11)
Age	Not stated in the Beta; *31–39* says nineteen once and twenty twice; *Character Bible* gives 2077 ER	○ OPEN
Handler	Raven	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT

HER ARC THROUGH THE DRAFTED CHAPTERS.

CHAPTER	BEAT
2	Caelum finds her in Shadowmere and recruits her with Elias (IV.15)
4, 6	Back at the palace; the masked reception; Zenithia's complaints
8–9	Hides as a candidate in brown contacts and black dye; violates Sanctum Protocol 17 with Cordelia; Tiran, disguised as a Sanctum official, gets them out on Caelum's arrangement

CHAPTER	BEAT
12	The augmenter incident; Code Sixteen; Raven's suppressor rod
14	Her first speech to fourteen terrified Pieces
16	Watches Katherine's bridge; wants to break it; doesn't
18	Sees Zephyr's two elements; tells Raven she saw nothing odd
20	Challenge Two's penalty lands on London Town
22–24	The Maze; the Remy memory surfaces; Tiran grounds her
29	Med bay after Challenge Four

The Remy memory in FTE. Ch. 22 gives Melena's version: a Maven job; Remy at the table; "If it goes sideways, Blackwood, you save the product or yourself"; an alley, a warehouse, a machete, a severed artery, "I love you, Mira"; Tiran beating her "to make sure you look like a mark, not a partner"; "You were never here"; "Maven never knew. Remy's death got filed as gang violence." (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT) The objective event belongs to 3SL. The gang leader's wound kills Remy while he protects her; her Fire creates the danger and escalates after he dies (TCD-063). The machete and artery are compatible candidates, not canon over the future 3SL scene (III.15).

What the development chapters draft. (◩ SUPPORTED · rewrite required) She goes off-script at the Naming Ceremony and gives each of London Town's dead a life, not a line. In Heart's Mirror she admits she wants Elias to abdicate and wants to be first. She tells Cordelia she hasn't killed anyone. She taps C-A-E-L-U-M into Cordelia's wrist in a code Maven taught her and Cordelia learned from pre-war naval dispatches. And she can't stop thinking "power over people." Every one of those beats sits well inside TCD-009: dangerous ambition, never villainy.

REVISION FLAG (FTE BETA)

"Months since the alley."

Carried from III.14. The interval is about two years ● CANON TCD-013; the Beta line needs revising to fit.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · MELENA IN FTE · ○ OPEN

FIXED

Not the villain (TCD-009); her guilt versus the forensic cause (TCD-063); her alliance with Caelum (TCD-043); her investigation before the Duel and her choice of survival (TCD-042, TCD-050).

UNDECIDED

Her age; her eye color; how she thinks of Shadowmere (IV.2); what she investigates and how; whether she has ever killed; how much of the Mirror's verdict she believes by the Duel.

WHY IT MATTERS

The forfeit is Melena's choice. The reader has to watch her become someone who can make it.

DECIDE BY

Eye color at the next revision of either book; the investigation thread before her next chapter.

WORKING SPACE · MELENA IN FTE

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-009, TCD-013, TCD-042, TCD-043, TCD-050, TCD-063; FTE Beta chs. 2, 4–9, 12, 14, 16, 18, 20, 22–24, 29; FTE 31–39 chs. 31, 33, 35, 37–38; Character Bible.*

SEE ALSO III.14 Melena and Remy in Shadowmere → FTE concordance · **p.216**

III.15 Remy's Death: Beat Sheet and Memory Translation → FTE concordance · **p.216**

III.18 Handoff into FTE and the Next Shadowmere Book → FTE concordance · **p.216**

IV.15 Caelum and Melena: The Leverage Ledger · **p.160**

IV.15 CAELUM AND MELENA: THE LEVERAGE LEDGER

Track a two-sided transactional alliance.

Melena and Caelum are in a transactional alliance with coercive leverage on both sides. ● CANON TCD-043. He isn't her handler and she isn't his subordinate. "Asset" is his operational language, and the Companion's narration never adopts it (II.15). He is an independent cross-land actor with deep Nightmare-adjacent access and nightmare magic, and he is not a member of the Nightmare organization. ● CANON TCD-031

How it starts (ch. 2). A hooded man in Shadowmere knows a name Melena has told no one. He has silver hair "not dyed," skin like wheat in a Rovencian field, three tiny studs in his ears, each a different metal, and violet eyes. He tells her Elias is in Somnoria as Professor Alexander Thorne, that his cousin Cassius is investigating him, and that the borders are closed "but there are still ways through." He wants her in the Tournament, win or lose, "as long as you keep their eyes on you." The price she gets is direct access to Elias's messages. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)

	CAELUM HOLDS	MELENA HOLDS
Access	Elias's location, cover identity, and messages; Somnorian intelligence; routes "through" closed borders; Shadowmere networks	Remnian royal access; a Queen's position inside the Tournament; Sanctum proximity; Shadowmere knowledge of her own
Threat	Elias's exposure: "If the Dream Guild finds out their prize is a Remnian defector, and the Empire learns a Lockwood is one of Somnoria's greatest teachers..."	Walking away; public attention; refusing to deliver
Delivered so far	Tiran's rescue and the Delegation gowns (chs. 8–9, arranged through Caelum)	Her presence on the Board
Asked for (*31–39*, ◩ SUPPORTED)	—	Communication schema, guard rotations, emergency evacuation lines, Sanctum broadcast relays: "proof that the Sanctum bleeds"
Withheld	○ OPEN	Whether she ever delivers; Zephyr's Dyad (she told Raven she saw nothing)

	CAELUM HOLDS	MELENA HOLDS
Standing at the latest source	"You made a deal. I collect before your board starts eating its own." (*31–39* ch. 38)	"That board is my people. London Town is not a bargaining chip."

His purpose shifts between sources. In ch. 2 he wants her as spectacle. In *31–39* he tells Maven she "went in there to gather intelligence on the Sanctum," and calls her "a kid I sent into a death game to save her brother." Both can be true of a man with a larger objective he hasn't named. ● CANON TCD-031 says that objective exists and isn't yet defined.

How he reaches her. *31–39* has Caelum appear in Melena's mind at Havenwood with no body ("I'm only trespassing in your mind"; "Bodies complicate exits"), and he feels her panic "through the dream magic." (◪ SUPPORTED) No ruling defines the mechanism, its range, or whether it's part of his nightmare magic. ○ OPEN

GUARDRAIL

Cassius is Caelum's cousin in Melena's hearing (ch. 2). That's a family connection a character states, not a Remnian's knowledge of House Aether. Melena doesn't know what House Aether is.

IV.15 · CAELUM AND MELENA: THE LEVERAGE LEDGER

CONTINUED

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE DEAL · ○ OPEN

FIXED
Transactional alliance with two-way coercion; asset as his framing only; he's not Nightmare (TCD-031, TCD-043).

UNDECIDED
His long-term objective; what he's already given her; what she delivers; how his mind-presence works; whether Cordelia now knows his name (Melena taps it to her in *31–39*); where the relationship goes.

WHY IT MATTERS
Caelum is the thread that pulls FTE into ADST. Every exchange here is a cross-book knowledge transfer (VII.2).

DECIDE BY
The mind-presence mechanism before it appears in canon prose.

WORKING SPACE · THE DEAL

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-031, TCD-032, TCD-043; FTE Beta chs. 2, 8–9, 18; FTE 31–39 chs. 31, 38. Records: Caelum/Melena Leverage Ledger; Caelum Cross-Book Agenda + Network Dossier.*

SEE ALSO II.4 Knowledge of the Other Lands · **p.29** | IV.14 Melena Lockwood · **p.157** | VII.2 Event Chronology vs Information Chronology → FTE concordance · **p.216**

IV.16 ATLAS: THE SYNCHRONIZATION INJURY

Fix the origin; keep the rest open.

Atlas's black-vein deterioration begins in the Conduit Trial. ● CANON TCD-051. He force-synchronizes his dense, controlled Frost with Katherine's reactive Frost in the same circuit. He tries to impose structure; the Frost overcorrects, turns inward, and creates a progressive injury visible as black veins. It isn't an accumulation of ordinary Element Rot, and no earlier Sanctum corruption, artifact, or experiment caused it.

WHAT'S ON THE PAGE.

SOURCE	STATUS	WHAT IT SHOWS
Beta ch. 28	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT	Nico briefs the Trial: four pillars, bonded-pair synchronization, runes in white and black. By the chapter's end the black veins reach Atlas's cheekbones.
Chapter 29.docx	◪ SUPPORTED · rewrite required	Atlas collapses; his skin is "cold in a way frost shouldn't be — wrong temperature, wrong texture"; black veining creeps toward his eyes and throat. Katherine performs the Elders' Prayer; the veining freezes "mid-crawl," then retreats down his forearms "until it thinned into nothing."
FTE 31–39	◪ SUPPORTED · rewrite required	A fading "tether" between Katherine and Atlas, carrying his alarm and thoughts, and Dax's heat; Atlas pale, hollow-eyed, hands bandaged
Character Bible	◪ SUPPORTED	"The most powerful Frost in Old Prosperity"; control "near-absolute"; the room froze at his birth

The *Character Bible*'s Atlas is the reason the ruling works. A Frost defined by control is exactly the Frost who would try to impose structure on someone else's reactive power and get hurt doing it.

GUARDRAIL

No retrofitted history.

Atlas's past violence (in ch. 7 Katherine recalls that he nearly killed Minho three years earlier; the *Character Bible* has a battle that nearly destroyed a mountainside) is not an earlier corruption, and an early description of his veins standing out against his skin is not foreshadowing of a pre-existing condition. The injury starts in the Trial.

OPEN

Does the injury come back?

TCD-0051 calls it progressive, and the audit asks why it progresses after synchronization ends. *Chapter 29.docx* has the Prayer drive it out entirely. Both can't be the whole story: either the Prayer stabilizes it without curing it, or it returns, or the progression happens before the Prayer. The Prayer restores a viable magical pattern and can't regenerate destroyed tissue (TCD-0057), which leaves room for lasting damage.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · ATLAS'S INJURY · ○ OPEN

FIXED
Conduit Trial origin; mechanism of inward overcorrection; not ordinary Element Rot; no earlier cause (TCD-051).

UNDECIDED
Whether it's acute Element Rot or its own pathology; its anatomy; why it progresses; aggravators; any link to Katherine after the Trial; treatment; the Prayer's exact effect; recovery; what it costs him permanently.

WHY IT MATTERS
The endgame runs Atlas and Katherine and Melena at once. If his condition is still live at the Duel, it changes what Katherine can afford to spend.

DECIDE BY
Before the Prayer scene is rewritten into the Beta's generation.

WORKING SPACE · ATLAS'S INJURY

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-009, TCD-051, TCD-057; FTE Beta chs. 3, 7, 28; Chapter 29.docx; FTE 31–39 chs. 32, 37; Character Bible. Record: Atlas Synchronization Injury Record.*

SEE ALSO II.14 The Elders' Prayer · **p.42** | IV.17 The Elders' Prayer in FTE · **p.166** | IV.24 FTE Endgame Packet · **p.187**

IV.17 THE ELDERS' PRAYER IN FTE

Record Katherine's performance.

Katherine performs the Elders' Prayer for Atlas. ● CANON TCD-009. It's the same inherited working Selah performs in 3SL, in a Remnian form, about two years later and with no causal link between the two performances. ● CANON TCD-023, TCD-048. Its function is fixed: it restores a living person's viable magical pattern when that pattern is severed, corrupted, or catastrophically dysregulated, and it can call someone back from active dying. It can't resurrect completed death or regenerate destroyed anatomy. ● CANON TCD-057 (II.14)

The controlling generation hasn't drafted it. *Chapter 29.docx* has, as a candidate (◪ SUPPORTED · rewrite required), and it gets a great deal right.

The candidate scene. Atlas collapses in the Conduit Trial. Katherine laces her fingers through his and presses their palms flat, "forcing contact the way her mother had taught her. Press here. Hold here. Eyes closed. Don't let go." Her Frost pours into him and doesn't behave like her power: "It didn't bite outward. It went into him." His Frost "reached back. Barely." Lines write themselves up both their forearms, matching, permanent. The black veining stops, then retreats. The Prayer takes long enough that London Town claims its second conduit, and Old Prosperity loses the Challenge.

The words, as the candidate draft has them. This is manuscript text in a rewrite-required file, not canon wording:

> By Elder's right. By covenant sworn— / I stake my claim. / Frost to frost, I bind your name— / For life we'll share. Through better or worse— / Let death know my name first.

CHECKED AGAINST THE RULINGS.

ELEMENT OF THE CANDIDATE	RULING	VERDICT
Atlas is actively dying of magical dysregulation; the Prayer stops the veining	TCD-051, TCD-057	Compatible: a viable pattern restored at the dying threshold
Michelle taught Katherine the contact	TCD-023 (transmission open)	Compatible; it would make Michelle a link in the Remnian transmission chain ◌ POSSIBLE

ELEMENT OF THE CANDIDATE	RULING	VERDICT
Katherine's Frost flows into Atlas	TCD-057 rejects a Frost-only ritual as the objective reading	Compatible as Katherine's expression, not as the Prayer's definition
The veining vanishes entirely	TCD-051 (progressive)	Tension; see IV.16
Permanent matching marks; vow-like language	Not ruled	◌ POSSIBLE Possible
No echo of Selah	TCD-048	Compatible; nothing in the scene draws on 3SL

The public version, as the candidate draft stages it. The Prayer happens on live broadcast. The announcers call it "an ancient Frost binding ritual. Once begun, it cannot be stopped," and "something we have never seen before in a Tournament"; the crowd chants KATHERINE! ATLAS! That's exactly the kind of institutional misreading II.15 tracks: Remnia's public knows it as a Frost bond, and its objective function is broader. If this staging survives, the Prayer stops being a family secret the moment Katherine performs it, and every viewer who knows the old rite now knows she knows it.

COPYEDIT FLAG (FTE DEVELOPMENT FILE)

Chapter 29.docx writes "Elder's Prayer" and spells her name "Nicolas" in the announcers' lines. The Companion spelling is **Elders' Prayer**; her name is Nicholas.

OPEN

Is there a second performance?

TCD-057 leaves the Prayer's effects "on Atlas/Melena" open, and the audit's open issues include "Katherine–Melena sanctioned action/prayer mechanics." The Challenges plan has Katherine perform it on Melena in the Duel. Whether Katherine's decisive act for Melena is a Prayer, and what a second performance would cost her, isn't ruled.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE PRAYER IN FTE · ○ OPEN

FIXED
Function, limits, independence from Selah (TCD-023, TCD-048, TCD-057); Katherine performs it for Atlas (TCD-009).

UNDECIDED
When (the candidate puts it at the end of Challenge Four); the caster's cost; whether contact or a bond is required; whether marks are permanent; whether the broadcast happens; whether it's performed again for Melena.

WHY IT MATTERS
If Katherine has already spent the Prayer on Atlas in public, the Sanctum has seen it, and the Duel's audience knows what she can do.

DECIDE BY
Timing and cost before *Chapter 29.docx* is rewritten into the Beta.

WORKING SPACE · THE PRAYER IN FTE

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-009, TCD-023, TCD-048, TCD-051, TCD-057; Chapter 29.docx; The Challenges FTE Year. Record: Elders' Prayer Transmission + Variant / Functional Anatomy Record.*

SEE ALSO

II.14 The Elders' Prayer · **p.42**

III.16 Selah and the Elders' Prayer in 3SL → FTE concordance · **p.216**

IV.16 Atlas: The Synchronization Injury · **p.163**

VII.7 Repeated Working and Ritual Registry → FTE concordance · **p.216**

IV.18 SUPPORTING CAST

Role and current status for recurring Remnian figures.

The cast below is limited to people with a drafted footprint or a ruled role. Where a supporting file adds something, it's labeled.

LONDON TOWN

NAME	ROLE	ON THE PAGE	SUPPORTING DETAIL	WATCH
Tiran Blackwood	Queen's Bishop; Flamer	Rescues Melena and Cordelia disguised as a Sanctum official on Caelum's arrangement, "on a run for Maven" (chs. 8–9); grounds her in the Maze (ch. 22); white locs, emerald eyes	*Character Bible*: heir to the Dukedom of Zenithia; white-gold hair, obsidian eyes. *31–39*: House Blackwood colors, violet on black; addressed "Your Grace"	Appearance ◇ CONFLICT; Zenithia title ◇ CONFLICT (IV.3). Did the 3SL cleanup (TCD-002)
Maxim Augustine	King; Terrain	Walks into a Maze built to suppress Terrain	—	Alive, conscious, and authorizes the forfeit ● CANON TCD-052
Cordelia Lockwood	Melena's sister; seventeen	Frost, "second generation" (ch. 8); crimson hair, amber eyes; "topped the Bishop cut"; caught in the Protocol 17 violation	*31–39*: visits before the Duel; sister code	Not on the Placements roster
Raven	London Town's handler	Midnight Tournament jacket with medals; neutralizing cuffs; suppressor rod	—	—
Seraphina, Astor, Luke, Viv	Backline	Seraphina: blonde, green eyes	*31–39*: all in Heart's Mirror	—
Ellis Vale	King's Rook; Blocker	—	*31–39*: shapeshifts in the Duel, redistributes injuries; dies after a refused yield	Rewrite required

NAME	ROLE	ON THE PAGE	SUPPORTING DETAIL	WATCH
Jarom Fairchild, Olivia Rembrandt	Suspended Knight; removed pawn	The augmenter incident; Sanctum probation (ch. 12)	—	—
The eight pawns	—	Ivy Lennox dies in the Maze	*31–39*: all eight named dead after Challenge Four	Name variants (IV.6)

OLD PROSPERITY

NAME	ROLE	ON THE PAGE	SUPPORTING DETAIL	WATCH
Atlas Tolliver	Queen's Bishop; Frost; Legion Captain	IV.16	*Character Bible*: born 2073 ER; twin of Dax by two minutes; 6'6"; silver eyes	Injury ● CANON TCD-051
Dax Tolliver	King's Knight; Flamer; Vanguard Captain	"His Vanguard jacket hung open like rules were optional"	*Character Bible*: fire-based and electrical abilities from an Elite mother	*31–39*: senses Katherine through the tether
Reign Woods	Queen's Rook; Terrain	Katherine's closest friend; holds position alone in the jungle	*31–39*: first to see Katherine's hands after the Mirror	—
Sebastian Augustine	King's Bishop; Flamer	Rockslide injury in C1; "History was numbers to them. Katherine was the answer key."	*31–39*: has shielded Zephyr's secret for years	—

NAME	ROLE	ON THE PAGE	SUPPORTING DETAIL	WATCH
Zephyr Augustine	Queen's Knight; registered Flamer; a true Dyad	Guards Melena in an ice cave, both elements visible; "Year Ten. Early Apprenticeship. Combat Protocol Division."	*31–39*: since thirteen	Registration ◇ CONFLICT (IV.10)
Houston Maddison	King's Rook; Frost	Saved from lava by Katherine	*31–39*: the camera blind spot; kills Ellis in the Duel	Rewrite required
Beckett Rhodes	Pawn; Terrain	Dies in the Maze; Atlas: "Old Prosperity Legion Platoon Nine. Squad Four. Son of Linda and Timothy Rhodes. Recently promoted to Sergeant."	—	—
Nova Chen, Blair Faelan, Justin Duran, Tegan Morrows, Griffin Hale	Pawns	Nova guides Katherine in the jungle; Justin wounded by a construct	*31–39*: all pawns dead by Four's end	—
Nico	Old Prosperity's handler	"I am not your friend. I am not your therapist."	—	—
Michelle Nicholas	Katherine's mother	IV.12	*31–39*: watches with Dalia and the Tollivers	● CANON TCD-040, TCD-059

THE CROWN AND BEYOND

NAME	ROLE	ON THE PAGE
Empress Aracelia	Sovereign	Signs the letter; watches Melena through Helena's eyes in *31–39*
Helena	Aracelia's aide; runs Melena's schedule	Complaints, trade delegations; *31–39*: Aracelia's friend of thirty years
Dalia Augustine	London Town royalty; mother of the four Augustines	*31–39* only
Maven	Shadowmere; green eyes; "the closest she ever came to maternal concern"	Mother Rae in 3SL (II.4)
Caelum	Cross-land actor	IV.15
General Gareth Thorne	Signs High Command's orders	Front matter

GUARDRAIL

Repeated names.

General Gareth Thorne is not connected to Professor Alexander Thorne, Elias's Somnorian identity. *Welcome to Remnia*'s Director Rowan Mercer is not connected to Dante Mercer of 3SL. The "Blackwood" in Remy's 3SL access phrase ("Blackwood, Moreno, Aether") and House Aether's name aren't established as references to Tiran's family or to Somnoria's House. Similar nouns aren't evidence.

SOURCE *TCD-002, TCD-051, TCD-052; FTE Beta front matter, chs. 1–3, 8–9, 12, 15–19, 22; 49th Placements; Character Bible; Welcome to Remnia; FTE 31–39.*

SEE ALSO III.13 Supporting Cast → FTE concordance · p.216 | IV.19 Minho Augustine · p.173 | Appendix B High-Impact Conflict Register · p.251

DOSSIER · ARC WORKSHEET · PART IV · FOR THEIR ENTERTAINMENT / REMNIA

IV.19 MINHO AUGUSTINE

Hold space for an unfinished arc.

Minho's death is not assumed. ● CANON TCD-009. The legacy draft killed him, and the ruling retired that: his current arc has to be found first, and death may only return if it becomes earned and indispensable to his own arc or to Tandem's consequences. That makes Minho the least-settled major character in FTE and the one most at risk of being written by momentum.

WHAT THE SOURCES ESTABLISH.

	MINHO	STATUS
Piece	Old Prosperity's King; Blocker	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Command	Captain of the En Guard, succeeding Michelle two months before ch. 1	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Family	Dalia's son; brother of Maxim (London Town's King), Sebastian, and Zephyr	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT; *Character Bible*
Birth, title	2074 ER; a London Town prince who gave up his claim to join Old Prosperity's military; youngest En Guard Captain ever	◩ SUPPORTED (*Character Bible*)
Blocker abilities	Shapeshifting and telepathic communication; eyes and hair that shift	◩ SUPPORTED (*Character Bible*; Factions file)
History with Atlas	Atlas nearly killed him three years before FTE	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (ch. 7)
History with Melena	Grew up alongside her and Elias	◩ SUPPORTED (*Character Bible*)

Minho under pressure, as drafted. In the tundra he refuses Katherine's search, then relents: "Bring him back." She reads it as fear for Zephyr he can't say out loud. At the Maze, he goes rigid when he realizes Maxim, a Terrain, is walking into a maze built to suppress Terrain. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 17, 21) In *31–39* (◩ SUPPORTED) he takes command the moment he sees Katherine's wrists, orders the lens blinded, calls her a Dyad, turns on Sebastian for hiding Zephyr, and names her his successor to the En Guard.

Minho arc worksheet. Pre-filled where the sources speak.

THREAD	WHAT EXISTS	WHAT WOULD MAKE IT AN ARC	STATUS
Command	En Guard Captain; King Piece; succession to Katherine (*31–39*)	What command costs him; what he'd sacrifice it for	○ OPEN
Brothers	Maxim across the Board; Zephyr's secret; Sebastian's cover-up	Whether the Tournament forces a brother against a brother	○ OPEN
Katherine	Commander and protector; the *Character Bible* has him watching her for years for reasons of his own	What he knows, if anything, about her father; why he protects her	○ OPEN · don't infer knowledge from proximity
Melena	Childhood rivalry and loyalty (*Character Bible*)	Whether he's a channel between the sisters	◌ POSSIBLE
Fate	Not assumed dead (TCD-009)	Death only if earned and indispensable	○ OPEN

GUARDRAIL

Dalia sending her sons to Michelle's house after Tobias died (*31–39* ch. 31) puts Minho near Michelle as a boy. It doesn't make him know anything. If Minho knows about Katherine's father, that's a ruling to make, not a conclusion to draw.

IV.19 · MINHO AUGUSTINE

CONTINUED

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · MINHO · ○ OPEN

FIXED
He isn't assumed dead (TCD-009); his position, command, and family as drafted.

UNDECIDED
His arc; his agenda; his knowledge of Katherine; his role in the Duel and the forfeit; his fate.

WHY IT MATTERS
Katherine's Conqueror title moves her past both her King and her commanders. Minho's reaction is the first measure of what that means in Old Prosperity.

DECIDE BY
Before his Duel matchup against Maxim is drafted.

WORKING SPACE · MINHO

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-009; FTE Beta chs. 1, 7, 17, 21; Character Bible; FTE Elemental Factions; FTE 31–39 chs. 31, 38–39.*

SEE ALSO IV.18 Supporting Cast · **p.169**

IV.20 The Endgame: Forfeit and Command Authority · **p.176**

IV.20 THE ENDGAME: FORFEIT AND COMMAND AUTHORITY

Lock the causal chain.

Old Prosperity wins because London Town forfeits after Challenge Six. ● CANON TCD-009. The forfeit is an act of agency on three levels at once, and the rulings keep the levels apart. ● CANON TCD-042, TCD-052

The causal chain. Every link is ruled; none is drafted.

#	LINK	WHO	RULING
1	Katherine's Frost configuration catastrophically fails; the older capacity reroutes as Fire	Katherine	TCD-058
2	Katherine's final sanctioned action against or for Melena prevents catastrophe and saves or stabilizes Melena	Katherine	TCD-042
3	That action creates the decisive state	Katherine	TCD-034, TCD-042
4	Melena consciously chooses survival over victory, rather than sacrificing more people to reach Challenge Seven	Melena	TCD-042, TCD-052
5	Tiran advises, supports, and operationalizes her choice; he can't surrender the province on his own authority	Tiran	TCD-042, TCD-052
6	Melena brings the decision to Maxim, or endorses it to him	Melena → Maxim	TCD-052
7	Maxim, alive, conscious, and acting as King, formally enters or authorizes the forfeit	Maxim	TCD-052
8	The Sanctum accepts and formalizes it; it may exploit the outcome but doesn't compel it	The Sanctum	TCD-042, TCD-052
9	Katherine is Conqueror	—	TCD-034

Atlas and Tiran's confrontation happens in the same climax and is officially a draw by intervention. ● CANON TCD-034. The sister reveal's confrontation stage lands here too (IV.13).

Tournament Command Authority. What each rank can do, as far as the rulings go.

RANK	CAN	CAN'T	OPEN
King	Formally enter or authorize a provincial forfeit (Maxim)	—	Whether the King alone holds that power in every case
Queen	Make the substantive decision and bring it to the King (Melena)	Surrender the province on her own, as far as ruled	Her emergency authority if the King is down
Bishop	Advise, support, operationalize (Tiran)	Surrender the province on rank alone	Anything beyond that
Any Piece	Surrender individually in a bout (*31–39*: a verbal yield)	—	The difference between individual yield and provincial forfeit
The Sanctum	Accept, verify, formalize	Be the original cause of this forfeit	Its veto

NOT THE SAME AS

Tournament command and military command.

In *31–39* ch. 39, Minho names Corporal Katherine his successor for the En Guard and Atlas names her for the Legion, citing a protocol that lets a commanding officer name a successor regardless of rank. That's Old Prosperity's military chain, not Tournament authority. It doesn't give Katherine the power to forfeit or accept a forfeit, and it doesn't change who formally acts for London Town.

SUPERSEDED

The legacy ending centered Tiran's announcement and incapacitated Maxim to make room for it. Retired by TCD-042 and TCD-052. Melena as the breaking villain who hands Katherine the win is retired by TCD-009.

Why Challenge Seven matters here. Melena's choice is a choice against something. The reader has to know what continuing costs: which Pieces would have to die, what the Sanctum has promised or threatened, what the Seventh would have been. Without that, the forfeit reads as collapse instead of agency (IV.7).

IV.20 · THE ENDGAME: FORFEIT AND COMMAND AUTHORITY

CONTINUED

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE FORFEIT · ○ OPEN

FIXED
The whole causal chain and every role in it (TCD-009, TCD-034, TCD-042, TCD-052, TCD-058).

UNDECIDED
Katherine's exact sanctioned action; the Frost-failure beat; what makes Challenge Seven unacceptable; Maxim's first response; the private and public procedure; emergency authority for King, Queen, and Bishop.

WHY IT MATTERS
This is the ending. Every open cell here is a blank in the last chapters.

DECIDE BY
Before the Duel is drafted.

WORKING SPACE · THE FORFEIT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-007, TCD-009, TCD-034, TCD-042, TCD-050, TCD-052, TCD-058; FTE 31–39 ch. 39. Record: FTE Forfeit Causal Chain + Command Authority Protocol.*

SEE ALSO IV.8 Conqueror Rules · **p.77** | IV.13 The Sister Reveal · **p.153** | IV.24 FTE Endgame Packet · **p.187**

IV.21 PLOT STATE

Drafted vs development vs open.

Where FTE stands, in three layers: what's drafted, what's in development, and what's ruled but unwritten.

LAYER	COVERAGE	STATUS
Drafted	Front matter through ch. 28; ch. 29 partial. Part One: The Pieces; Part Two: The Tournament; Part Three: The Conqueror (begun)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
In development	The Prayer chapter (*Chapter 29.docx*); chs. 31–39. No ch. 30 in any source.	◩ SUPPORTED · rewrite required
Ruled, unwritten	Melena's investigation; the Duel; Frost failure and Fire; Katherine's decisive act; the confrontation; Atlas–Tiran draw; the forfeit; Katherine as Conqueror; verification; Michelle's testimony	● CANON TCD-034, TCD-042, TCD-050, TCD-052, TCD-058
Unruled, unwritten	Aftermath; Board seat; Minho's arc; Elias; the handoff into TSWK and the next Shadowmere book	○ OPEN

The drafted book, chapter by chapter. POV alternates, except for three back-to-back runs: chs. 8–9 (Melena), 10–11 and 25–26 (Katherine).

CH.	POV	BEAT
1	K	Katherine's evaluation; Michelle's banner; the summons
2	M	Shadowmere; Maven; Caelum's recruitment
3–6	K / M	Old Prosperity strategy seminar; Atlas; palace, reception, Zenithia
7	K	The Examination: Fire trauma, Frost response
8–9	M	In disguise; Protocol 17; Tiran's rescue; Delegation
10–11	K	Delegation and its aftermath
12	M	The augmenter; Code Sixteen
13	K	The fence; Havenwood; Nico
14	M	London Town's House; Raven; Melena's first speech

IV.21 · PLOT STATE

CONTINUED

CH.	POV	BEAT
15–18	K / M	Challenge One: jungle, lava, tundra; the rescue; Zephyr's two elements
19–20	K / M	Challenge Two: the Breathbound Law and the Writ
21–24	K / M	Challenge Three: the Maze; Beckett and Ivy die; the Remy memory
25–26	K	Aftermath; Katherine and Atlas
27–28	M / K	Toward and into Challenge Four; Atlas's black veins
29	M	Med bay (partial)

Chapter beats for 3–6, 10–11, and 25–27 are summarized from the map and targeted reads, not a full pass.

SOURCE *TCD-001, TCD-034, TCD-042, TCD-050, TCD-052, TCD-058; FTE Beta (chapter map); Chapter 29.docx; FTE 31–39.*

SEE ALSO IV.1 Book Identity and Source Status · **p.51** | IV.24 FTE Endgame Packet · **p.187** | IV.25 FTE Open Development · **p.190**

IV.22 KNOWLEDGE PROGRESSION

Who knows what, when, across the book.

FTE is two women learning, from opposite directions, that the official story about their family is wrong. It's also an Empire learning, in public, that one of its Queens has an element she shouldn't. Those are different knowledge problems, and the ledger keeps them separate.

Seed ledger. Dated to where it's shown; nothing is promoted to a whole society.

WHO	WHEN	KNOWS OR BELIEVES	LANE	STATUS
Melena	Ch. 2, before Caelum	"There's nothing outside of Remnia anymore"	Character belief	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Melena	Ch. 2, after Caelum	Somnoria exists; Elias lives there as Thorne; the borders are closed but crossable	Character knowledge: existence, route (claimed)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Katherine	Ch. 13	Michelle's caution looks like a fence	Character knowledge (suspicion of her own life)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Melena	Ch. 18	Zephyr has two elements; tells Raven she saw nothing	Character knowledge; deliberately withheld	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Katherine	Ch. 17	Has seen Zephyr's two elements	Character knowledge	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Katherine	Ch. 19	The unmarked text resembles the Breathbound Law; she dismisses the thought	Character knowledge, then chosen belief	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
London Town and Old Prosperity Pieces	Ch. 11–13	They're filmed, owned, and edited for broadcast	Character knowledge	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT

WHO	WHEN	KNOWS OR BELIEVES	LANE	STATUS
Sebastian	Before FTE	Zephyr is a Dyad	Character knowledge	◩ SUPPORTED (*31–39*)
Cordelia	Ch. 38 of *31–39*	Elias "vanished into a foreign country"; a sealed file on his "illness"	Character knowledge? belief?	◩ SUPPORTED; see flag
The Remnian public	Any point	Whether Somnoria is known at all	Institutional / public	○ OPEN
The Remnian public	*Chapter 29.docx*	The Prayer is "an ancient Frost binding ritual"	Institutional / public	◩ SUPPORTED

KNOWLEDGE FLAG

Who in Remnia knows other lands exist?

Melena's ch. 2 belief says a princess who has toured the provinces didn't. Cordelia in *31–39* speaks of Elias vanishing "into a foreign country." The *Remnian Timeline Before Story Start* (repeated in the unaudited *Imperial Lineage*) gives the heir apparent the traditional title "Duke of Somnoria" "as a means of fostering relations with the neighboring empire." Those three can't all describe the same public. TCD-016 says awareness varies by class, institution, and time; it doesn't say how it varies in Remnia. ○ OPEN · decide before any Remnian character names Somnoria on-page again.

GUARDRAIL

Author knowledge doesn't travel into FTE heads. Katherine doesn't know she's Tobias's daughter, doesn't know what her magic objectively is, and doesn't know Selah exists. Melena doesn't know Katherine is her sister until her own investigation gives her reason to suspect it.

SOURCE *TCD-016, TCD-032, TCD-040, TCD-050; FTE Beta chs. 2, 11–13, 17–19; FTE 31–39 ch. 38; Chapter 29.docx; FTE Remnian Timeline Before Story Start; The Imperial Lineage (unaudited). Record: Knowledge of the Other Lands Matrix.*

SEE ALSO I.5 Knowledge States · **p.18** | II.4 Knowledge of the Other Lands · **p.29** | VII.5 Cross-Land Knowledge Matrix → FTE concordance · **p.216**

NOTES · IV.22

CONNECTION TABLE · PART IV · FOR THEIR ENTERTAINMENT / REMNIA

IV.23 CROSS-BOOK CONNECTIONS

Only supported links.

FTE touches all three other books, and every touch has to be sourced. A connection exists when a ruling or a drafted page makes it. Everything else goes in the second table.

CONNECTION	BOOKS	WHAT IT IS	STATUS
Remy's death and its memory	3SL → FTE	The gang leader kills Remy while he protects Melena; FTE carries her guilt and her version (ch. 22)	● CANON TCD-002, TCD-063; ■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (memory)
Tiran Blackwood	3SL → FTE	Same man; his 3SL cleanup; his FTE rescue "on a run for Maven"	● CANON TCD-002; ■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Maven / Mother Rae	3SL → FTE	Shadowmere's route-keeper in both books	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (both)
Lucia's letter	3SL → FTE	"Find the woman with the silver bells. Tell her Lucia's daughter needs a passage to nowhere" (FTE ch. 2); 3SL ch. 3's letter and route phrase	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (both)
Melena's two years in Shadowmere	3SL → FTE	She stays in the Underside through the interval	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (FTE ch. 2); interval ● CANON TCD-013
Elias / Professor Thorne	FTE ⇔ ADST	Voluntary double life; compromised by the Nightmare organization; missing from Remnia first	● CANON TCD-032, TCD-062
Elias in Shadowmere	FTE ⇔ 3SL setting	Melena last saw him there six months before FTE, with a gash (ch. 2)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Caelum	FTE ⇔ ADST (and 3SL setting)	Independent cross-land actor; recruits Melena in Shadowmere; his cousin Cassius	● CANON TCD-031, TCD-043
The Elders' Prayer	3SL ⇔ FTE	Same inherited working, two independent performances	● CANON TCD-023, TCD-048, TCD-057

CONNECTION	BOOKS	WHAT IT IS	STATUS
The Breathbound Law beside the Writ	FTE ⇔ ADST (textual)	First on-page comparison of two Shattered Veil descendants (ch. 19)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT; ● CANON TCD-047
The Remnia–Underside crossing	3SL ⇔ FTE	Exists near the London Town / Old Prosperity / Alea no-man's-land	● CANON TCD-027; coordinate ○ OPEN
Convergence	All four	Late FTE is a major Remnian manifestation, not yet a proven equal trigger; ADST's climax is T0	● CANON TCD-056
Chronology	FTE ⇔ ADST	FTE begins a couple of weeks after ADST opens; they end around the same time	● CANON TCD-013
Handoff	FTE → TSWK, next Shadowmere	Direct rolling handoff; days or small weeks	● CANON TCD-054

Not connections. These look like links and aren't, unless a ruling makes them one.

RESEMBLANCE	WHY IT DOESN'T COUNT
General Gareth Thorne / Professor Alexander Thorne	A shared surname in different books
Director Rowan Mercer / Dante Mercer	A shared surname in different books
Zephyr Windrider (2092) / Zephyr Augustine	A shared first name in a Supporting file
The Factions file's "The Veil" / the Shattered Veil	A shared noun
"Aether" in Remy's access phrase / House Aether	A shared noun; nothing rules a link

IV.23 · CROSS-BOOK CONNECTIONS

CONTINUED

RESEMBLANCE	WHY IT DOESN'T COUNT
Old Prosperity's frozen no-man's-land / the TCD-027 crossing's no-man's-land	Both are border wastes; the ruling doesn't place the crossing on Old Prosperity's wall
Selah's cold / Katherine's Frost	Imagery; the Prayer isn't a Frost working (II.14)
Katherine, Zephyr, Cassius as "Crossbloods"	A contested label; each case stands alone (TCD-036)

SOURCE *TCD-002, TCD-013, TCD-016, TCD-023, TCD-027, TCD-031, TCD-032, TCD-036, TCD-043, TCD-047, TCD-048, TCD-054, TCD-056, TCD-057, TCD-062, TCD-063; FTE Beta chs. 2, 8–9, 19, 22; 3SL draft ch. 3.*

SEE ALSO Part VII The Continuity Room → FTE concordance · **p.216**

NOTES · IV.23

IV.24 FTE ENDGAME PACKET

Pages beside the manuscript while chs. 30–39 are rewritten.

These are the pages that sit open beside the Duel. The rulings have fixed more of FTE's ending than of any other book's, so this packet is mostly non-negotiables and a short list of blanks.

Stop points. The Beta stops in ch. 29 with Melena in the med bay after Challenge Four, told she's "the third most powerful person in Remnia." The development chapters stop after the Duel's first bout, with Katherine in the viewing box watching Houston kill Ellis. Everything between the two is provisional.

CONDITIONS AT THE BETA'S STOP POINT.

CHARACTER	CONDITION
Atlas	Black veins to his cheekbones from the Conduit Trial (ch. 28)
Melena	In the med bay (ch. 29)
Katherine	Frost only; lover of Atlas since ch. 26; has seen Zephyr's two elements
Old Prosperity	Wins in Challenges One and Two; Beckett dead
London Town	Ivy dead; penalized in Challenge Two

NON-NEGOTIABLES

- **Katherine's magic.** Frost-dominant until the climax. Fire comes only when her Frost configuration catastrophically fails, and never from stress, heat, grief, or Melena. She's not Zephyr's kind of Dyad, whatever the Sanctum calls her. Heart's Mirror can foreshadow; she walks out of it Frost-dominant, and nothing inside it is proof of her past. (TCD-049, TCD-058; author ruling, 2026-09-26)
- **The reveal.** Melena suspects before the Duel, from her own investigation. The Duel confirms nothing. Records prove it; Michelle explains it. (TCD-050)
- **Katherine's reason.** She saves or stabilizes Melena from her own moral arc, not only because they're sisters. (TCD-050)
- **The forfeit.** Melena chooses; Tiran supports; Maxim, alive and conscious, authorizes; the Sanctum accepts. (TCD-042, TCD-052)
- **The title.** Katherine is Conqueror. Atlas and Tiran draw by intervention. (TCD-034)
- **Atlas.** The injury started in the Trial. No earlier cause. (TCD-051)
- **The Prayer.** Restores a viable pattern; no resurrection, no regeneration, no echo of Selah. (TCD-048, TCD-057)
- **Melena.** Not the villain. (TCD-009)
- **Minho.** Not assumed dead. (TCD-009)
- **Remy.** The gang leader killed him. Melena's guilt is real and forensically wrong. (TCD-063)
- **The count.** The Tournament was built for seven; the Sanctum ends it at Six. (TCD-007)

SCENE-LEVEL OPEN CHOICES BEFORE THE DUEL

CHOICE	BLOCKS THE DUEL?
Katherine's exact sanctioned action for Melena	Yes
The beat that breaks Katherine's Frost	Yes
How Heart's Mirror foreshadows Katherine's capacity without activating it (ruled: foreshadowing only, 2026-09-26)	Yes, for rewriting *31–39*
Melena's first clue and her pre-Duel evidence	Yes
Challenge Six's actual kill rules and the Sanctum's real policy	Yes

IV.24 · FTE ENDGAME PACKET

CONTINUED

CHOICE	BLOCKS THE DUEL?
What Challenge Seven would demand	Yes, for Melena's choice
When the Prayer for Atlas happens and what it costs	Yes, if it's in Challenge Four
Maxim's first response to Melena	Only in the forfeit scene
Atlas's condition at the Duel	Likely
Minho's arc	Only if his bout is drafted
Board seat powers	No; aftermath

SOURCE *TCD-007, TCD-009, TCD-034, TCD-042, TCD-048, TCD-049, TCD-050, TCD-051, TCD-052, TCD-057, TCD-058, TCD-063; FTE Beta chs. 17, 22, 26, 28–29; FTE 31–39 ch. 39.*

SEE ALSO IV.10 Katherine's Elemental Anatomy · **p.83** | IV.13 The Sister Reveal · **p.153** | IV.20 The Endgame: Forfeit and Command Authority · **p.176**

NOTES · IV.24

IV.25 FTE OPEN DEVELOPMENT

Every open FTE item in one place, sorted by when it has to be decided.

ITEM	FIXED	UNDECIDED	DECIDE BY
Katherine's decisive act	Saves or stabilizes Melena; creates the decisive state (TCD-042)	The act itself; whether it's a Prayer	Before the Duel
Frost failure and Fire	Climax, catastrophic, rerouted (TCD-058); Heart's Mirror foreshadows only (author ruling, 2026-09-26)	The beat; switching; cost	Before the Duel
Melena's investigation	Before the Duel; suspicion, not proof (TCD-050)	First clue; evidence; Shadowmere knowledge	Before her next chapter
Challenge Six rules	Mirrored single combat; decisive (TCD-007; *31–39*)	Kill policy; bout order; yield rules	Before the Duel
Challenge Seven	Never held (TCD-007)	What it would have been	Before Melena's choice
The Prayer for Atlas	Katherine performs it (TCD-009)	Timing; cost; marks; broadcast	Before *Chapter 29.docx* is rewritten
Atlas's injury	Trial origin (TCD-051)	Pathology; progression after the Prayer	Same
Forfeit procedure	Chain of agency (TCD-042, TCD-052)	Maxim's response; public procedure; emergency authority	Before the forfeit scene
Verification	Authenticated record (TCD-050)	Which record; who authenticates	Before the verification scene
Initial publicity of Katherine's birth	Owners of each concealment layer (TCD-059)	Was it ever public?	Before anyone reacts to the Nicholas name

ITEM	FIXED	UNDECIDED	DECIDE BY
Remnian knowledge of other lands	Varies by actor and time (TCD-016)	Who knows Somnoria exists	Before a Remnian names Somnoria again
How Melena classifies Shadowmere	—	Inside or outside Remnia, in her head	Before a Melena POV names the Underside
Caelum's mind-presence	Nightmare magic; not Nightmare (TCD-031)	Mechanism; range	Before it enters canon prose
Minho	Not assumed dead (TCD-009)	Arc; knowledge; fate	Before his bout
Challenge Three's result; Challenge Four's name	Four's concept (TCD-008)	Result; name	Next revision
Melena's eyes	◇ CONFLICT amber versus green	Which one	Next revision of either book
Melena's age	—	Nineteen or twenty	With the timeline
Zenithia's leadership; London Town's royal house	◇ CONFLICT	Which titles	Before Tiran's title matters on-page
Aracelia's name	◇ CONFLICT Mignonette versus Lockwood versus Hastings line	Which	Next revision
Zephyr's birth registration	◇ CONFLICT Flamer versus Frost	Which	Before his secret is exposed
"Regnant"; Rovencia; Easton/Estonian	—	Title and places	Before *31–39* is rewritten
Calendar	None ruled (TCD-010)	ER years; the "49th"; Year 847	With the Remnian timeline (VII.1)
Conqueror bylaws; Board seat	Katherine is Conqueror (TCD-034)	Powers and benefits	Aftermath
The Imperial Lineage	—	Audit status	Next audit pass

MANUSCRIPT REVISION FLAGS (NOT OPEN CANON)

FLAG	CONTROLLING ANSWER	REVISE WHERE
"Six challenges"	Seven-stage design, ended at Six ● CANON TCD-007	Beta front matter
"Months since the alley"	About two years ● CANON TCD-013	Beta, Tiran reunion
Death penalty for dualists	Code Sixteen: removal and Imperial discipline (Beta)	*31–39* ch. 38
Zephyr's secret as news to Katherine	She saw it in ch. 17 (Beta)	*31–39* ch. 38
Katherine's Fire before the climax; childhood heat	TCD-058, clarified by author ruling 2026-09-26: the Mirror foreshadows only; remove childhood Fire, post-Mirror marks and casting, dual-element casting, and Zephyr-equivalence	*31–39* chs. 34, 36–39
Mid-Duel sister realization	Staged reveal ● CANON TCD-050	*The Challenges FTE Year* C6
"Elder's Prayer"	Elders' Prayer	*Chapter 29.docx*; *The Challenges FTE Year*
"Nicolas"; "Remian Empire"	Nicholas; Remnian	*Chapter 29.docx*; Beta front matter
Sine Cauldiste / Jin Wang; Ivy's age and siblings	Placements names; one Ivy	*31–39* ch. 31, 33

Also flagged in IV.11: *FTE 31–39*'s Mirror makes Tobias a Frost and Lucia a Flamer; the Beta's ch. 8 makes Lucia a powerful Frost and gives Melena her father's fire. The Beta controls; revise the Mirror scene.

SOURCE *TCD-007, TCD-008, TCD-009, TCD-010, TCD-013, TCD-016, TCD-031, TCD-034, TCD-042, TCD-050, TCD-051, TCD-052, TCD-058, TCD-059; FTE Beta; Chapter 29.docx; FTE 31–39; The Challenges FTE Year; 49th Placements; Character Bible; Welcome to Remnia; The Imperial Lineage (unaudited).*

SEE ALSO VII.12 Open Canon Queue → FTE concordance · p.216

IV.25 FTE OPEN DEVELOPMENT

Every open FTE item, with somewhere to work on it.

GUARDRAIL

Blockers get their own pages. Everything else waits until a scene needs it.

OPEN STAYS OPEN.
The queue repeats IV.25's Fixed and Decide-by columns. Tick a box only when the prose or a ruling decides it.

ITEM	WHAT'S FIXED	DECIDE BY	SAFE TO DEFER	DECIDED	WORK ON
Katherine's decisive act BLOCKS THE DUEL	Saves or stabilizes Melena; creates the decisive state (TCD-042)	Before the Duel	☐	☐	p.196–197
Frost failure and Fire BLOCKS THE DUEL	Climax, catastrophic, rerouted (TCD-058); Heart's Mirror foreshadows only (author ruling, 2026-09-26)	Before the Duel	☐	☐	p.92
Melena's investigation BLOCKS THE DUEL	Before the Duel; suspicion, not proof (TCD-050)	Before her next chapter	☐	☐	p.198–199
Challenge Six rules BLOCKS THE DUEL	Mirrored single combat; decisive (TCD-007; *31–39*)	Before the Duel	☐	☐	p.200–201
Challenge Seven BLOCKS THE DUEL	Never held (TCD-007)	Before Melena's choice	☐	☐	p.202
The Prayer for Atlas BLOCKS THE DUEL	Katherine performs it (TCD-009)	Before *Chapter 29.docx* is rewritten	☐	☐	p.203–204
Atlas's injury BLOCKS THE DUEL	Trial origin (TCD-051)	Same	☐	☐	p.205
Forfeit procedure BLOCKS THE DUEL	Chain of agency (TCD-042, TCD-052)	Before the forfeit scene	☐	☐	p.206–207
Verification BLOCKS THE DUEL	Authenticated record (TCD-050)	Before the verification scene	☐	☐	p.208–209

ITEM	WHAT'S FIXED	DECIDE BY	SAFE TO DEFER	DECIDED	WORK ON
Initial publicity of Katherine's birth	Owners of each concealment layer (TCD-059)	Before anyone reacts to the Nicholas name	☐	☐	p.140
Remnian knowledge of other lands	Varies by actor and time (TCD-016)	Before a Remnian names Somnoria again	☐	☐	p.141
How Melena classifies Shadowmere	—	Before a Melena POV names the Underside	☐	☐	p.210–211
Caelum's mind-presence	Nightmare magic; not Nightmare (TCD-031)	Before it enters canon prose	☐	☐	p.210–211
Minho	Not assumed dead (TCD-009)	Before his bout	☐	☐	p.210–211
Challenge Three's result; Challenge Four's name	Four's concept (TCD-008)	Next revision	☐	☐	p.212–215
Melena's eyes	◇ CONFLICT amber versus green	Next revision of either book	☐	☐	p.137
Melena's age	—	With the timeline	☐	☐	p.144
Zenithia's leadership; London Town's royal house	◇ CONFLICT	Before Tiran's title matters on-page	☐	☐	p.142
Aracelia's name	◇ CONFLICT Mignonette versus Lockwood versus Hastings line	Next revision	☐	☐	p.137
Zephyr's birth registration	◇ CONFLICT Flamer versus Frost	Before his secret is exposed	☐	☐	p.89–91
"Regnant"; Rovencia; Easton/Estonian	—	Before *31–39* is rewritten	☐	☐	p.212–215

IV.25 · WORKING PAGES

CONTINUED

ITEM	WHAT'S FIXED	DECIDE BY	SAFE TO DEFER	DECIDED	WORK ON
Calendar	None ruled (TCD-010)	With the Remnian timeline (VII.1)	☐	☐	p.212–215
Conqueror bylaws; Board seat	Katherine is Conqueror (TCD-034)	Aftermath	☐	☐	p.212–215
The Imperial Lineage	—	Next audit pass	☐	☐	p.212–215

ADDED IN DRAFTING · NAME IT, DATE IT, GIVE IT A PAGE

ITEM	WHAT'S FIXED	DECIDE BY	SAFE TO DEFER	DECIDED	WORK ON
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	

RESOLVED ITEMS MOVE TO APPENDIX A WITH A LOG NO.

APPENDIX A · P.223

IV.25 THE DECISIVE ACT

● CANON

FIXED · KATHERINE'S DECISIVE ACT

Saves or stabilizes Melena; creates the decisive state (TCD-042)

UNDECIDED
The act itself; whether it's a Prayer
DECIDE BY
Before the Duel

○ OPEN

THE ACT ITSELF

What does Katherine do for Melena in the climax that creates the decisive state? Name the action and the moment, and keep it inside her own moral arc, not only sisterhood (TCD-050).

TIED TO
TCD-042 · TCD-050

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN **IS IT A PRAYER?**

Is the act a Prayer, or something else? If it's a Prayer, square it with what the Prayer can and can't do.

TIED TO
TCD-048 · TCD-057

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.25 MELENA'S INVESTIGATION

● CANON

FIXED · MELENA'S INVESTIGATION

Before the Duel; suspicion, not proof (TCD-050)

UNDECIDED
First clue; evidence; Shadowmere knowledge
DECIDE BY
Before her next chapter

○ OPEN

FIRST CLUE

What is Melena's first clue, where does she find it, and in which chapter?

TIED TO
TCD-050 · IV.13

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

EVIDENCE BEFORE THE DUEL

List what she holds by the Duel. For each item: what it suggests, and what it can't prove.

TIED TO
TCD-050: suspicion, not proof

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

WHAT SHADOWMERE GAVE HER

What does she already know from Shadowmere and Lucia's trail that points toward Katherine?

TIED TO
IV.13 · IV.14

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.25 CHALLENGE SIX RULES

● CANON	FIXED · CHALLENGE SIX RULES Mirrored single combat; decisive (TCD-007; *31–39*)	UNDECIDED Kill policy; bout order; yield rules DECIDE BY Before the Duel
○ OPEN	KILL POLICY What does the Sanctum actually allow in a bout, and what does it say in public?	TIED TO TCD-007 · IV.7

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN **BOUT ORDER**

TIED TO IV.6 roster

List the bouts in order: who fights whom, and why the Sanctum sets it that way.

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN **YIELD RULES**

TIED TO IV.7

How does a bout end short of death, and who can call it?

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.25 CHALLENGE SEVEN

● CANON

FIXED · CHALLENGE SEVEN

Never held (TCD-007)

UNDECIDED
What it would have been
DECIDE BY
Before Melena's choice

○ OPEN

WHAT IT WOULD HAVE BEEN

What would Challenge Seven have demanded? It has to be something Melena chooses to stop from happening.

TIED TO
TCD-007 · TCD-042

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.25 THE PRAYER FOR ATLAS

● CANON

FIXED · THE PRAYER FOR ATLAS

Katherine performs it (TCD-009)

UNDECIDED
Timing; cost; marks; broadcast
DECIDE BY
Before *Chapter 29.docx* is rewritten

○ OPEN

TIMING

When does Katherine perform the Prayer for Atlas? The candidate scene puts it at the end of Challenge Four (Chapter 29.docx).

TIED TO
TCD-009 · IV.17

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

COST

What does the Prayer cost the caster?

TIED TO
IV.17

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN **MARKS**

Does it leave marks, and where?

TIED TO
IV.17 · IV.5

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN **BROADCAST**

Does the broadcast show it? Who sees it, and what does the Sanctum learn?

TIED TO
IV.4 · IV.24

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.25 ATLAS'S INJURY

● CANON

FIXED · ATLAS'S INJURY

Trial origin (TCD-051)

UNDECIDED
Pathology; progression after the Prayer
DECIDE BY
Same

○ OPEN

PATHOLOGY

Is Atlas's injury acute Element Rot or its own pathology? What is its anatomy?

TIED TO
TCD-051 · IV.16

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

PROGRESSION

Why does it keep progressing after synchronization ends, and what does the Prayer change?

TIED TO
TCD-051 · IV.16

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.25 FORFEIT PROCEDURE

● CANON	FIXED · FORFEIT PROCEDURE Chain of agency (TCD-042, TCD-052)	UNDECIDED Maxim's response; public procedure; emergency authority DECIDE BY Before the forfeit scene
○ OPEN	MAXIM'S RESPONSE What does Maxim say and do when Melena brings him the choice? He is alive and conscious, and he authorizes.	TIED TO TCD-042 · TCD-052

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN **PUBLIC PROCEDURE**

How is a forfeit made official on the board, in front of the cameras?

TIED TO
IV.8 · IV.20

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN **EMERGENCY AUTHORITY**

Under what authority does a King forfeit mid-Challenge, and who could contest it?

TIED TO
IV.3 · IV.20

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.25 VERIFICATION

● CANON

FIXED · VERIFICATION

Authenticated record (TCD-050)

UNDECIDED
Which record; who authenticates
DECIDE BY
Before the verification scene

○ OPEN

WHICH RECORD

Which record verifies the paternity, who made it, and where is it kept? The Sanctum keeps the records (TCD-059).

TIED TO
TCD-050 · TCD-059

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN **WHO AUTHENTICATES**

Who authenticates it, and why is their word enough?

TIED TO
TCD-050 · IV.13

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.25 MELENA, CAELUM, MINHO

○ OPEN

HOW MELENA CLASSIFIES SHADOWMERE · FIXED

Nothing fixed.

DECIDE BY
Before a Melena POV names the Underside

○ OPEN

INSIDE OR OUTSIDE

In Melena's head, is Shadowmere inside Remnia, outside it, or no place a map would name?

TIED TO
IV.2 knowledge flag

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

● CANON

CAELUM'S MIND-PRESENCE · FIXED

Nightmare magic; not Nightmare (TCD-031)

DECIDE BY
Before it enters canon prose

○ OPEN

MECHANISM AND RANGE

How does Caelum's presence reach Melena's mind, and how far does it carry? It's Nightmare magic; he isn't Nightmare.

TIED TO
TCD-031 · IV.15

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

● CANON	MINHO · FIXED Not assumed dead (TCD-009)	DECIDE BY Before his bout
○ OPEN	ARC, KNOWLEDGE, FATE What does Minho want in FTE, what does he know about Katherine, and where does he end? His death isn't assumed.	TIED TO TCD-009 · IV.19

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

IV.25 CHALLENGES, TITLES, CALENDAR, BOARD

● CANON	CHALLENGE THREE'S RESULT; CHALLENGE FOUR'S NAME · FIXED Four's concept (TCD-008)	DECIDE BY Next revision
○ OPEN	RESULT AND NAME Who wins Challenge Three? What is Challenge Four's canon name? ("The Conduit Trials" is a working title.)	TIED TO TCD-008 · IV.7

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN	**"REGNANT"; ROVENCIA; EASTON/ESTONIAN · FIXED** Nothing fixed.	DECIDE BY Before *31–39* is rewritten
○ OPEN	**TITLE AND PLACES** Is “Regnant” a real Remnian title? Is Rovencia a province? Easton or “Estonian”?	TIED TO IV.2 · IV.3. New evidence: BSS and TLE use “Regnant” for faction leaders; TLE lists Rovencia among seventeen provinces (SUPPORTED / LEGACY)

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

● CANON

CALENDAR · FIXED

None ruled (TCD-010)

DECIDE BY
With the Remnian timeline (VII.1)

○ OPEN

THE ER CALENDAR

What year is FTE in ER, what is the “49th,” and where does Year 847 sit?

TIED TO
TCD-010. TLE makes 2038 Year 13 ER but dates other births “2024 ER”; BSS runs to 2096

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

● CANON

CONQUEROR BYLAWS; BOARD SEAT · FIXED

Katherine is Conqueror (TCD-034)

DECIDE BY
Aftermath

○ OPEN

POWERS AND BENEFITS

What can a Conqueror do with the one-year Board seat, and what does it give Old Prosperity?

TIED TO
TCD-034 · IV.8

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

THE IMPERIAL LINEAGE · FIXED

Nothing fixed.

DECIDE BY
Next audit pass

○ OPEN

AUDIT STATUS

Give The Imperial Lineage an audit status.

TIED TO
This volume uses it for comparison only; every claim the Content Master quotes from it is in BSS (record, R-12)

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

CONCORDANCE · CONTINUITY ROOM · FTE SLICE

CONTINUITY ROOM: FTE CONCORDANCE

VII·FTE

Where this volume carries the FTE information behind each Continuity Room and 3SL pointer.

The full Companion's Continuity Room (Part VII) and the 3SL dossier (Part III) aren't printed in this volume. Every page here that points into them resolves to this table. The middle column is the Production Master's description of the full section; the right column names where the FTE information already sits in these pages.

FULL COMPANION SECTION	WHAT IT HOLDS (PRODUCTION MASTER)	FTE INFORMATION IN THIS VOLUME
VII.1 **Master Synchronization Timeline**	One grid: `Relative point` | `3SL` | `FTE` | `ADST` | `TSWK` | `Next Shadowmere` | `Later books` | `Cross-land consequence` | `Who knows`; four bands per book (Background Activation, Narrative Opening, Climax, Resolution); the two-year interval; Elias's double-life span; ADST T0.	FTE row of the four-band table (II.16); plot state (IV.21); the dated succession history in the lineage record, lane C; the FTE bands tracker on the following page. II.16 · p.47 IV.21 · p.179 IV.11 · p.102
VII.2 **Event Chronology vs Information Chronology**	Information-delay record `Event` | `Witness` | `First record` | `Route/communication path` | `Travel delay` | `Recipient` | `Version received` | `When they act`. Worked row: Elias's missed return.	Caelum's exchanges as cross-book transfers (IV.15); the knowledge ledger (IV.22); cross-book connections (IV.23). IV.15 · p.160 IV.22 · p.181 IV.23 · p.184

FULL COMPANION SECTION	WHAT IT HOLDS (PRODUCTION MASTER)	FTE INFORMATION IN THIS VOLUME
VII.5 **Cross-Land Knowledge Matrix**	Nation | Class | Institution | Network | Character | Time | Knows | Believes | Hidden | Status against the six knowledge levels. Priority actors: Silas, Isola, Melena, Remy, Tiran; Katherine, Atlas, Maxim, Michelle, Tobias, Sanctum; Reverie, Cassius, Caelum, Elias/Thorne, House Aether, High Council; Azrine, Levi, Tavian, Jori, House Dren, Skyhold.	The knowledge levels (II.4); FTE's dated seed ledger (IV.22); the FTE knowledge tracker in this section. II.4 · p.29 IV.22 · p.181
VII.7 **Repeated Working and Ritual Registry**	The Elders' Prayer: objective function, cultural forms, Selah's and Katherine's performances, activation conditions, death threshold, what it can't do, no direct transfer.	The Elders' Prayer can/can't frame (II.14); the FTE candidate checked against the rulings (IV.17). II.14 · p.42 IV.17 · p.166
VII.8 **Shattered Veil Reconstruction Workspace**	Master-to-variant claim comparison; four provenance chains; evidence ledger; reconstruction thresholds; exact-text vs historical-truth columns; who could reconstruct what.	The Shattered Veil and its descendant texts (II.13); Challenge Two and the Breathbound Law on the page (IV.7). II.13 · p.37 IV.7 · p.72
VII.10 **Continuity Translation Pages**	Objective event | First-book depiction | Later memory | Institutional/public version | Reader knowledge | Contradiction risk. Priority pages: Remy's death (3SL vs Melena's FTE memory); Elias missing vs Thorne deteriorating; Katherine's lineage (truth vs Crown/Sanctum/public records); House Dren Anchor history vs official mythology.	Remy's death as Melena remembers it (IV.14); Katherine's lineage: truth versus Crown, Sanctum and public records (IV.12 and the lineage record). IV.14 · p.157 IV.12 · p.150 IV.11 · p.102

FULL COMPANION SECTION	WHAT IT HOLDS (PRODUCTION MASTER)	FTE INFORMATION IN THIS VOLUME
VII.12 **Open Canon Queue**	Every open item sorted into: blocks current drafting · needed before a climax · needed before a later book · Companion-only clarification · research-required · safe to defer.	Every open FTE item (IV.25) and its working pages; the lineage decisions (lineage record, lane D); the IV.10 your-pages carry their own open items. IV.25 · p.190 IV.25 · p.193 IV.11 · p.102
Part VII	Part VII — the Continuity Room.	This concordance stands in for Part VII in this volume.
III.3 **The Underside: A Vertical Nation**	Nine tiers descending off Zenithia's side of Remnia; Crownlight and Dawnveil as surface-level tiers; Ironcross as the fully subterranean threshold; lower tiers deeper still; "Underside" as the name of a descent-organized civilization; Halflight and other tiers as established in worldbuilding.	What FTE needs from the Underside's geography: Shadowmere on Remnia's Zenithia side (IV.2 places table; II.2). IV.2 · p.54 II.2 · p.27
III.13 **Supporting Cast**	Remy, Rhea, Jude, Asha, Micah, Selah, Tiran, and others as drafted; the gang leader as the climax antagonist.	Tiran and Maven as FTE carries them (IV.18; IV.14). IV.18 · p.169 IV.14 · p.157
III.14 **Melena and Remy in Shadowmere**	Melena's hidden identity; Remy's grounding role; their attachment; her Fire instability; what 3SL gives FTE.	Melena's two years in Shadowmere as FTE inherits them (IV.14); Caelum's report of Tiran and Maven (IV.15). IV.14 · p.157 IV.15 · p.160

FULL COMPANION SECTION	WHAT IT HOLDS (PRODUCTION MASTER)	FTE INFORMATION IN THIS VOLUME
III.15 **Remy's Death: Beat Sheet and Memory Translation**	Fixed beats: Melena's Fire escalates; Remy deliberately intervenes to protect her; the gang leader mortally wounds him; she tries and fails to stop the bleeding; he dies; her Fire goes catastrophic; blaze/collapse (not the fatal mechanism); Tiran's cleanup. Beta's machete/major-artery detail as compatible candidate only. Second lane: what Melena remembers in FTE.	The Remy memory in FTE, and the ruled objective event it must stay compatible with (IV.14). IV.14 · p.157
III.16 **Selah and the Elders' Prayer in 3SL**	Selah's performance for Silas and Isola; Silas's returning breath/pulse as recovery, not resurrection; Isola's leg remaining ruined.	Selah's performance as the Prayer's other, independent instance (II.14; IV.17). II.14 · p.42 IV.17 · p.166
III.18 **Handoff into FTE and the Next Shadowmere Book**	Melena's state entering FTE; Tiran's aftermath function; Silas and Isola's separate immediate paths; the two-year interval; the next Shadowmere installment in the rolling window.	Melena's state entering FTE and the two-year interval (IV.14; II.16). IV.14 · p.157 II.16 · p.47
III.20 **3SL Open Development**	Remy-death specifics; romance specifics; tier depths; crossing placement; next Shadowmere book.	3SL open items that touch FTE: Melena's eye colour (lineage record, LC-01); Remy-death specifics (IV.14). IV.11 · p.102 IV.14 · p.157
Part III	Part III — the 3SL dossier.	Part III isn't printed in this volume; this concordance names where FTE carries what it needs from 3SL.

VII.1 · FTE BANDS · RECORD: TANDEM MASTER SYNCHRONIZATION TIMELINE II.16 · P.47

FTE and ADST rows reproduced from II.16 (the two books run concurrently). The working columns take dates and anchors as drafting fixes them.

BOOK	BAND	AS RULED / OPEN (II.16)	WORKING DATE · ANCHOR · CH.
ADST	Background activation	Elias's years-long double life as Thorne; the organization's compromise of his research and dream functioning (TCD-032, TCD-062)	
ADST	Narrative opening	When Elias goes missing (TCD-013)	
ADST	Climax	The Nightmare organization's attempted Network rupture; the first established Convergence threshold, T0 (TCD-056, TCD-060)	
ADST	Resolution	Around the same time as FTE's (TCD-013)	
FTE	Background activation	○ OPEN beyond the 3SL aftermath and the Elias clock	
FTE	Narrative opening	A couple of weeks after ADST opens (TCD-013)	
FTE	Climax	Challenge Six; the London Town forfeit (TCD-034, TCD-042, TCD-052)	
FTE	Resolution	Around the same time as ADST's (TCD-013)	

VII.5 · FTE KNOWLEDGE SEED · RECORD: KNOWLEDGE OF THE OTHER LANDS MATRIX

IV.22 · P.181

FTE rows reproduced from IV.22. Every row is dated to where it's shown; blank rows extend the matrix as drafting adds knowledge.

WHO	WHEN	KNOWS OR BELIEVES	LANE	STATUS
Melena	Ch. 2, before Caelum	"There's nothing outside of Remnia anymore"	Character belief	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Melena	Ch. 2, after Caelum	Somnoria exists; Elias lives there as Thorne; the borders are closed but crossable	Character knowledge: existence, route (claimed)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Katherine	Ch. 13	Michelle's caution looks like a fence	Character knowledge (suspicion of her own life)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Melena	Ch. 18	Zephyr has two elements; tells Raven she saw nothing	Character knowledge; deliberately withheld	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Katherine	Ch. 17	Has seen Zephyr's two elements	Character knowledge	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Katherine	Ch. 19	The unmarked text resembles the Breathbound Law; she dismisses the thought	Character knowledge, then chosen belief	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
London Town and Old Prosperity Pieces	Ch. 11–13	They're filmed, owned, and edited for broadcast	Character knowledge	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Sebastian	Before FTE	Zephyr is a Dyad	Character knowledge	◪ SUPPORTED (*31–39*)

CONTINUITY ROOM · FTE CONCORDANCE

CONTINUED

WHO	WHEN	KNOWS OR BELIEVES	LANE	STATUS
Cordelia	Ch. 38 of *31–39*	Elias "vanished into a foreign country"; a sealed file on his "illness"	Character knowledge? belief?	◪ SUPPORTED; see flag
The Remnian public	Any point	Whether Somnoria is known at all	Institutional / public	○ OPEN
The Remnian public	*Chapter 29.docx*	The Prayer is "an ancient Frost binding ritual"	Institutional / public	◪ SUPPORTED

APPENDIX · STATUS & PROVENANCE SHEET

A CANON DECISION LOG: FTE SLICE

Every author ruling this volume cites, reproduced from the audit's Canon Decision Log.

60 rulings are cited in this volume. Each row is reproduced from the Tandem Source Authority Audit — Working Record (Sep 26, 2026). Rulings this volume doesn't cite appear in the full Companion's Appendix A.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-001 2026-09-04	**Controlling FTE manuscript generation** FTE/Shared	Beta is the controlling prose generation. Chapters 31–39 are usable new-development material, but all content outside the Beta must be rewritten/integrated before it becomes canon.	SUPERSEDES FTE 2025 FINAL as prose authority; all older manuscript generations DOWNSTREAM Future FTE audits distinguish usable planning/development from canonized prose. No unwritten Beta-era ending is assumed canon.
TCD-002 2026-09-04	**3SL authority beyond drafted ch. 22** 3SL/FTE	Manuscript controls drafted events. Remy's death and Tiran's cleanup remain fixed; all other outline beats are provisional.	SUPERSEDES Outline as controlling chapter map DOWNSTREAM Remy's fate and Tiran's aftermath function stay canon; remaining structure and Silas/Isola ending require fresh development.
TCD-003 2026-09-04	**ADST authority beyond drafted ch. 19** ADST/Shared	Hybrid: current material controls the opening; the older plan retains the Prism, Nightmare, conduit climax, and sequel setup.	SUPERSEDES Older plan's superseded early execution DOWNSTREAM Later ADST architecture may use the retained climax/endgame, but must be bridged from the current manuscript generation.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-004 2026-09-04	**Graveshand/Deathwork classification** 3SL/Shared	Graveshand is inherited Graves-family magic outside the formal Six Disciplines. Deathwork is the broader category of ending-magic/effects that Graveshand can perceive, manipulate, sever, redirect, or create.	SUPERSEDES Any treatment of Graveshand as one of the formal Six Disciplines DOWNSTREAM The Companion must distinguish a formal discipline system from inherited exceptional magic and define Deathwork by function rather than institutional classification.
TCD-006 2026-09-04	**Authority of the Shattered Veil poem set** All four	The complete Shattered Veil is canon at the author/universe level. The four cultural texts are canon divergent inherited versions. Characters do not automatically possess or know the complete master text; intact in-world custody was initially left open and is resolved by TCD-047.	SUPERSEDES Any assumption that one cultural version is the complete master or that the old Full 4 plot is validated by the poem's canonicity DOWNSTREAM The Companion can compare repetition and redaction, but must separate universe truth, cultural inheritance, and character knowledge; TCD-047 establishes no known intact in-world master.
TCD-007 2026-09-04	**FTE challenge count** FTE	The Tournament is structured around seven Challenges, but reaching Challenge Seven is not guaranteed. Attrition, Checkmate, disqualification, intervention, or another decisive outcome may end it early. In current FTE, the Sanctum declares Challenge Six decisive and terminates the Tournament.	SUPERSEDES Any statement that the Tournament inherently contains only six stages or that the Seventh must occur DOWNSTREAM FTE ends after the Sixth without contradicting the seven-stage institutional design.
TCD-008 2026-09-04	**Challenge Four identity** FTE	The Conduit Trials replaces Burden and Bonds as the current Challenge Four concept. Its mechanics remain current for now, but "The Conduit Trials" is a working title; the final canon name is open.	SUPERSEDES Burden and Bonds as current Challenge Four DOWNSTREAM Mechanics may be audited now; naming must remain flagged rather than canonized.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-009 2026-09-04	**FTE endgame anchors** 3SL/FTE/Shared	Retain Atlas's deterioration and the Selah → Katherine prayer parallel; Old Prosperity wins because London Town forfeits after Challenge Six; retain the Katherine–Melena sister reveal and Katherine's hidden elemental exposure; retire Minho's assumed death and all "Melena was the villain" framing. 3SL controls the factual memory of Remy's death and Melena's fire loss-of-control event.	SUPERSEDES Minho's mandatory death; Melena-as-villain framing; generic breakdown handing Katherine victory; contradictory FTE memories of 3SL; Atlas's deterioration as an isolated accident DOWNSTREAM TCD-034, TCD-042, and TCD-049–052 now govern the Conqueror, forfeit, elemental classification, reveal architecture, Atlas origin, and Maxim's authority. Prayer transmission is clarified by TCD-048. Minho's arc, detailed climax mechanics, recovery/consequences, and unused Seventh remain open.
TCD-010 2026-09-04	**Remnian timeline authority** FTE/Shared	Construct a new canonical Remnian timeline. Existing Remnian timelines are reference/source material only and do not independently control chronology.	SUPERSEDES Every existing timeline's claim to global chronology authority DOWNSTREAM Timeline facts must be rebuilt from current manuscripts and explicit rulings, with conflicts surfaced rather than blended.
TCD-012 2026-09-04	**TSWK ending authority** TSWK/Shared	TSWK's ending is open. No existing ending concept controls. A later hybrid or different resolution may be developed after understanding what 3SL, FTE, and ADST hand into TSWK.	SUPERSEDES Old Cael/Levi descent ending as a fixed destination DOWNSTREAM Companion architecture must label all TSWK end-state claims as possible until ruled.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-013 2026-09-04	**3SL/FTE/ADST chronology** 3SL/FTE/ADST	3SL occurs approximately two years before the main concurrent period. ADST begins when Elias goes missing; FTE begins a couple of weeks later. FTE and ADST then run largely concurrently and end around the same time without requiring chapter-level lockstep.	SUPERSEDES Any sequence placing ADST wholly after FTE or requiring chapters to synchronize one-for-one DOWNSTREAM Cross-book appearances, information transfer, travel, and consequences must respect the shared active window.
TCD-014 2026-09-04	**Shadowmere continuation and TSWK** 3SL/TSWK/Shared	TSWK is contemporaneous with the book that follows 3SL. Shadowmere books follow a 3 / 5 / 7 numbering pattern. The next title is open.	SUPERSEDES Any assumption that TSWK is automatically concurrent with 3SL itself or that the old Shadowmere series titles survive DOWNSTREAM TCD-054 now places the pair in a rolling window directly after FTE/ADST. The next Shadowmere address/title remains open.
TCD-015 2026-09-05	**Physical relationship of the four settings** All four	Remnia, Somnoria, Thalara, and the Underside exist in one physical world as separate nations/territories. Extreme isolation, magical boundaries, restricted routes, and controlled knowledge make “world” or “realm” valid in-world language, not literal cosmology.	SUPERSEDES Literal separate-planet, parallel-universe, or dimension readings of legacy lore DOWNSTREAM The Companion must distinguish physical reality, political reality, cultural perception, and magical/travel reality. Irreconcilable separate-world claims become Legacy.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-016 2026-09-05	**Knowledge of the other lands** All four	Awareness varies by nation, class, institution, profession, network, person, and time. Existence, location, functional, route, historical, and true Tandem knowledge are distinct levels and cannot be inferred from one another.	SUPERSEDES Any universal rule that all populations either know or do not know the other lands DOWNSTREAM Build a time-sensitive Knowledge of the Other Lands Matrix tracking teaching, belief, official claims, suppression, rumor, institutional knowledge, exceptional characters, errors, acquisition dates, and source status.
TCD-017 2026-09-05	**Nature and scale of routes** 3SL/TSWK/Shared	Routes are magically enabled transit through real physical passages. They may serve local, tier, restricted/institutional, underground/smuggling, boundary-crossing, or neutral-transit functions. Cross-land routes breach barriers, distance, or concealed geography—not dimensions—and not every route has every capability.	SUPERSEDES Dimensional-portal cosmology; assumption that any route can reach any land DOWNSTREAM Build a Route Classification System tracking origin, controller, knowledge, opening requirements, stability, destination, cost/risk, traceability, traveler knowledge, and alternate names; connect it to TCD-016.
TCD-018 2026-09-05	**Oneiros Prism location and integrity** ADST/Shared	The Oneiros Prism was once whole and is now fragmented. House Aether secretly holds one significant surviving piece in its restricted archive; other pieces exist and are not all located or identified. The complete Prism remains “lost,” and characters or records may mistakenly treat the House Aether piece as the whole/original artifact.	SUPERSEDES Objective reading of the archive object as the intact Prism; assumption that “lost” means no piece is held DOWNSTREAM Build a Prism provenance and fragment record. Number, locations, core-piece status, acquisition, mutual resonance, and reassembly effects remain open; do not assume four pieces or one per land.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-019 2026-09-05	**Oneiros Prism's primary function** ADST/Shared	The Prism is a major cross-land artifact created to maintain boundaries, balance, or structural separation among the four lands. Somnorian dream infrastructure, conduit stabilization, and network regulation are later applications, not its original purpose.	SUPERSEDES Somnoria-centric treatment of Dream Network regulation as the Prism's complete original purpose DOWNSTREAM Define its original four-land function, whether it belonged to a larger system, why it fragmented, each piece's independent role, and the consequences of reunion. Somnorian interpretations may be accurate but incomplete.
TCD-021 2026-09-05	**Somnorian governing structure** ADST/Shared	The High Council is Somnoria's national governing body. The four Dream Houses hold representation and political power within it. The Dream Master's Guild regulates professional dreamwalking and related magic.	SUPERSEDES Any single institution's blanket supremacy across national governance, House politics, and professional magic DOWNSTREAM Build a Somnorian Institutional Power Map defining authority, regulation, punishment, overlap, and competition among Council, Houses, and Guild.
TCD-022 2026-09-05	**Survival scope of Full 4 Series Flesh Out** All four	Treat the file as a Shared Lore Source Pool / Legacy Recovery Source, never a controlling master plan. The Shattered Veil poem architecture survives. Convergence/reconnection may survive if compatible, but its meaning, mechanism, timing, participants, and outcome are not inherited. All other claims require individual support or ruling.	SUPERSEDES Blanket canon or blanket discard of the document; automatic survival of detailed plots, endings, couple mechanics, activations, resurrection/reincarnation, sequence, or sequels DOWNSTREAM TCD-045–047 now define the two-stage Divide, transition-state Convergence, and prophecy reconstruction. Continue the claim-level [C] / [P] / LEGACY / [X] pass for every other claim.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-023 2026-09-05	**Elders' Prayer relationship** 3SL/FTE/Shared	Selah and Katherine perform the same inherited Elders' Prayer/magical working through different cultural language, terminology, and ritual expression. This is intentional cross-book repetition. Direct performance-to-performance causation was initially left open and is excluded by TCD-048.	SUPERSEDES Unrelated/coincidental-ritual reading; automatic direct-causation reading DOWNSTREAM Trace the prayer's origin, transmission, divergence, teaching, mechanics, costs, cultural names, and possible survival in Somnoria/Thalara. Katherine need not know Selah, the Underside origin, or the full history.
TCD-024 2026-09-05	**TSWK/next Shadowmere synchronization** 3SL/FTE/ADST/TSWK	TSWK and the next Shadowmere novel occur in the same general period. Their exact relationship to FTE and ADST was initially open and is fixed at macro level by TCD-054.	SUPERSEDES Any fixed placement of the pair against FTE/ADST before later ruling DOWNSTREAM Build a master event-anchor timeline with separate activation, opening, climax, resolution, and delayed-information dates; TCD-054 establishes the direct rolling handoff.
TCD-025 2026-09-09	**Tandem macro geography** All four	The four lands occupy multiple major landmasses/regions in one world. Remnia and Somnoria are separate continental landmasses with ocean between them. Underside attaches to the Zenithia side/corner of Remnia's broader geography. Primarily underwater Thalara lies farther outward in the island/sea region. Spain/France/Italy/Greek-islands comparisons describe relative placement only, never real borders, scale, climate, culture, or coastlines.	SUPERSEDES One-continent assumptions; literal copying of real-world geography; separate-world cosmology DOWNSTREAM Build the Tandem Macro Geography Map and overlay physical and magical travel. Coastlines, landmass/ocean names, scale, distances, islands, and borders remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-026 2026-09-09	**Underside vertical geography** 3SL/FTE/Shared	The Underside is a vertically tiered nation beginning at/near the surface off Zenithia's side of Remnia and descending underground. Crownlight and Dawnveil are above-ground/surface-level tiers. By Ironcross, the descent is fully subterranean; lower tiers continue deeper. "Underside" names the descent-organized civilization even though its highest tiers are not literally underground.	SUPERSEDES Flat buried-continent model; assumption that every Underside tier is underground DOWNSTREAM Build a vertical cross-section fixing tier elevations/depths, surface transition, Zenithia relationship, and route/lift/rail descent.
TCD-027 2026-09-09	**Echo Gate and current Remnia–Underside access** 3SL/FTE/ADST/Shared	The singular sealed Echo Gate is Legacy. Its seal, spiral/mirrored glyph, or ancient-crossing imagery may be recovered later only as [P]. Independently, a current Remnia–Shadowmere/Underside crossing exists near the London Town edge/no-man's-land associated with London Town, Old Prosperity, and Alea. The canonical Remnia map will control its precise provincial coordinate once reviewed.	SUPERSEDES Echo Gate as established crossing; automatic inheritance of its lore; guessed precise map coordinate or arrival tier DOWNSTREAM Add the known entrance to the Route Map after reviewing the Remnia map. Exact border placement and whether it arrives directly in Shadowmere Tier 7 remain open.
TCD-028 2026-09-09	**Drowned Canticle within the Seal Song tradition** TSWK/Shared	The texts are neither identical nor unrelated. The Drowned Canticle is Thalara's cultural Shattered Veil version and survives within or alongside the larger Seal Song tradition as a historical/prophetic strand. The Seal Song also encompasses pre-Drowning vows, memorial culture, identity, breathwork, sealing, pressure control, communal memory, and survival protocol.	SUPERSEDES Treating the Drowned Canticle as the whole Seal Song; treating the two as unconnected traditions DOWNSTREAM Build the Seal Song Textual Layers. Whether Tavian's fragment belongs to the Canticle, another forbidden verse, or an older layer remains open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-029 2026-09-09	**Reverie's layered magic classification** ADST/Shared	All three are true at different explanatory levels. Reverie is a Dreamwalker and natural dream conduit whose conduit nature enables her unusual Remote Viewing. Early Reverie believes she is an illegal/unlicensed Dreamwalker with a rare gift; public and institutional labels may miss the conduit nature; she learns the deeper classification later in ADST.	SUPERSEDES Either/or classification; early-character knowledge of the objective answer DOWNSTREAM Build Reverie's Classification Reveal Track, including symptoms, suspicions, proof, terminology, reveal timing, and who knows what before she does.
TCD-030 2026-09-09	**Reverie/Cassius bond mechanics and cost** ADST/Shared	Retire physical withdrawal. Touch is safe, and separation does not make either partner sick. Passive awareness, sensory spillover, emotion, pain, or magical recognition may cross distance without creating dependency. The known major danger begins when their powers actively synchronize, merge, overlap, or channel through one another; Cassius's Labyrinth scar tries to regulate both power sources and tears, spreads, or deteriorates.	SUPERSEDES Physical-proximity requirement; mutual separation sickness; touch-as-danger romance mechanic DOWNSTREAM Build a six-level Bond Mechanics Ladder from touch through Prism/network use. Reverie's physiological/magical cost, tattoo bleeding, and permanent effects remain open.
TCD-031 2026-09-09	**Caelum's allegiance and cross-book function** 3SL/FTE/ADST/Shared	Caelum is an independent cross-land actor with deep access to Nightmare-adjacent information, people, research, favors, markets, and operational channels, but he is not a member of the Nightmare organization. He can deliberately use nightmare magic; affinity is not allegiance. His central loyalty is not currently to Nightmare, House Aether, Remnia, Shadowmere, or one protagonist. He recurs because he pursues a larger personal objective across the current sequence and into later books.	SUPERSEDES Caelum as secret Nightmare loyalist; nightmare magic proving membership; treating him as a connective cameo or omniscient information device DOWNSTREAM Build a cross-book agenda/network dossier tracking his local purpose, knowledge sources/limits, debts, withheld information, gains, and own-story progression. "Caelum's asset" as Melena's objective status remains under review.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-032 2026-09-09	**Elias Lockwood / Alexander Thorne double life** FTE/ADST/Shared	Elias voluntarily created and maintained Professor Alexander Thorne as an established Somnorian researcher/instructor identity. He traveled to Somnoria and built that life for years, beginning while Lucia preceded him in succession and Aracelia reigned. After Lucia's death, his elevation to Crown Prince made the lives increasingly incompatible. At ADST's opening Elias is missing from Remnia because he failed to return on pattern, while Thorne is not yet missing from Somnoria but is becoming unstable or compromised.	SUPERSEDES Abduction into the Thorne identity; Thorne as a recent cover created only after Elias's Remnian disappearance DOWNSTREAM TCD-062 now establishes organization-exploited research/dream compromise as the failure-to-return cause. First crossing, alias creation, credentials, helpers, teaching history, Cassius chronology, travel pattern, exact technique, and later fate remain open.
TCD-034 2026-09-09	**Tournament purpose, Conqueror rules, and current winner** FTE/Shared	Both functions are canon. Publicly, the Conqueror—the surviving Piece whose decisive sanctioned action earns victory—holds the winning province's Provincial Leadership Board seat for the next year. Conqueror is not automatically the King or any fixed rank. Privately, the Sanctum uses selection, assignments, challenges, stress, injuries, alliances, and survival to classify, cultivate, control, exploit, monitor, suppress, or eliminate dangerous people. Under a forfeit, Conqueror is the surviving Piece whose final sanctioned action or matchup directly produces the decisive state causing the forfeit. Atlas and Tiran's confrontation is officially a draw by intervention; Katherine and Melena produce the decisive sequence. Katherine Nicholas is the current Tournament's Conqueror.	SUPERSEDES King automatically becoming Conqueror; Atlas winning solely because he made the last physical attack before intervention; Tournament as only public governance or only secret culling; legacy climax execution DOWNSTREAM Rebuild the Katherine–Melena climax and London Town forfeit so Katherine earns the title causally. Define Checkmate, final move, forfeit adjudication, succession/proxy rules, title duration, Board powers, and victorious-province benefits.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-035 2026-09-09	**Fundamental origin of magic** All four	All four modern traditions ultimately draw from one primordial magical source or substrate predating the modern division of the Tandem world. The Divide did not create four unrelated magics. Geography, environment, bodies, bloodlines, culture, survival, history, and institutions reshaped the shared power into genuinely distinct systems with non-interchangeable mechanics, costs, classifications, and understandings.	SUPERSEDES Four wholly unrelated magical origins; any reading that modern systems are interchangeable or were once one standardized spell system DOWNSTREAM Build the Tandem Magic Ancestry Map. The primordial source's nature, pre-Divide practice, divergence mechanism, surviving old principles, and cultures' relative historical accuracy remain open.
TCD-036 2026-09-09	**Status of "Crossblood"** FTE/ADST/Shared	Crossblood is an institutional, scholarly, political, or historical label for people believed to carry inheritance associated with more than one separated Tandem tradition. It is not currently an objectively correct universal biological category. Institutions may define it differently through incomplete theory, bloodline politics, fear, or propaganda. The label does not establish what a person's magic objectively is.	SUPERSEDES Crossblood as settled universal biology; automatic retention of the old candidate list; use as a catch-all for rare, ancient, hybrid, inherited, or anomalous magic DOWNSTREAM Build a Crossblood Classification Record with institutional definitions, objective-theory comparison, consequences, land-specific terminology, and individual case review.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-037 2026-09-09	**Prism and Leviathan within the boundary system** ADST/TSWK/Shared	The Oneiros Prism and Leviathan participate in the same larger magical boundary-maintenance system/problem preserving Tandem's current separation and stability. They are not equivalent components: the Prism is a fragmented cross-land artifact, while the Leviathan is a living pressure entity functioning as seal and infrastructure. Their connection does not require one matching anchor per land and does not establish shared creators, age, or direct power transfer.	SUPERSEDES Treating them as unrelated by default; treating Leviathan as a Prism-equivalent artifact; inventing four matching anchors for symmetry DOWNSTREAM TCD-055 fixes Leviathan as preexisting the later First Seal, when it was bound into local survival infrastructure. Its actual origin, earlier boundary function, other components, direct versus third-condition resonance, compensation, and failure propagation remain open.
TCD-038 2026-09-09	**Nightmare entity's relationship to the Prism** ADST/Shared	Nightmare predates the Oneiros Prism and the present boundary system. It is not physically contained inside the artifact. It exists beyond or behind a magical boundary that the complete Prism was created for or incorporated into maintaining; this restricts Nightmare's crossing, manifestation, and full influence. Fragmentation weakens or complicates that architecture without placing entity fragments inside Prism pieces. "Cage" may survive as House Aether's limited interpretation.	SUPERSEDES Literal entity-inside-Prism model; Nightmare fragmenting with the artifact; every Prism piece containing part of Nightmare; Prism existing only to imprison this threat DOWNSTREAM Build the Nightmare–Prism Boundary Model and failure-state ladder separating entity position, boundary, Prism pieces, and Dream Network.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-039 2026-09-09	**Nature and contents of Tavian's fragment** TSWK/Shared	Tavian's fragment is a composite Thalaran memory-shell relic containing layered historical evidence, preserved or forbidden language, memory records, route information, and operational sealing data tied to First Shellward, House Dren, the Drowning, and suppressed history. Tavian added a contingency-memory mechanism governing disclosure. The object proves deliberate sacrifice at First Shellward and carries route and Dren infrastructure connections, but its physical age, makers, layer authorship, and exact relationship to Canticle or Seal Song text remain open.	SUPERSEDES Fragment as one missing Canticle passage; one Seal Song verse; a Oneiros Prism piece; all contents authored by Tavian; Caelus's Dren ownership claim as automatic objective truth DOWNSTREAM Build the Tavian Fragment Layer Record and progressive reveal sequence. Preserve the fragment reaction and Levi's mark reaction as separate functions unless later ruled otherwise.
TCD-040 2026-09-09	**Katherine and Melena's biological relationship** FTE/Shared	Tobias Lockwood is the shared biological father of Katherine Nicholas and Melena Lockwood. Katherine's biological parents are Michelle Nicholas and Tobias; Melena's are Lucia Hastings-Lockwood and Tobias. Katherine and Melena are paternal half-sisters. Biological truth does not independently establish legal status, public records, legitimacy, title, or succession.	SUPERSEDES Lucia as Katherine's biological mother; Ethan as Katherine's biological father; conflicting legacy parentage DOWNSTREAM Build the Remnian Royal Lineage and Katherine Secrecy Record. Conception, birth, concealment, record alteration, individual knowledge, reveal path, legitimacy, and succession consequences remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-041 2026-09-09	**Remnian power structure** FTE/Shared	Remnia is a centralized empire with overlapping centers of authority. The Crown is the highest public civil and dynastic authority and directly controls London Town and imperial affairs. Provincial Leaders administer territories within the Empire; titles and structures may vary. The Provincial Leadership Board provides formal representation and can be altered by a Conqueror's one-year seat. The Elemental Court is a separate political-magical bloc influencing multiple provinces and elemental policy but not London Town. The Sanctum is semi-autonomous in magical regulation, bloodlines, Tournament law, doctrine, security, and historical control, but is neither simply subordinate to the Crown nor legally omnipotent over it.	SUPERSEDES Simple Crown-versus-Sanctum dual state; fully sovereign provinces; Sanctum as ordinary subordinate agency; Sanctum as unlimited legal ruler DOWNSTREAM Build the Remnian Power and Jurisdiction Map, including public civics versus actual closed-door power and institutional conflict procedures.
TCD-042 2026-09-09	**London Town forfeit causal chain and authority** FTE	Katherine's final sanctioned action against or for Melena prevents catastrophe, stabilizes or saves Melena, and creates the decisive state. Melena consciously chooses survival over victory rather than sacrificing more people to reach Challenge Seven. Tiran supports, communicates, or operationalizes that choice, but Bishop rank alone does not grant unilateral provincial surrender authority. The formal forfeit must be entered by the properly authorized Piece or official. The Sanctum accepts and may exploit the outcome but is not its original cause.	SUPERSEDES Melena breaking down as villain; Tiran automatically possessing unilateral authority; Sanctum forcing the original decision; passive injury attrition as the whole cause DOWNSTREAM TCD-052 fixes Maxim as alive, conscious, active King who formally authorizes the forfeit. Exact procedure and emergency command rules remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-043 2026-09-09	**Melena and Caelum's operational relationship** 3SL/FTE/ADST/Shared	Melena and Caelum operate in a transactional alliance with coercive leverage, not a true handler–subordinate hierarchy. Caelum has Elias access, Somnorian intelligence, routes, and networks; Melena has Remnian and royal access, Tournament intelligence, Shadowmere knowledge, and information he cannot obtain. Both negotiate, withhold, resist, and act independently. "Asset" is Caelum's operational language and self-conception, not objective narration of Melena's status.	SUPERSEDES Melena as Caelum's formal subordinate; asset terminology as objective canon; either party having complete authority over the other DOWNSTREAM Build the Caelum/Melena Leverage Ledger and deal progression. Whether the relationship becomes friendship, intimacy, loyalty, rivalry, or something else remains open.
TCD-044 2026-09-09	**Silas and Isola's Book One romantic landing** 3SL	Silas and Isola become explicitly and mutually romantic during 3SL, crossing from subtext into substantial consensual physical choice before the novel ends. Their magical tether is not romance or evidence of consent. They do not end as a fully settled, publicly defined couple; the crisis, Remy's death, responsibilities, Silas's changed role, and unresolved tether still pull them onto separate immediate paths. The outline's restrained separation and future promise may survive only after the romantic line has already been crossed.	SUPERSEDES Deferring all physical romantic payoff to the sequel; using tether dependency as romantic consent; a fully settled public-couple ending DOWNSTREAM Build the Silas/Isola Romance and Tether Progression as separate chapter-level tracks. Exact scene placement, intimacy level, initiator, stopping point, verbal definition, and ending wording remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-045 2026-09-24	**Historical nature of the Divide** All four	The Divide is a two-stage historical crisis. First, a non-deliberate natural, celestial, cosmic, or magical rupture destabilized the primordial system and relations among the lands. Ancient peoples then created, adapted, bound, activated, or repurposed seals, artifacts, routes, living systems, and boundary structures in response. Their deliberate response did not cause the rupture, but it hardened its consequences into long-term separation. “Divide” may name the initiating catastrophe or the broader rupture–containment–hardening era. Long isolation accelerated specialization of one shared magical ancestry; migration may be a consequence, not the cause.	SUPERSEDES Divide as solely migration; solely deliberate partition; solely natural catastrophe with no containment response; origin of four unrelated magics DOWNSTREAM Build the Divide Reconstruction. TCD-055 now establishes the Drowning as later and distinct, and First Seal as later local containment. Rupture cause, continent/Prism chronology, Leviathan’s pre-First-Seal role, boundary intent, and duration remain open.
TCD-046 2026-09-24	**Objective definition of Convergence** All four	Convergence is the progressive destabilization and re-entanglement of the four lands, magical branches, boundary systems, buried shared history, routes, artifacts, and entities after enforced separation. It can manifest through permeability, resonance, cross-land responses, restored contact, knowledge leakage, and failing isolation structures. It is a transition state, neither inherently repair nor destruction; present choices determine whether the result is controlled reconnection, transformed partial separation, restabilization, catastrophic collapse, or another state. It does not physically merge continents or flatten distinct magics. The Shattered Veil predicts compatible conditions, but its reliability is not yet fixed.	SUPERSEDES Convergence as automatic salvation, apocalypse, continental merger, uniform magic, Echo Gate event, or any inherited legacy trigger/ending DOWNSTREAM TCD-056 fixes long degradation/latent symptoms and late-ADST cross-system threshold, not a one-event origin. Build the causal timeline, symptom ledger, response clock, outcome tree, and knowledge states; precise onset and end state remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-047 2026-09-24	**Shattered Veil master-text custody and reconstruction** All four	A complete Shattered Veil exists at author/universe level, but no intact authoritative master is presently known in-world. The four national texts are divergent historical descendants, not four physical pieces. Characters may reconstruct wording and/or underlying truth by comparing variants with historical, magical, material, and testimonial evidence, but no national version is presumed untouched.	SUPERSEDES Hidden intact master as default; prophecy fetch quest; living entity storing the whole text; one culture possessing the objectively complete version DOWNSTREAM Build the Shattered Veil Reconstruction Dossier: master-to-variant claim comparison, four provenance chains, evidence ledger, reconstruction thresholds, and text-versus-truth record. Who suspects the shared origin, who reconstructs it, and whether exact wording is recoverable remain open.
TCD-048 2026-09-24	**Selah/Katherine Elders' Prayer causal relationship** 3SL/FTE/Shared	Selah and Katherine independently perform the same inherited Elders' Prayer approximately two years apart. Their connection is shared magical ancestry and ritual tradition, not direct causation. Selah's act leaves no specific echo, reservoir contribution, transmitted route, or power that Katherine later accesses.	SUPERSEDES Direct performance-to-performance echo; Selah powering Katherine; a stored magical reservoir or route transmission between the two acts DOWNSTREAM Build the Elders' Prayer Transmission + Variant Record: ritual ancestry tree, Selah/Katherine comparison, activation conditions, transmission history, cultural and objective interpretations, and cross-book recognition.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-049 2026-09-24	**Katherine's Fire/Frost magical anatomy** FTE/Shared	Katherine is not objectively the same Fire/Frost Dyad as Zephyr. Her manifestation is ancestral reversion or resurfacing of a less-specialized earlier Remnian elemental inheritance. She genuinely possesses both Frost and Fire; Fire is not borrowed, temporary, or merely a reaction to Melena. The Sanctum likely labels her a Dyad because current taxonomy lacks a better category, but that diagnosis is incomplete or wrong. Zephyr remains a genuine modern Fire/Frost Dyad.	SUPERSEDES Simple objective Dyad equivalence; settled Crossblood anatomy; borrowed or temporary Fire; Melena creating Katherine's Fire DOWNSTREAM TCD-058 establishes one capacity with Frost dominance and catastrophic Frost-failure Fire rerouting; no magical suppression is established. Objective name, ancient norm, inheritance, anomalies, precise failure beat, simultaneous use, and costs remain open.
TCD-050 2026-09-24	**Katherine–Melena sister-reveal architecture** FTE/Shared	The reveal proceeds through investigation, confrontation, verification, and personal confirmation. Melena begins finding inconsistencies before Challenge Six because 3SL destroyed her trust in official history. Before the Duel she has enough evidence to suspect Katherine is biologically connected to the Lockwoods/Tobias, not enough to prove it. Their climax confrontation provides magical, behavioral, and inherited recognition that reinforces suspicion but does not establish paternity. Melena directly tells/confronts Katherine. Authenticated lineage, birth, or Sanctum evidence then proves Tobias's paternity; Michelle's later testimony supplies the human history and concealment. Katherine saves or stabilizes Melena because of her own moral arc, not only sisterhood.	SUPERSEDES One magical reaction, single file, or exposition scene proving the whole reveal; sisterhood as Katherine's sole reason to save Melena DOWNSTREAM Build the Sister-Reveal Evidence Architecture with four synchronized tracks—Melena's knowledge, Katherine's knowledge, available evidence, and objective truth—plus evidence chain, climax causality, Michelle layer, and disclosure ladder. First clue, exact records, sealing actor, institutional knowledge, testimony timing, and public disclosure remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-051 2026-09-24	**Origin of Atlas's black-vein deterioration** FTE/Shared	Atlas's deterioration originates in the Conduit Trial when he force-synchronizes his dense/control Frost with Katherine's reactive Frost in the same circuit. He tries to impose structure; the Frost overcorrects, turns inward, and creates a progressive synchronization injury visible through black-vein deterioration. It is not a prior ordinary accumulation of Element Rot, and no earlier Sanctum/artifact corruption or experiment is established.	SUPERSEDES Pre-existing ordinary Element Rot; retrofitted Sanctum corruption, artifact infection, or secret experiment as the origin DOWNSTREAM Build the Atlas Synchronization Injury Record. Whether the condition is acute Element Rot or a distinct pathology, why it progresses after separation, its anatomy, aggravators, cross-link, treatment, and prayer stabilization remain open.
TCD-052 2026-09-24	**Maxim's condition and authority at the London Town forfeit** FTE	Maxim is alive, conscious, and functioning as active King when the forfeit occurs. Melena makes the substantive choice of survival over victory. Tiran advises, supports, and operationalizes that choice but cannot unilaterally surrender the province. Melena brings or endorses the decision to Maxim; Maxim formally enters or authorizes the forfeit. The Sanctum accepts and formalizes it rather than compelling it. Katherine remains Conqueror because her sanctioned action creates the decisive state.	SUPERSEDES Incapacitating Maxim solely to preserve the legacy Tiran announcement; Tiran's unilateral authority; Sanctum-compelled original surrender DOWNSTREAM Add a Tournament Command Authority table and final causal sequence to the FTE Forfeit record. Maxim's initial response, private/public procedure, and emergency authority rules for King, Queen, and Bishop remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-053 2026-09-24	**Nightmare entity's ADST Book One endpoint** ADST/Shared	ADST Book One ends with the ancient Nightmare entity reaching Awareness only. Reverie, Cassius, and/or the House Aether Prism fragment become perceptible to it because of the protagonists' successful intervention and the Prism's deeper boundary response, not because the criminal organization completes its plan. The entity does not independently communicate, influence, manifest through the Dream Network, run an operation, or cross into waking reality. The protagonists win locally; the organization's immediate plan fails, but its network survives and remains dangerous. "Nightmare" in the current manuscript may reflect Reverie's incomplete knowledge rather than entity identification.	SUPERSEDES Entity communication, influence, Network manifestation, autonomous operation, or waking crossing in Book One; organization success as the source of Awareness; total antagonist defeat DOWNSTREAM TCD-060–061 now specify the failed Network-rupture/boundary-channel operation and intact fragment's unintended stabilizing resonance. Build the awakening ladder, attribution, mechanical counteraction, aftermath, and reader-reveal method. Exact perception and next-stage timing remain open.
TCD-054 2026-09-24	**Post-FTE/ADST rolling chronology** All four	TSWK and the next Shadowmere installment form the next concurrent window and begin directly after FTE/ADST, with no meaningful months- or years-long gap; days or small weeks for logistics are acceptable. The handoff is rolling: conditions for later plots may already be active during late FTE/ADST, the two next books substantially overlap without requiring identical opening dates, and still-later stories may begin activating before the prior pair fully resolves. Local conflicts remain independently rooted, so temporal proximity does not create automatic causation.	SUPERSEDES Long gap after FTE/ADST; isolated book eras; identical page-one dates as a requirement; assuming adjacent events cause one another DOWNSTREAM Update the Tandem Master Synchronization Timeline with separate Background Activation, Narrative Opening, Climax, and Resolution fields for every book. TSWK crackdown, Azrine's sanctuary, Levi's assignment, and the next Shadowmere character's continuing two-year life may predate page one.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-055 2026-09-26	**Divide, Drowning, and First Seal** TSWK/Shared	D clarified: the Drowning is a significantly later, staged Thalaran regional catastrophe shaped by environmental/magical instability and political decisions, not the original Divide under another name. Its First Seal is the deliberate final emergency response: Thalarans bind the preexisting Leviathan, operationalize an existing Seal Song, and sacrifice part of Thalara to stabilize the rest while using/intersecting older Tandem boundary infrastructure. The catastrophe, sacrifice decision, and initial ancient rupture are three distinct events. Whether Divide-era system deterioration contributed to the Drowning is open.	SUPERSEDES Drowning = Divide; First Seal = original global containment; Leviathan created/discovered at First Seal; all Thalaran infrastructure assumed Divide-era DOWNSTREAM Build the Divide/Drowning Historical Crosswalk: two-crisis timeline, pre-Drowning infrastructure inventory, First Seal cause/effect, and layered Skyhold/Deepfolk/Shellkeeper/Dren/Underwake/protagonist knowledge states. Leviathan's earlier boundary role and exact old/new system interactions remain open.
TCD-056 2026-09-26	**Present Convergence causal threshold** All four	E staged threshold: long-term degradation, alteration, isolation, and strain of post-Divide architecture precede the present process. By the FTE/ADST window localized Convergence is latent. Late ADST's Reverie/Cassius/Prism/Dream Network interaction is the first established threshold shifting largely independent local instabilities toward responsive cross-system instability; ancient Nightmare Awareness is an indicator/consequence, not its origin. Late FTE is a major Remnian manifestation, not yet an equal proven trigger. TSWK/next Shadowmere unfold after this threshold. Not every local anomaly is Convergence.	SUPERSEDES ADST climax as creation of centuries of degradation; Nightmare Awareness as initiating cause; every FTE/Thalaran/Underside anomaly automatically a co-trigger; Leviathan-only origin DOWNSTREAM Add causal timeline, symptom ledger with real non-Convergence classifications, tested arrow-by-arrow threshold chain, and T0 cross-land response clock to the Convergence State Model. Onset definition, first measurable cross-land effects, FTE trigger status, and Leviathan/Underside timing remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-057 2026-09-26	**Elders' Prayer objective function** 3SL/FTE/Shared	E C+B hybrid: the inherited working restores a living person's viable magical/life pattern when severed, corrupted, or catastrophically dysregulated. Restored magical continuity can stabilize secondary bodily functions and call someone back from active dying while a viable living pattern remains. It cannot resurrect completed death or regenerate destroyed anatomy; Isola's leg remains ruined despite life-saving stabilization. Silas's returning breath/pulse under Selah is recovery of living function, not resurrection. Selah/Katherine share this objective function through differing cultural presentations.	SUPERSEDES Resurrection of completed death; full physical regeneration; Frost-only ritual; automatic universal burden redistribution DOWNSTREAM Add Functional Anatomy to the Elders' Prayer Transmission + Variant Record: failure-state eligibility, original-pattern reference, possible mechanical sequence, both performances, death threshold, caster cost, bond requirement, and cultural variants. Exact eligibility and effects on Atlas/Melena remain open.
TCD-058 2026-09-26	**Katherine's Frost-dominant Fire emergence** FTE/Shared	E refined C: Katherine's one less-specialized ancestral elemental capacity naturally organized itself around a dominant Frost expression from childhood, reinforced by modern Frost training. Fire is a genuine alternative expression of the same capacity, not a separate ordinary Dyad channel, borrowed ability, or established magically sealed second element. Ordinary stress/Fire exposure does not activate it. In FTE's climax catastrophic severance or unavailability of her established Frost configuration lets the older capacity reroute through what modern Remnia calls Fire. Deliberate magical suppression is not currently established; unusual readings or institutional suspicion are possible but open.	SUPERSEDES Fire triggered by generic stress or exposure; two ordinary Fire/Frost channels; external seal/medical suppression as established cause; interpreting legacy "Fire is back" as proof of Katherine's childhood Fire use DOWNSTREAM Add Katherine Expression Architecture to the elemental dossier: one-capacity/multiple-expression anatomy, Frost dominance, Examination baseline, exact climax Frost failure, Fire rerouting, later switching/dual access/cost, tests and misclassification.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-059 2026-09-26	**Katherine's layered lineage concealment** FTE/Shared	E multi-party: Lucia/the Lockwood Crown originates Katherine's public/legal and dynastic erasure; Sanctum is principal institutional enforcer and record/surveillance custodian; Tobias cooperates by non-acknowledgment without being established as the architect; Michelle raises and protects Katherine inside imposed constraints rather than designing her erasure. Each controls a different layer. Exact motives, coercion/consent, record alterations, Aracelia's role, and whether Katherine's birth was publicly known before suppression or never meaningfully acknowledged remain open.	SUPERSEDES Michelle as architect; Sanctum as original decision-maker; Tobias's silence equated with indifference; silent settlement of conflicting initial-publicity accounts DOWNSTREAM Build Katherine Concealment Architecture as layered record/decision/knowledge matrix integrated with the TCD-050 sister-reveal board and secrecy timeline.
TCD-060 2026-09-26	**Nightmare organization's ADST Book One operation** ADST/Shared	E A+C hybrid: the criminal organization uses Thorne's completed research, a rare celestial alignment, and a living conduit/anchor configuration to deliberately rupture the Dream Network. The rupture is a means to force a usable channel or critical weakness in Somnoria's older boundary architecture toward the ancient entity, not the end goal. Reverie is targeted for her conduit nature; Cassius and the fragment can become important without the organization foreseeing a fixed trio. Reverie/Cassius stop the intended Network rupture/boundary breach. The Network survives sufficiently to function; ancient Nightmare gains no usable channel. Its later Awareness is an unintended result of the protagonists' successful intervention and the fragment response.	SUPERSEDES Entity personally operating Book One attack; artifact theft as whole operation; completed Network destruction/breach; organization necessarily predicting the exact paired/fragment configuration DOWNSTREAM Add ADST Climax Operation Map to the existing outcome/awakening record: asset roles and knowledge, intended-versus-actual sequence, dreamer stakes, Thorne's exact role, protagonist countermechanism, and aftermath.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-061 2026-09-26	**House Aether Prism fragment's climax state** ADST/Shared	A clarified with limited C: Reverie/Cassius's combined intervention engages House Aether's intact fragment in a deeper boundary-stabilization function that helps prevent Nightmare's Network rupture becoming a breach. It reacts unusually to the pair, but no permanent attunement, ownership, exclusive access, or effortless repeat activation follows. Its structural correction sends unintended boundary-scale resonance, making the ancient entity Aware without deliberately messaging it or completing Nightmare's goal. The fragment does not fracture further, vanish, or relocate; it remains physically present.	SUPERSEDES Fragment breaking/vanishing in Book One; automatic keeper assignment; conscious Prism beacon; entity Awareness as proof of a successful breach; convenient reveal of all other fragment locations DOWNSTREAM Add Prism Climax State Record to TCD-053/060: pre-crisis, overload, paired activation, stabilization, aftermath; specify energy redirection, distinct Reverie/Cassius contributions, non-repeatability, continued custody/access, fragment state, and institutional knowledge.
TCD-062 2026-09-26	**Elias/Thorne's failure to return** FTE/ADST/Shared	E B+C hybrid: Nightmare the organization targets Thorne's boundary/Network research and exploits the vulnerability created by his own exposure, operationally compromising dream/magical functioning so ordinary return to Remnia becomes unsafe or impossible without requiring initial physical captivity. Remnia notices Elias missing first; Thorne initially remains publicly present but deteriorating in Somnoria. Reverie's encounter with his collapsing dream, breakdown rumors, and Professor Lane's mirrored case reflect real patterned compromise. Exact technique, later captivity, protective self-isolation, travel risk, consent in the final operation, and physical status remain open.	SUPERSEDES Abduction into the Thorne identity; casual elective extended stay as entire cause; ancient entity personally attacking him in Book One; purely self-inflicted research madness; unproven House Aether/Council detention DOWNSTREAM Integrate a staged Failure-to-Return Sequence in the Elias/Thorne Double-Life Timeline + Knowledge Matrix with two public clocks, Nightmare interventions, diminishing Elias agency, identity collision, and exact pre-chapter-one and climax conditions.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-063 2026-09-26	**Remy's objective death mechanism and Melena's guilt** 3SL/FTE	A clarified: the gang leader mortally wounds Remy as he deliberately intervenes to protect/rescue Melena. Melena's escalating uncontrolled Fire helps create the dangerous confrontation, but neither her Fire nor the later warehouse collapse is the objective lethal mechanism. After the wound, Melena attempts to save him but cannot stop catastrophic bleeding; his death then drives her Fire into full loss of control and the blaze/collapse. She feels causally responsible even though the gang leader physically kills him. The Beta's machete/major-artery details are compatible candidates, not canon over the future 3SL scene.	SUPERSEDES Melena directly burning Remy to death; collapse as fatal event; accidental intervention; old "directly caused by Melena" as forensic truth DOWNSTREAM Build a 3SL Remy Death Beat Sheet before drafting the climax, with objective events versus FTE Melena memory. Exact attacker motive, intervention action, weapon/anatomy, antagonist fate, witnesses, and fire/collapse proportions remain open.
TCD-064 2026-09-26	**Levi and the Leviathan / House Dren Anchor system** TSWK/Shared	E A+clarified D: Levi is fully human, not a shard, reincarnation, avatar, or soulprint of Leviathan. House Dren has genuine inherited compatibility with Leviathan-associated seal infrastructure, expressed through pressure tolerance and interface ability. The House made a hereditary Anchor system identifying, conditioning, marking/authorizing compatible children and sacrificing some within the system. First currently established Anchor Caelen was twelve, not the willing adult in House mythology. Levi is the current intended operator; his capacity does not entail consent, ownership, or obligation. The Leviathan does not choose, claim, bless, or possess him in Book One; it watches after the system is opened. His name reflects institutional history, not metaphysical identity.	SUPERSEDES Legacy Soulprint Echo/reincarnated line; compatibility as consent; entity choosing/claiming Levi in Book One; Caelen as willing adult hero DOWNSTREAM Build the Dren Anchor Line + Seal Interface Record separating inherited compatibility, bodily conditioning, and Shellmark authorization; track Caelen to Levi, official versus objective history, sacrifices, inheritance source, and whether reproductive selection occurred. The July 2026 blueprint is now inventoried; resolve its 'Cael Dren' tablet and pre-Drowning Anchor-school terminology without silently overriding this ruling.

AUTHOR RULINGS WITHOUT A TCD NUMBER

DATE	TOPIC	AUTHOR RULING	WHERE
2026-09-26	**TCD-058 clarified: Heart's Mirror**	Heart's Mirror may foreshadow Katherine's hidden ancestral capacity through Fire imagery, fear, symbolic or ambiguous memory, lineage recognition, or other Mirror-generated material. Her Fire doesn't become objectively active during Challenge Five or its aftermath; she leaves the Mirror still operating through her Frost-dominant configuration. Material inside the Mirror isn't automatically an objective recovered memory. Her first objective Fire manifestation stays in the Challenge Six climax, after her established Frost pathway catastrophically fails or becomes unavailable.	APPLIED IN IV.10 · IV.24 · IV.25 · IV.10 working pages
2026-10-09	**IV.2 status: Remnia at a glance**	CANON — TCD-025 / TCD-041: Remnia is an empire on its own continental landmass, separated from Somnoria by ocean; the Crown sits at the highest public civil/dynastic level of the Remnian sovereignty structure. CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT — FTE Beta: Remnia has seventeen provinces. "Seventeen" is not attached to the TCDs.	APPLIED IN IV.2
2026-10-09	**IV.3 status: the military**	The military structure is CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, not TCD-041 canon. TCD-041 is the layered sovereignty framework.	APPLIED IN IV.3
2026-10-09	**Lineage anchor restated**	TCD-040 is the locked anchor: Tobias is the biological father of Katherine (with Michelle) and of Melena (with Lucia); they are paternal half-sisters. It doesn't make Katherine legally acknowledged, a Lockwood by law, a princess, publicly known, or an heir. TCD-059 governs concealment only. (Restates existing rulings; no new canon.)	APPLIED IN IV.11 · IV.11 record

APPENDIX A · CANON DECISION LOG · FTE SLICE

CONTINUED

DATE	TOPIC	AUTHOR RULING	WHERE
2026-10-09	**Underside tier status**	CANON — TCD-0025 / TCD-0026: the Underside is vertically tiered and attached to Zenithia's side of Remnia; Crownlight and Dawnveil are surface/above-ground tiers; the nation is fully underground by Ironcross. DRAFTED — 3SL ch. 10: nine tiers. SUPPORTED — 3SL Full Worldbuilding. The nine-tier count is not ruled canon.	APPLIED IN Cited via the concordance (III.3)

LOGGED IN DRAFTING · RESOLVED IV.25 AND LINEAGE ITEMS · ASKING A QUESTION ASSIGNS NO TCD NUMBER

LOG NO.	ITEM	DECISION AS MADE IN PROSE OR RULED	DATE · CH. · PAGES TO UPDATE

APPENDIX A · CANON DECISION LOG · FTE SLICE

CONTINUED

LOG NO.	ITEM	DECISION AS MADE IN PROSE OR RULED	DATE · CH. · PAGES TO UPDATE

APPENDIX · STATUS & PROVENANCE SHEET

B HIGH-IMPACT CONFLICT REGISTER: FTE SLICE

Every FTE conflict in the audit's register, plus the lineage conflicts the reconstruction found.

Rows reproduced from the audit's High-Impact Conflict Register: every entry whose books include FTE, and every entry cited elsewhere in this volume (28 rows).

ID	TOPIC · BOOKS	CONFLICT	PRIORITY / STATUS
HC-001	**Controlling FTE manuscript generation** FTE/Shared	Complete Final vs later partial Beta rewrite, plus later fragments	Resolved by TCD-001
HC-002	**3SL remaining plot and ending** 3SL/FTE	Current manuscript execution vs 32-ch outline/locked Remy-death climax	Resolved at authority/romantic-outcome level by TCD-002 and TCD-044; remaining climax bridge and exact romance beats require development
HC-006	**FTE Tournament architecture** FTE	Seven planned challenges vs six held/executed; challenge-four identity varies	Resolved by TCD-007 and TCD-008, except final Challenge Four name
HC-007	**Remnian chronology and royal genealogy** FTE/Shared	Multiple ER timelines disagree; older RSAS continuity is wholly incompatible	Resolved at authority and core-parentage level by TCD-010 and TCD-040; timeline, secrecy, and legal-status construction remains
HC-017	**Selah/Katherine prayer relationship** 3SL/FTE/Shared	Same ritual, causal echo, or merely thematic parallel	Resolved by TCD-023 and TCD-048: same inherited working in divergent forms, independently performed about two years apart with no direct performance-to-performance echo or borrowed power

ID	TOPIC · BOOKS	CONFLICT	PRIORITY / STATUS
HC-018	**Placement of TSWK/next Shadowmere era** 3SL/FTE/ADST/TSWK	Their mutual overlap is established, but sources do not consistently place them against the FTE/ADST window	Resolved at window level by TCD-024 and TCD-054: rolling handoff directly after FTE/ADST, allowing only days/small weeks, with substantial TSWK/Shadowmere overlap and separate activation/opening/climax/resolution dates
HC-020	**Underside physical placement** 3SL/FTE/Shared	“Buried realm” language could imply a nation wholly beneath another land or an independent vertical territory	Resolved by TCD-026: vertical nation attached to Zenithia’s side of Remnia; surface upper tiers, fully underground by Ironcross
HC-021	**Echo Gate status** FTE/ADST/Shared	Older lore treats a singular sealed Remnia–Somnoria convergence point as established	Resolved by TCD-027: Echo Gate is Legacy; its imagery is only a possible recovery candidate
HC-025	**Caelum’s allegiance** 3SL/FTE/ADST/Shared	Nightmare magic, Nightmare access, House Aether kinship, and cross-book manipulation could imply incompatible loyalties	Resolved at identity and Melena-relationship level by TCD-031 and TCD-043: independent cross-land actor, not a Nightmare member or Melena’s formal handler; full agenda remains open
HC-026	**Elias/Thorne identity chronology** FTE/ADST/Shared	Recent disappearance framing vs evidence of a long-established Somnorian academic life	Resolved structurally by TCD-032 and TCD-062: voluntary longstanding double life; Nightmare organization exploits research/dream vulnerability, causing unsafe/impossible return before Somnoria sees Thorne disappear; exact technique and later status open

ID	TOPIC · BOOKS	CONFLICT	PRIORITY / STATUS
HC-028	**Tournament reward and Conqueror** FTE/Shared	Real Board power vs secret culling function; King-versus-final-move title; no ordinary Checkmate under the ruled forfeit	Resolved by TCD-034, TCD-042, and TCD-052: Katherine creates the decisive state, Melena chooses survival, Tiran supports, living/conscious King Maxim formally authorizes the forfeit, and the Sanctum accepts it
HC-030	**Crossblood taxonomy** FTE/ADST/Shared	Legacy lore treats Crossblood as objective pre-fracture biology and groups dissimilar anomalies together	Resolved at terminology level by TCD-036: institutional/theoretical label, not proven universal biology; case-level classification remains
HC-034	**Katherine/Melena parentage** FTE/Shared	Supporting files variously identify Tobias, Lucia, Ethan, secrecy, and public scandal	Resolved biologically by TCD-040: paternal half-sisters through Tobias; records, knowledge, legitimacy, and succession remain open
HC-035	**Remnian institutional hierarchy** FTE/Shared	Crown, Board, provincial leaders, Elemental Court, Sanctum, and military sources imply overlapping supremacy	Resolved structurally by TCD-041: layered centralized empire with domain-specific, competing authority; exact jurisdiction remains open
HC-036	**London Town forfeit causation and authority** FTE	Legacy ending gives Tiran the announcement while rank rules and Melena's agency remain unclear	Resolved causally by TCD-042: Katherine creates the decisive state, Melena chooses survival, and properly authorized London Town command must formally forfeit
HC-037	**Melena/Caelum power relationship** 3SL/FTE/ADST/Shared	"Caelum's asset" conflicts with Melena's bargaining, resistance, and independent choices	Resolved by TCD-043: transactional alliance with coercive leverage; asset is Caelum's framing, not objective subordination

ID	TOPIC · BOOKS	CONFLICT	PRIORITY / STATUS
HC-042	**Elders' Prayer direct causality** 3SL/FTE/Shared	Shared working could be a later character accessing an earlier magical echo or reservoir	Resolved by TCD-048: independent performances connected only by inherited tradition; no specific echo, reservoir contribution, route transmission, or borrowed power
HC-043	**Katherine's Fire/Frost classification** FTE/Shared	Legacy Dyad/Crossblood labels equate Katherine with Zephyr despite different evidence and historical implications	Resolved at anatomy/expression level by TCD-049 and TCD-058: one older capacity expresses dominant Frost then reroutes to Fire when Frost configuration fails; both real, not two ordinary Dyad channels or proven deliberate suppression
HC-044	**Katherine–Melena sister-reveal mechanism** FTE/Shared	Legacy execution risks one magical reaction, file, or testimony instantly establishing biology and history	Resolved structurally by TCD-050: investigation → confrontation → authenticated verification → Michelle's personal confirmation; exact clue/evidence chain and disclosure remain open
HC-045	**Atlas's deterioration origin** FTE/Shared	Legacy symptoms permit ordinary Element Rot, earlier corruption, experiment, or Conduit Trial injury	Resolved by TCD-051: progressive inward synchronization injury originates in the Conduit Trial; exact pathology, progression, treatment, and prayer interaction remain open

ID	TOPIC · BOOKS	CONFLICT	PRIORITY / STATUS
HC-046	**Maxim's role in the London Town forfeit** FTE	Legacy ending centers Tiran while the King's condition and formal authority are unclear	Resolved by TCD-052: Maxim is alive, conscious, and active; Melena chooses, Tiran supports, Maxim authorizes, Sanctum accepts; exact procedure and private/public sequence remain open
HC-051	**Elders' Prayer effect and death boundary** 3SL/FTE/Shared	Silas regains breath/pulse and Atlas may recover, allowing mistaken resurrection, generic healing, or burden-transfer explanations	Resolved by TCD-057: restores viable living magical pattern and secondary physiology, can recover active dying threshold but never completed death or full tissue regeneration; exact cost/eligibility mechanics open
HC-052	**Katherine's hidden Fire and apparent suppression** FTE/Shared	Older sources imply sealed Fire, two Dyad channels, or stress-triggered awakening despite severe Beta Fire trauma producing only Frost	Resolved by TCD-058: dominant Frost expression of one ancestral capacity; Fire reroutes only after catastrophic Frost unavailability, not ordinary stress or proven external magical seal
HC-053	**Architect and layers of Katherine's concealment** FTE/Shared	Sources differ on public scandal versus no initial acknowledgment and on Crown, Sanctum, Tobias, Michelle roles	Resolved institutionally by TCD-059: Lucia/Crown originates public/legal erasure, Sanctum enforces records, Tobias participates in silence, Michelle protects within constraints; original public exposure and motivations remain open

ID	TOPIC · BOOKS	CONFLICT	PRIORITY / STATUS
HC-056	**Elias's failure to return** FTE/ADST/Shared	Voluntary Prince/Professor double life, breakdown rumors, criminal targeting, and separate missing-person clocks obscure immediate cause	Resolved by TCD-062: Nightmare organization exploits his research exposure to compromise dream/magic functioning, making return unsafe/impossible before Somnorian public disappearance; exact technique, later captivity, and agency open
HC-057	**Remy's death: forensic cause versus moral guilt** 3SL/FTE	Older 3SL character phrasing blames Melena directly; outline and Beta memory point to gang leader wound during rescue	Resolved by TCD-063: gang leader mortally wounds Remy as he deliberately protects Melena; her escalating Fire creates circumstances and his death precedes catastrophic blaze; exact weapon/anatomy remain subordinate to future 3SL draft
HC-059	**First Dren Anchor versus credited seal designer** TSWK	July 2026 blueprint ch. 29 calls 'Cael Dren' the man who designed the sacrificial route and First Anchor; chs. 38–39 reveal twelve-year-old Caelen as first Anchor	Deferred to TSWK draft/reveal design; do not identify the credited designer as the child or state who designed the route as fact; protect TCD-064's twelve-year-old Caelen
HC-061	**TSWK Book One ending and shared-system effects** TSWK/ADST/Shared	Working blueprint commits to Tavian's death, ordination, Levi opening the outward route, freed/observing Leviathan, Skyhold blackout, Oneiros response, and surviving wall symbols; TCD-012 leaves ending open and TCD-056 fixes ADST as first active cross-system threshold	Deferred to Book One drafting; record components as provisional blueprint beats, not canonical outcomes; preserve ADST's earlier cross-system threshold

LINEAGE CONFLICTS FOUND IN THE RECONSTRUCTION (2026-10-09) P.129

Not yet in the audit. Each is worked in full in the lineage record, lane D, with both sources quoted.

ID	CLAIM	HIGHER-AUTHORITY EVIDENCE	STATUS
LC-01	**Melena's eye colour**	Beta controls FTE prose (TCD-001). No ruling on which book changes.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT
LC-02	**Aracelia's surname and house**	The Beta's styling controls the drafted page. No ruling on her house; WTR, BSS and TLE all put her in the Hastings line.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT (name) · house Hastings SUPPORTED
LC-03	**Lucia's birth year**	None. TCD-010: no existing timeline controls chronology. Both files give Aracelia's birth as 2038, so BSS's 2047 would make Aracelia nine at Lucia's birth.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT
LC-04	**Eden's generation and reign**	TCD-032 has Aracelia reigning while Elias built the Thorne life as an adult; it doesn't date her accession.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT
LC-05	**Melena's great-grandmother**	None in this session. The Beta isn't available here, so whether it keeps the Caliane line is unchecked.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT (Caliane LEGACY unless the Beta keeps her)
LC-06	**Imperial succession law**	TCD-032: Elias is elevated to Crown Prince after Lucia's death. Beta: Melena is second in line. Neither states the law.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT (the law) · positions CANON / DRAFTED
LC-07	**Which house the throne passes through**	Beta: the heirs are Lockwoods ("the Lockwood second-in-line"). TCD-040 names Lucia "Hastings-Lockwood."	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT (dynastic house) · children's surname DRAFTED
LC-08	**Was Katherine's birth public?**	TCD-059 leaves initial publicity OPEN.	○ **OPEN** OPEN (sources conflict)

ID	CLAIM	HIGHER-AUTHORITY EVIDENCE	STATUS
LC-09	**Elias's titles**	TCD-032 (CANON).	● **CANON** Crown Prince from Lucia's death CANON · from birth SUPERSEDED · Duke of Somnoria SUPPORTED
LC-10	**Does the Remnian public know Somnoria exists?**	TCD-016: awareness varies by class, institution and time; Remnia's case isn't ruled.	○ **OPEN** OPEN
LC-11	**London Town's royal house**	TCD-041: the Crown directly controls London Town, so whoever reigns there rules under it. Beta: the four brothers are Augustines.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT
LC-12	**Dalia's father and the king before Nathaniel**	None.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT (inside TLE) · Edward SUPPORTED
LC-13	**Richard's birth year**	TCD-010.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT
LC-14	**Tobias's birth vs his parents' ages**	TCD-010.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT
LC-15	**Melena's birth year and age**	The Beta doesn't state her age (IV.14).	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT
LC-16	**How and where Lucia died**	None. The Content Master's IV.11 had "cause of death SUPPORTED" from 31–39 alone; corrected to CONFLICT.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT
LC-17	**Where Tobias is in 2094–95**	None. The Content Master: dead before FTE (SUPPORTED).	○ **OPEN** OPEN
LC-18	**Ethan's surname and role**	TCD-040: Ethan as biological father is superseded.	◇ **CONFLICT** Biological LEGACY / SUPERSEDED · social role POSSIBLE · surname CONFLICT
LC-19	**London Town's order of succession**	Nathaniel's 2090 decree (BSS) keeps daughters in birth order. No ruling.	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT (inside BSS)

ID	CLAIM	HIGHER-AUTHORITY EVIDENCE	STATUS
LC-20	**Dukedom titles vs provincial rule**	TCD-041: provincial leaders' titles may vary. Zenithia's leadership is already a CONFLICT (IV.3).	◇ **CONFLICT** CONFLICT
LC-21	**The parents' elements**	Beta (TCD-001).	■ **DRAFTED** Beta CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT · 31–39 needs revising

APPENDIX · STATUS & PROVENANCE SHEET

C SOURCE AUTHORITY INVENTORY: FTE SLICE

Every source this volume uses, with how this build could reach it.

Rows reproduced from the audit's Source Inventory for every file this volume cites (25 rows). The right column says how Build 2 reached each file. Files marked "through the Content Master" weren't available to this build: their facts are taken as the Content Master records them. The four files supplied on 2026-10-09 carry their treatment in the lineage record. The reconstructed lineage itself is a derived record, not a source, and isn't listed.

FILE · BOOK · TYPE	GENERATION · DOMAINS	STATUS	KNOWN CONFLICT · BUILD 2 ACCESS
3 Shadowmere Lane First Draft(9).docx 3SL · Manuscript, 22 chapters	Current drafted generation; revised through 2026-08-19 DOMAINS On-page chronology, POV, characterization, plot, Graveshand/Deathwork execution	Current for drafted pages	Diverges from the 32-chapter outline after the midpoint; stops with Remy alive and the transit route unresolved. TCD-044 requires voluntary romance to cross into explicit physical choice while keeping the nonconsensual tether mechanically distinct from consent. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build
3SL Character Outlines(5).docx 3SL · Character bible/outlines	Foundational character generation DOMAINS Histories, relationships, motivations, age progression	Supporting	Top-sheet ages describe a later time jump; opening ages align with locked constraints. Older language calling Melena the direct cause of Remy's death is emotional/indirect causation, not the objective fatal mechanism under TCD-063. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build

FILE · BOOK · TYPE	GENERATION · DOMAINS	STATUS	KNOWN CONFLICT · BUILD 2 ACCESS
3SL Full Worldbuilding(4).docx 3SL · Worldbuilding/magic/institutions	Foundational Underside generation DOMAINS Nine tiers, Synod, culture, economy, formal Six Disciplines	Supporting, clarified by rulings	TCD-004 places Graveshand outside the Six Disciplines. TCD-025–026 establish the Underside's vertical geography. TCD-035 places all Underside practices within a distinct modern branch of the shared primordial magical substrate without making them interchangeable with other lands' magic. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build
FTE Official Beta Reader Copy.docx FTE · Partial revised manuscript, through ch. 29	Current controlling prose generation DOMAINS On-page POV, characterization, plot, rules for revised chapters	Current for drafted pages	Incomplete; all material outside this generation must be rewritten before it becomes canon. TCD-058 explains its severe Fire-trauma Examination still producing Frost; TCD-063 establishes Remy's objective fatal cause while exact Beta flashback weapon/wound awaits 3SL draft. TCD-040 and TCD-049–052, TCD-059 control parentage, magic, injury, reveal, concealment, and forfeit. BUILD 2 Through the Content Master
Chapter 29.docx FTE · Manuscript chapter fragment	Post-Beta development fragment DOMAINS Candidate scene material	Supporting; rewrite required	Outside the controlling Beta file and therefore not canon until rewritten/integrated. BUILD 2 Through the Content Master
FTE 2025 FINAL(3).docx FTE · Complete 47-chapter manuscript	Earlier pre-Beta prose generation DOMAINS Planning/reference evidence for the unfinished half	Legacy	Its prose is superseded; no scene outside the Beta becomes canon without rewriting. Its simple Dyad/Crossblood explanation, reveal shortcut, Atlas deterioration cause, and Tiran-only forfeit execution are also superseded by TCD-049–052. BUILD 2 **Supplied 2026-10-09.** Legacy prose (TCD-001). Corroboration only; never establishes a claim.

FILE · BOOK · TYPE	GENERATION · DOMAINS	STATUS	KNOWN CONFLICT · BUILD 2 ACCESS
FTE 31-39.docx FTE · Manuscript fragment	New-development chapters for the unfinished half DOMAINS Usable scene and plot development	Supporting; rewrite required	May be developed into the current generation, but is not canon prose until rewritten/integrated with the Beta. BUILD 2 Through the Content Master
New Opening.docx FTE · Opening fragment	Beta-era alternate opening DOMAINS Candidate opening language	Supporting	Competes with Beta Reader Copy's existing opening. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build
New FTE Chapters.docx FTE · Large manuscript compilation	Older overlapping/restarted generation DOMAINS Historical scene bank	Legacy	Multiple restarted chapter sequences; predates the modern Remnia execution despite "New" in title. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build
The Challenges FTE Year.docx FTE · Challenge plan	Late-2025 challenge generation DOMAINS Current six executed challenges and mechanics	Supporting/current development	TCD-008 adopts the Conduit Trials concept for Challenge Four, but its final canon name remains open. BUILD 2 Through the Content Master
49th Chess Tournament Placements(1).docx FTE · Placement table	Modern roster generation DOMAINS Exact Piece positions and replacements	Current/Supporting	Aligns with Beta and Final core backline placements; older Chessboard Chart differs. BUILD 2 Through the Content Master
Character Bible.docx FTE · Character bible	Early modern generation DOMAINS Character backgrounds, affinities, relationships	Supporting by claim	Its Michelle/Tobias parentage for Katherine and Lucia/Tobias parentage for Melena are confirmed by TCD-040. Ages, titles, knowledge states, and other relationships still require current-generation checks. BUILD 2 Through the Content Master
FTE Elemental Factions.docx FTE · Magic/faction worldbuilding	Late-2025 DOMAINS Elemental categories, culture, faction rules	Supporting	Must yield where manuscript/locked constraints define Dyads, costs, or institutions differently. BUILD 2 Through the Content Master

FILE · BOOK · TYPE	GENERATION · DOMAINS	STATUS	KNOWN CONFLICT · BUILD 2 ACCESS
Welcome to Remnia(1).docx FTE/Shared · Setting primer	Mid-2025 composite DOMAINS Provinces, Tournament overview, public-facing lore	Supporting	Calls Dax a Rook and implies eight selections per province; modern manuscripts/placement table use sixteen and place Dax as Knight. BUILD 2 Through the Content Master
FTE Remnian Timeline Before Story Start(1).docx FTE/Shared · Detailed ER timeline	Latest expanded ER generation DOMAINS Births, lineages, pre-story chronology	Supporting/Needs Author Ruling by claim	TCD-040 fixes shared Tobias paternity; TCD-059 assigns the original public/legal erasure to Lucia/Crown and enforcement/record control to Sanctum. This file's public-scandal/birth-exposure framing, dates, titles, and knowledge states remain unresolved. BUILD 2 **Supplied 2026-10-09.** Historical/development pool, claim by claim. Latest expanded ER generation; Supporting / needs ruling (audit). Never controls chronology (TCD-010).
FTE Remnian Timeline Early(1).docx FTE/Shared · ER timeline	Earlier expanded ER generation DOMAINS Founding history, genealogy, pre-story chronology	Legacy/Supporting by claim	Any Lucia-as-Katherine's-mother or Ethan-as-father lineage is superseded by TCD-040. Remaining founding/history claims require separate support in the rebuilt timeline. BUILD 2 **Supplied 2026-10-09.** Earlier pool for genealogy, old succession and names; every later source outranks it. Claims only it makes are LEGACY until separately supported (audit).
FTE Timeline.docx FTE · Timeline	2024 generation DOMAINS Historical drafting evidence	Legacy	Superseded chronology and story framework. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build

FILE · BOOK · TYPE	GENERATION · DOMAINS	STATUS	KNOWN CONFLICT · BUILD 2 ACCESS
ADST(3).docx ADST · Partial manuscript, 19 chapters	Current drafted generation DOMAINS On-page POV, characterization, plot, Somnoria execution	Current for drafted pages	Its bond/scar and Caelum nightmare-magic execution are clarified by TCD-029–031. Thorne's compromised dream, research, and Professor Lane pattern support TCD-062. It ends before the TCD-060–061 rebuilt Network-rupture operation and Prism stabilization. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build
Thalara Worldbuilding(2).docx TSWK · Comprehensive worldbuilding/magic/history	Current Thalara generation DOMAINS Three-zone geography, Breath Rights, institutions, Seamwork, Seal Song, Leviathan, Drowning	Current/Supporting	TCD-055 fixes the Drowning as a later regional crisis and the First Seal as deliberate containment: existing Leviathan bound, existing Seal Song operationalized, part of Thalara sacrificed. TCD-037 keeps Leviathan within broader boundary architecture while its pre-First-Seal function remains open. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build
Azrine and Levi(2).docx TSWK · Character bible plus opening plot setup	Current Azrine/Levi generation with targeted correction DOMAINS Protagonists, families, relationships, crackdown, fragment mission	Current/Supporting	Every Joryn Rhos reference is superseded by Tavian Rhos. TCD-039 establishes the layered memory-shell relic. TCD-064 separates fully human Levi and inherited Dren seal compatibility from the distinct Leviathan; legacy soulprint/reincarnation is superseded. Compare the July 2026 blueprint for provisional full-book execution, not automatic replacement of character-file facts. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build

FILE · BOOK · TYPE	GENERATION · DOMAINS	STATUS	KNOWN CONFLICT · BUILD 2 ACCESS
Novel Constraints(2).docx Shared/all four · Locked constraint sheet	Jan. 2026 consolidated generation with targeted corrections DOMAINS Book order, core settings, magic, protagonists, major plot engines	Current, subject to logged rulings	TCD-004/005 clarify Graveshand and fragment chain; TCD-029–030 clarify Reverie/Cassius; TCD-049 and TCD-058 replace simple Dyad/suppressed-second-channel readings of Katherine; TCD-060–061 define a survivable Network-rupture climax; TCD-064 rejects Levi as reincarnated entity; TCD-054 fixes rolling handoff. “Caelum’s asset” is only his framing per TCD-043. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build
Full 4 Series Flesh Out(1).docx Shared/all four · Series plan, prophecy, sequel architecture	Aug. 2025 mixed/legacy plot generation DOMAINS Poem architecture, possible shared concepts, legacy cross-book plots/endings	Shared Lore Source Pool / Legacy Recovery Source	TCD-022 requires claim-level classification. TCD-045–047 retain a two-stage Divide, progressive Convergence, and four divergent descendant prophecy traditions, but the plan’s detailed plots, triggers, endings, relationship mechanics, activations, reincarnation/resurrection, sequence, and sequels do not control without separate support or ruling. BUILD 2 **Supplied 2026-10-09.** Shared lore pool / legacy recovery source (TCD-022). Claim by claim; cross-series mechanisms are not imported.
The Poems(1).docx Shared/all four · Prophecy/verse artifact	Dec. 2025 current poem generation DOMAINS Complete Shattered Veil plus four divergent cultural versions	Current for poem texts	TCD-006 and TCD-047 establish a complete author-level text but no intact authoritative in-world master. The four national texts are divergent historical descendants rather than physical pieces; reconstruction requires comparison and corroborating evidence. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build

FILE · BOOK · TYPE	GENERATION · DOMAINS	STATUS	KNOWN CONFLICT · BUILD 2 ACCESS
Full Tandem Lore Document(1).docx FTE/ADST/Shared · Remnia–Somnoria master lore	May 2025 two-world generation DOMAINS Series positioning and high-level Remnia–Somnoria links	Supporting/Legacy by claim	Separate-world cosmology and the singular Echo Gate are superseded. Its shared-origin concept survives in expanded four-land form under TCD-035. “Crossblood” survives only as a contested institutional/scholarly label under TCD-036; candidate lists and biological certainty do not control. Its Prism-as-cage language is at most limited in-world interpretation under TCD-038. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build
Full Tandem Lore Document(2).docx FTE/ADST/Shared · Remnia–Somnoria master lore	Exact duplicate DOMAINS None independently	Duplicate	Byte- and text-identical to Full Tandem Lore Document(1).docx. BUILD 2 Cited by the Content Master; not consulted in this build
The Imperial Lineage FTE/Shared · genealogy as news bulletins	Not in the audit’s inventory.	UNAUDITED	Comparison only; nothing imported. Every claim the Content Master quotes from it is in the Remnian Timeline Before Story Start. BUILD 2 Not available; quoted by the Content Master

APPENDIX · TERMINOLOGY REGISTER

TERMINOLOGY REGISTER: FTE SLICE

E

Print version of Production Control A7, limited to the terms this volume uses.

These terms carry rulings; drafters use them exactly. 15 of the register's 18 terms appear in this volume.

TERM	REQUIRED USAGE	GOVERNING RULING
Graveshand	Inherited Graves-family magic, outside the formal Six Disciplines	TCD-004
Routes	Physical-magical transit through real passages; never portals	TCD-017
Echo Gate	LEGACY only	TCD-027
Oneiros Prism	Fragmented cross-land artifact; "the Prism" alone must not imply the whole is held	TCD-018, TCD-019
Nightmare (organization)	The criminal organization; say "the Nightmare organization" when ambiguous	TCD-020
ancient Nightmare / the entity	The ancient entity; at ADST Book One's end, Aware only	TCD-020, TCD-053
Crossblood	Contested institutional/scholarly label, never objective biology	TCD-036
Dyad (for Katherine)	The Sanctum's incomplete label; objectively she is not Zephyr's kind of Dyad	TCD-049, TCD-058
Conqueror	Surviving Piece whose decisive sanctioned action earns victory; not automatically the King	TCD-034
The Conduit Trials	Working title for Challenge Four; always flag the name as open	TCD-008
Levi / Cael	Levi is default; Cael is a nickname from Caelis; full name Leviathan Caelis Dren	TCD-011
Leviathan	The living pressure entity; never Levi	TCD-064

TERM	REQUIRED USAGE	GOVERNING RULING
Drowned Canticle / Seal Song	Canticle is Thalara's Shattered Veil version within or alongside the broader Seal Song	TCD-028
Divide / Drowning	Ancient rupture-plus-response vs later Thalaran regional catastrophe	TCD-045, TCD-055
Convergence	A transition state, never an outcome	TCD-046, TCD-056